

Foreword

Good intelligence depends in large measure on clear, concise writing. The information CIA gathers and the analysis it produces mean little if we cannot convey them effectively. The Directorate of Intelligence and the Agency as a whole have always understood that. Both have been lucky, from their earliest days, to people who enjoy writing and excel at it.

The *Style Manual and Writers Guide for Intelligence Publications* is an essential reference for the officers of our Directorate. Now in its eighth edition, it reflects an enduring commitment to the highest standards of care and precision.

This guide is designed to be helpful and convenient, sensible in organization, and logical in content. It contains, among other changes, a revised list of accepted acronyms and new tips on word usage. The world is not static. Nor is the language we employ to assess it.

In dealing with foreign policy and national security, our government has many sources of insight on which to draw. The depth of our knowledge, the strength of our thinking, and the power of our words will ensure that our customers, from policymakers to operations officers, continue to rely on the Directorate of Intelligence.

Fran Moore
Director for Intelligence

Preface

The eighth edition of the *Style Manual and Writers Guide for Intelligence Publications* provides guidance for English usage and writing style in the Central Intelligence Agency. It incorporates most of the improvements that appeared in previous editions but returns to the organization by chapters of the earliest versions. The chapters on capitalization, numbers, abbreviations, italics, punctuation, spelling, and compound words have numerous headings and subheadings to enable users to find specific subjects quickly within the chapters themselves or through the table of contents. Further subject indexing is provided in chapter 9—the Word Watchers List—which incorporates many of the style rules in abbreviated form; it is similar to the Word Watchers Index in the fourth edition and to the overall organization of more recent editions. The manual also includes a comprehensive Spelling and Compound Words List, as have all previous editions, and an index to the entire manual.

The counsel in this guide is derived from many sources, including the works of Barzun, Bernstein, Copperud, Follett, Fowler, the Morrisises, Strunk and White, Gregg, and other recognized arbiters of English usage. It also draws on the stylebooks of press services, newspapers, publishing houses, and past and present CIA offices.

A basic reference for spelling, compounding, and other instructions for all eight editions is the US Government Printing Office's *Style Manual*, the most recent edition of which was issued in 2008. The GPO's authority for spelling and compounding words is *Webster's Third New International Dictionary*, published by G. & C. Merriam Company. That dictionary or the more up-to-date abridgments of it (the latest being *Webster's 11th New Collegiate Dictionary*) are the authorities for the preferred spellings listed in this guide that were not found in the GPO manual.

This guide is for both the creators and the processors of intelligence analysis—for the writers and for the editors of their analyses. It also serves writers and processors of administrative papers. Moreover, it has been used and will continue to be used by teachers and students of writing and publications processing.

The manual is available online in both web browser (HTML) and printer-friendly (PDF) versions; limited quantities are available in hardcopy. The browser version contains active links that take users from one related issue to another; these are indicated with the standard hyperlink convention: underlined text. The browser version may be updated as needed.

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§

1. CAPITALIZATION

1.1. A Few Basic Rules

When deciding whether or not to capitalize a word, follow the old maxim: "When in doubt, don't." Do not, for example, capitalize the first letters of the words explaining an uppercase abbreviation unless the term abbreviated is a proper name.

LAN (local area network)

USPS (United States Postal Service)

The capitalization of abbreviations themselves is covered in chapter 3. One general rule is to avoid the all-uppercase formulations common in the military for weapon designators (use *Scud*, not *SCUD*) and for exercises. Lowercase is preferred for acronyms (such as *comsat*), but be aware of exceptions (notably *NATO* and *SIGINT*).

This chapter covers other areas in which uncertainty about capitalization may arise. We assume all users of this manual know that the first letter of a sentence should be capitalized, but a writer may be unsure about what to do if a number begins a sentence—spell it out, even if it is a number normally written as a figure (see sections 2.2 and 2.14), or rephrase the sentence (for example, change *1988 was a significant year for her* to *The year 1988 was significant for her*).

1.2. Proper Nouns

Generally, capitalize a common noun when it forms part of a proper name but not when it is used alone as a substitute for the name of the place or thing or when it becomes separated from the rest of the name by an intervening word or phrase. Certain well-known short forms of specific proper names, however, are exceptions to this rule.

Social Democratic Party, the party

Catholic Church, the church

Harvard University, the university

Quebec Province, Province of Quebec; the province; Quebec, Canada's separatist province
but

the British Commonwealth, the Commonwealth

the Panama (or Suez) Canal, the Canal

the Golan Heights, the Heights

the Persian Gulf, the Gulf

the Horn of Africa, the Horn

the Korean Peninsula, the Peninsula

the Olympic Games, the Games, the Olympics, the Winter (or Summer) Olympics

the Taiwan Strait, the Strait, cross-Strait

A noun common to two or more proper names is capitalized in the plural form when preceded by the proper adjectives in those names.

Montgomery and Prince George's Counties

Harvard and Yale Universities

Red and Black Seas

1.3. Derivatives of Proper Names

Do not capitalize derivatives of proper names used with acquired independent meanings.

anglicized words	italic type
bohemian lifestyle	molotov cocktail
byzantine organization	pasteurized milk
diesel engine	roman type
draconian measures	venetian blinds
but	
Castroite sympathies	islamization
degrees Celsius	Maoist, Leninist
degrees Fahrenheit	Morse code
Francophone	pulsed Doppler effect
Gaullist policies	Sandinista

1.4. Articles in Place Names

Capitalize the definite article, or its foreign language equivalent, when it is part of an official name. When such a name is used adjectively, an uncapitalized *the* might be used and, despite the redundancy, would precede a capitalized non-English equivalent.

The Bahamas	the Bahamas Tourist Office
El Salvador	the El Salvador situation
The Gambia	the Gambia mapping project
The Hague	the Second Hague Conference

For some country names the definite article is used but is not capitalized because it is not part of the official name (for example, the United Kingdom, the United States, the Vatican) or because the convention has been to use a lowercase *t*, as in:

- the Philippines (The proper adjective is *Philippine*; the people are *Filipinos*.)
- the Netherlands (The proper adjective is *Dutch* or *Netherlands*; the people are called the *Dutch* or the *Netherlanders*.)²

Do not omit the article before a country name in a series if the article is used when the name stands alone.

The United States and the Netherlands (not *the United States and Netherlands*)

There is no *the* in *Congo, Seychelles, Sudan, or Western Sahara* (*the Sahara* refers to the desert).

1.5. Names of Persons

The spelling of personal names in CIA writing follows transliteration systems generally agreed upon by US Government agencies, unless officials have stated a preference for variant spellings of their names.

²Guidance on country names and the nouns and adjectives denoting nationality is given in *The World Factbook*, produced by the CIA and available online or in hardcopy from the US Government Printing Office or the National Technical Information Service.

1.5a. Particles in Personal Names

In certain personal names, particles such as *al*, *d'*, *de*, *del*, *della*, *den*, *di*, *du*, *l'*, *la*, *le*, *van*, and *von* are usually not capitalized unless they begin a sentence.

- ... achieved independence while de Gaulle was President. De Gaulle, however, did ...
- ... was opposed by the den tly government. Den tly's policy differed from that of van Agt ...

In some cases, particles are often dropped when the family name alone is used.

- Iraqi Prime Minister Nuri al-Maliki; but Maliki stated ...

Anglicized versions of foreign names vary in the matter of retaining or dropping particles and in the use of capital letters.

1.5b. Nicknames

When a nickname or a descriptive expression replaces a person's first name, capitalize it. If the nickname falls between a person's first and last names, capitalize it and enclose it in quotation marks.

- the late revolutionary Che Guevara
- Israeli Prime Minister Binyamin "Bibi" Netanyahu

1.6. Government Bodies

Capitalize both the full proper name of a national government body and its shortened form.

- the British Parliament, the Parliament, Parliament
- the Argentine Congress, the Congress; the Tunisian Chamber of Deputies, the Chamber, but the Argentine legislature, the Tunisian legislature, the legislature
- the French Senate, the Senate, the upper house
- the Cuban Council of Ministers, the Council of Ministers
- the British Cabinet, the Cabinet, the Conservative Cabinet, Cabinet member; but the Labor shadow cabinet (This example does not apply across the board, especially if the term cabinet is used in reference to a body whose formal title does not resemble the English word. If in doubt, use lowercase.)
- the Ministry of Economy, the Ministry; a proposed ministry of energy, the proposed ministry, various ministries, several ministries, the economic ministries, the foreign service, the civil service; but a Secret Service agent, the Intelligence Community
- the Supreme Court
- the Central Bank, the Bank
- the US Government, the Federal Government (US only; also Federal employes, etc.), the French Government, the French and Italian Governments, the Government of France, the Governments of France and Italy; but the government (shortened form always lowercase), the Brown government, the Tory government, the European governments; the executive, legislative, and judicial branches of government; the Obama administration, the administration; the Calderon administration

For a subnational government body, capitalize only the full proper name and avoid shortened forms that might be confused with national equivalents.

- the Maryland House of Delegates, the state legislature (not the House), the Quebec Parliament, the provincial parliament; the Jerusalem Municipal Council, the council, municipal councils all over Israel

1.7. Military Forces

Capitalize the full proper name (or reasonable translations and approximations thereof) of a military force or service as well as the shortened form of that name.

the US Army, the Army
 the Egyptian Army, the Army, an Army engineer
 Chilean Army, division, or regiment level
 the Russian Navy, the Navy, a Navy officer
 the People's Liberation Army, the Army, the PLA
 the Royal Air Force, the Air Force, the RAF, an Air Force pilot
 The Israel Defense Forces, the IDF (not the Forces)

This rule does not apply to individual units in the matter of capitalizing the shortened form of the name.

the 3rd Army, the army the 27th Division, the division
 the 7th Fleet, the fleet The 1028th Brigade, the brigade

Nor does it apply to a reference, other than a proper name, to military services as a group, to a general reference to one kind of service in the plural form, or to any general reference.

the Russian armed forces
 the British military establishment
 the infantry, the artillery, the submarine forces
 US naval forces
 the East European air forces
 the navies of the Mediterranean NATO members
 a navy (army, air force) to be proud of
 Russian-supplied air force (naval, ground force) equipment
 but
 the German and French Air Forces, the Greek and Turkish Navies (specific services referred to by proper names in plural form)

1.8. International Organizations

Capitalize both the full proper name and the shortened form of an international organization and its subelements.

the UN General Assembly, the Assembly
 the World Bank, the Bank

1.9. Diplomatic and Consular Units

Capitalize the full or shortened name of a specific embassy, mission, or consulate, but not those words when used generally.

the British Embassy, the Embassy
 the British Embassies in Paris and Rome
 the US Mission, a spokesman for the Mission
 the French Consulate, the Consulate, during Consulate hours

but
 reports from African embassies
 employees skilled in consulate operations
 members of diplomatic missions
 US embassy guards in the African states

1.10. Religious Terms

Capitalize the names of religions, religious bodies, and the terms for their adherents and writings

the Bible	Islam	Methodist Church (but the church)
Biblical text	a Jew	a Muslim
Catholicism	Judaism	a Protestant
Christianity	the Koran	the Talmud
an Episcopalian	Koranic law	Talmudic scholar

Do not capitalize such terms when they are used in a nonreligious sense.

This style guide, which should be the bible for intelligence writers, attempts to be catholic in its approach to English usage.

1.11. Titles of Religious Leaders

The terms for and titles of religious leaders are capitalized preceding a name and occasionally following the name or when used alone.

Bishop Tutu, the Bishop; but appointment of a bishop. (In a political context simply use the name for subsequent reference: meetings between Tutu and the authorities.)

Pope Benedict XVI . . . the Pope; but election of a pope; future popes; papal, papacy

1.12. Political Parties and Similar Groups

Capitalize the full or shortened name of a political party but not the word party standing alone.

the Chinese Communist Party, the party, the CCP

the Italian Socialist Party, the Socialist Party, the PSI

the Christian Democratic Union, the party, the CDU

the British (or Australian or New Zealand) Labor² Party, the party, Labor's chances in the election

1.13. Political Philosophies

Capitalize words referring to members of organized parties but not words referring to political philosophies and their adherents.

a Socialist, a Liberal, a Laborite, a Conservative, a Tory, a Social Christian, a Christian Socialist, a Communist (all party members)

A British socialist is likely to be a member of the Labor Party.

The socialist parties of Western Europe include the British Labor Party and the German Social Democratic Party.

²Note that, even in proper names, we always use the American spelling for English words spelled differently in the British Commonwealth.

Not all liberal European parties have the word *liberal* in their names.

a communist opposition party called the People's Party

The communist³ countries today are China, Cuba, North Korea, Laos, and Vietnam.

Eurocommunism

but

Christian Democracy, Christian Democrat, Christian Democratic (both the C and the D are uppercased)

1.14. Geographic Terms

1.14a. Direction

A geographic term used to denote mere direction or position on the earth⁴ is not a proper name and is not capitalized.

north, south, east, west, south-central, far north

northerly, eastward, western, far western

east coast, southern France, central Europe

the polar region, polar icecap; the Arctic Circle, the Arctic region (lowercase as descriptive adjective; arctic clothing, conditions, etc.)

Latitude (zero to 90 degrees) and longitude (zero to 180 degrees) continue to describe position on the earth, but context and space limitations allow for differences in format beyond the traditional symbols used to designate degrees, minutes, and seconds (when needed).

Either 55° 45' north latitude, 37° 35' east longitude or 55 45 north latitude, 37 35 east longitude may be used in the text of a paper, as long as use is consistent.

The format 55 45 N 37 35 E is preferred on a map or graphic.

Six digits set solid (554500N) is preferred in a table or matrix with latitude as a header and seven digits set solid (0373500E) with longitude as a header.

1.14b. Special Geographic Groupings

Geographic terms often become part of a proper name for a definite region, geographic feature, or political grouping and are capitalized.

the West, the East, Western countries, East-West dialogue

the Western Hemisphere, the North Pole, the Caribbean Basin, the San Andreas Fault

the Equator

the Continent (meaning continental Europe)

but

the coterminous, or contiguous, United States (meaning the first 48 states) and the continental United States (meaning the first 48 states plus Alaska)

Greater Moscow, Metropolitan Moscow (but Moscow metropolitan area)

North and South, capitalized, are often used as abbreviations of the two Koreas or to refer, respectively, to the developed and developing countries, as in "the North-South dialogue."

³Communist countries and parties often call themselves "Socialist" or "socialist." In paraphrasing communist statements, put such references in quotation marks. The same applies to imperialism and imperialist (and to anti-imperialism and anti-imperialist), which are terms communists use in describing their opponents.

⁴Capitalize Earth, Moon, and Sun only in extraterrestrial contexts. Earth orbit, Moon landing, orbit the Sun; but earth's topography, moonlight, sunshine.

Some capitalized geographic terms are used to divide the world into groups of countries for purposes of intelligence reporting.

Middle East or Middle Eastern (preferred over Near East, Mideast)
 North Africa (occasionally North-Central Africa)
 Sub-Saharan Africa
 West Africa, East Africa
 but
 black Africa, southern Africa (South Africa refers only to the republic)
 South Asia (sometimes Southwest or Southeast Asia)
 East Asia (preferred over Far East)
 Oceania (note also North or South Pacific, the Pacific Rim, but eastern, western Pacific)
 Western Europe, West European
 Eastern Europe, East European
 Latin America
 Middle America
 Central America

Some countries fall into more than one category, depending on the context. In some reports, countries logically belonging in a geographic category are grouped separately by some other criterion, such as membership in NATO. The Arab states are often treated as a group in papers on the Middle East. And the terms Middle America and Central America are not synonymous. Be careful, therefore, to explain any such groupings or any deviations from normal geographic categories in a prefatory note or a footnote.

1.15. Nationalities, Tribes, and Other Groups of People

Capitalize the names of racial, linguistic, tribal, ethnic, and religious groupings such as the following. Check *The World Factbook* for specific groupings in a country.

African-American	Colored ^b	Mongol
Amerindian	Creole	Mongoloid
Arab	Indian	Mormon
Aryan	Indo-Chinese	Negro, Negroid
Asian	Indo-European	Nordic
Bedouin (ethnic population) ^a	Jewish	Oriental
Barber	KwaZulu	Polynesian
Bushman	Magyar	Pygmy
Caucasian	Malay	Walloon
Caucasoid	Maori	Zulu

Do not capitalize the following terms based on racial origin, size, and local or other usage (Some terms of this sort can have offensive connotations and, of course, should never be used.)

aborigine, aboriginal	bushman (general sense)	overseas (as in overseas Chinese)
animist	mestizo	pygmy (general sense)
bedouin (nomadic lifestyle)	mulatto	white
black		

^aSee bedouin in chapter 9.

^bThe capitalized term Colored is used in reporting on South Africa and (historically) other white-populated areas of Africa. Except in the way it is spelled here (Colored, not Coloured) the term conforms to local usage.

1.16. Coined Names

A coined name or short form for a military, economic, political, or other grouping is capitalized.

the Alliance, Allied (adjective), and Allies in reference to NATO (uppercasing is needed for clarity, otherwise lowercase)
 the Contras
 the European Union, the Union, the EU member states
 the Free World (use noncommunist world in all but historical contexts)
 the Group of Eight (G-8)
 the Intelligence Community
 Nonaligned Movement
 Six-Party Talks
 but
 Camp David accords, Geneva accords, Helsinki accords, Amman accords, Dayton accords,
 Paris accords
 the establishment
 fifth column
 the occupied territories
 Persian Gulf states, the Gulf states
 stealth bomber, stealth technology, counterstealth

1.17. Holidays, Religious Feasts, and Historic and Other Significant Events

Many of the examples in this section need capitalization to give them the emphasis or prominence essential to understanding their meaning, especially when they are used out of context.

the Cold War	the Holocaust	Ramadan
the Cultural Revolution	Independence Day	the Renaissance
D-Day	New Year's Day	the Six-Day War ²
the Depression	the October War ²	World War II
the Feast of the Passover	the 23rd Party Congress	
the Great Leap Forward	the Prague Spring	

1.18. Trade Names

Trade names (such as *Velcro*, *Kleenex*, or *Teflon*) should be capitalized or replaced with a generic term.

air-cushion vehicle (ACV) or hovercraft (unless it is a real *Hovercraft*)
 fiber-glass (unless it is Owens-Corning *Fiberglas*)
 oxytetracycline (unless the physician specifically prescribed *Terramycin*)
 a photocopy (unless it is known to be a *Xerox* copy or a *Kodak* copy)
 tracked vehicles (unless they have genuine *Caterpillar* treads)
 a canning jar (unless it is a real *Ball* or *Mason* jar)

²Capitalize the W in *October War* or *Six-Day War* because either term as a whole is a distinguishing coined name, but 1973 Middle East war or 1967 Arab-Israeli war is distinguishing enough without the capital W. Avoid Yom Kippur war, which is slangy. Do not uppercase the w in *Korean war*, which was "undeclared"; the same logic applies to *Vietnam war* and *Falklands war*, and a similar convention (if not logic) to *Kan-Iraq war*.

Sometimes an acceptable replacement is hard to find. For example, "Ping-Pong diplomacy," the catchphrase once used to describe the exchange of sport and cultural delegations between the United States and China, was probably not entirely accurate even with the trade name uppercased but was certainly preferable to "table tennis diplomacy." Usage eventually pushes bestselling trademarks into the generic language—and in some cases, such as jeep, the generic preceded the trade name. For instance, the following once-capitalized names are now listed in the Merriam-Webster dictionary in lowercase: *celluloid*, *deep-freeze*, *dry ice*, *photosat*, and *zipper*.

1.19. Titles of Persons

1.19a. Before the Name

Capitalize any valid title (or short form of it) immediately preceding a person's name. The plural form of the title preceding more than one name is also capitalized. In front of a title, the prefix *ex* (followed by a hyphen or an en dash) and the adjectives *former* and *then* (neither followed by a hyphen) are not capitalized; neither are the suffixes *designate* and *elect*. Do not confuse a mere description with a title by capitalizing it.

President Sarkozy, Acting President Ghimpu, Defense Minister Barak, First Deputy Premier Shvatur
 Prime Ministers Cameron and Cowen
 former Prime Minister Callaghan, then Defense Minister Sharor, ex-President Lopez, ex-Foreign Minister Gromyko, President-elect Salinas, Permanent Representative-designate to the UN Dauth
 the late PLO Chairman Arafat (but former PLO leader Arafat)
 Chief Justice Ramirez, Associate Justice Alberti, Justices Alberti and Ramirez
 Bishop Jones, Chairman Smith, Prof. Mary Brown, Professor Brown
 Mayor Black, Assistant Principal Jones
 First Lady Margarita Zavala de Calderon
 party Secretary Brown (uppercase any party top leader's formal title preceding the name), ruling-party Chairman Jones
 vice-presidential candidate Gonzalez, pianist Ray Charles

Avoid preceding a name with more than one title. Use the more important one first, and then the other later in the text if necessary or if desired for variation.

onetime Minister of Defense Yazov . . . Marshal Yazov
 the late President Pinchot . . . General Pinchot

1.19b. After or in Place of the Name

Generally, a title standing alone is lowercased unless it refers to an incumbent—present or past (but not future). To indicate preeminence or distinction in certain instances, capitalize a common-noun title or shortened title when it follows the name of a person or is used alone in reference to the person to whom the title belongs or belonged. The plural form of such a title is also capitalized as appropriate. So is the word *Acting* if it is a valid part of a capitalized title. Do not capitalize such a title when it refers to the office rather than the individual or when it is used generally.

1.19b1. *Head or Assistant Head of State or Government⁴; Royal Heir Apparent*

Nicolas Sarkozy, President of France
 the President
 the Prime Ministers of Italy and France
 the Premier-designate, the Vice President-elect
 the woman designated as Premier, the man elected Vice President
 the former Vice President, an ex-President
 the then Secretary General
 the Queen of England, the Prince of Wales, the Crown Prince
 the former King
 but
 aspire to be president
 destined to be king
 a younger head of state
 the new chief of state
 note also
 the first Lady, the First Family (but the royal family)

1.19b2. *Top Officials, National Government Unit; Principal Members, Legislative and Judicial Branches*

David Wright Miliband, Secretary of State for Foreign and Commonwealth Affairs
 the Acting Foreign Secretary
 the Minister of Foreign Affairs, the Foreign Minister
 the Deputy Minister of Foreign Affairs
 Minister Without Portfolio
 the Chief Justice
 the President of the Senate, the President
 the Speaker of the House, the Speaker
 Bank of Canada Governor Carney
 but
 a deputy minister of foreign affairs, a first deputy premier
 shadow minister, shadow chancellor of the Exchequer, shadow foreign secretary
 conferred with cabinet ministers and secretaries of state
 the senator, the representative, the congressman, the assemblyman
 the member of Parliament (never parliamentarian—see chapter 9)
 a deputy in the National Assembly
 an associate justice
 chairman of the Foreign Affairs Committee
 the deputy chairman

1.19b3. *Officers of Party Organizations in Communist Countries*

Cuban Communist Party First Secretary Fidel Castro
 Hu Jintao, General Secretary of the Communist Party of China
 party General Secretary Hu
 the General Secretary, the party General Secretary

⁴Capitalize Presidential in any reference to a present or past US President (Presidential votes, decisions, proclamations, etc.) but not a reference to a future one (the 2012 presidential election) or to the office generally (presidential powers under the US Constitution). Outside the US context, lowercase presidential and other adjectives referring generally to government offices unless they are part of an official name or title: Presidential (Ministerial, Vice-Presidential) liaison Office(s); but presidential action, ambassadorial courtesies, prime-ministerial caliber.

but

Politburo member Ricardo Alarcon

party secretary Juan Almeida

the party secretary responsible for agriculture

a full member or candidate member of the party Politburo

the general secretary of the Italian Communist Party

1.19b4. Top Officials of First-Order Subnational Administrative Divisions

Jean Charest, Premier of Quebec

the Vice Premier of Quebec

the Governor of Connecticut

the Lieutenant Governor of Virginia

the Acting Governor of Maryland

the Armenian Republic First Secretary

but

a capable premier

several state governors

the mayor of Philadelphia

1.19b5. Top Officers in a Military Service

Commander in Chief of the Chilean Army; the Commander in Chief

Chief of Staff, Brazilian Air Force

Deputy Chief of Staff

but

the quartermaster

commander, IV Corps

chief, G-2 (Intelligence Branch), Army Headquarters

the general (military title standing alone not capitalized)

1.19b6. Principal Official of an International Organization

the Secretary General

the current Secretaries General of the UN and the OAS

but

periodic selection of NATO secretaries general

1.19b7. Principal Members of the Diplomatic Corps

the Ambassador, the British Ambassador²

the Deputy Chief of Mission

the Minister, the Charge, the Consul General, Minister Plenipotentiary

but

the counselor of embassy, the economic counselor, the first secretary, the US defense attache,

the consul, the rank of ambassador, ambassadors at the conference (general use)

²There are four levels of ambassadorship. 1) Ambassador-nominee: a person who has been designated by a government as ambassador but for whose appointment the United States has not granted agreement.

2) Ambassador-designate: a person whose government has obtained agreement for appointment but who has not yet taken up the post. 3) Appointed Ambassador: a person who has presented credentials to the Secretary of State or resigned but not to the President. 4) Ambassador: a person who has presented credentials to the President.

1.20. Publications

1.20a. Titles in English

Capitalize the first letter of the initial word, that of the final word, and that of any principal word in titles of publications and the like (books, newspapers, magazines, articles, series, reports, speeches, plays, movies, musical compositions, works of art, and historical documents). Principal words include all nouns, pronouns, verbs (including the *to* in an infinitive), adjectives, and adverbs; the preposition *via*, as well as *per* when part of a unit modifier; any other word of more than three letters; the first word following a colon or em dash within a title; and parts of compounds that would be capitalized standing alone (Long-Term, President-Elect, Re-Creation, Follow-On, Trade-Off but Balance-of-Payments Problems, Nine-to-Five Schedule, Co-op Formation). If a normally lowercased short word is used in juxtaposition with a capitalized word of like significance, it should also be capitalized (*Buildings In and Near Minneapolis, Construction "On the Cheap"*).

1.20b. Shortened Titles

The above rule is sometimes modified to apply to accepted shortened titles of some publications and historic documents.

article in *The Washington Post*, quoted in the *Post* article
reported in *The Times*; from the *London Times*³⁰
Quadrupartite Agreement, the Agreement
Balfour Declaration; the Declaration (but a British white paper)
the Ruritanian Constitution; the Constitution
but
The 1962 Constitution was a vast improvement over earlier constitutions.
Writers of constitutions (general use) and compilers of style guides are kindred souls.

1.20c. Laws and Treaties

Capitalize the first word and all other important words in the formal titles or distinguishing shortened names of federal, state, or foreign documents. If a descriptive term is used, or if the document is still in draft form, use lowercase. The names of ratified treaties are capitalized when rendered in full. For treaties that have not been ratified, the *in treaty* should always be lowercase.

Bill of Rights
START Treaty, the treaty, New START Treaty
Treaty of Paris, the treaty
Kyoto treaty

1.20d. Foreign Titles

Capitalization of titles that must be given in a language other than English should conform to the practice in that language.

³⁰Always word referenced to the *London Times* so as to avoid confusion with *The New York Times* and vice versa

1.21. Graphics, Tables, and Chapters

The rule in section 1.20 concerning capitalization of titles of publications and the like also applies to titles of graphics, tables, chapter and part headings, headlines, and the equivalent, but not to annotations (such as arrowed captions or callouts) on a photograph, map, or other graphic—in which only the first letter of the initial word is capitalized. If a number given as a figure begins such a caption the word following it is *not* capitalized.

200-mile limit (not 200-Mile limit or 200-mile Limit)

1.22. Cross-References

The common nouns used in numeral or letter designations of chapters, parts, graphics, tables, etc. are not usually parts of titles and are not capitalized in cross-references.

covered in chapter III, volume I
refer to appendix B
(see figure 13)
(detailed in table A-4)
disagrees with section 27

1.23. Indented Bullet or Dash Paragraphs

Capitalize the first letter of each entry in a series of blocks of text indented for emphasis and introduced by a bullet or an em dash.

1.24. Miscellany

1.24a. Seasons¹⁴

Do not capitalize *spring*, *summer*, *fall* (*autumn*), or *winter*. As a general rule, use the definite article in referring to a season and use *of* before the year.

In the fall of 2009
but
her fall 2009 election triumph

1.24b. Major Storms

Capitalize *hurricane* and *typhoon* as part of a US National Weather Service name for such a storm, as in Hurricane Katrina or Typhoon Mearkut. Both terms designate types of cyclones, as does *tornado*, but personalization has not been applied to cyclones, tornadoes, or waterspouts (tornadoes gone to sea). In view of the confusion of nomenclature, be sure of what you are talking about before you write about it.

¹⁴Avoid seasonal references in any writing about the Southern Hemisphere.



2. NUMBERS

2.1. Basic Guidance

Although the reader comprehends figures more readily than numbers spelled out, particularly in technical, scientific, or statistical matter, typographic appearance and other special reasons often call for spelling out numbers rather than using figures.

2.2. Numbers of 10 or More

Except in the first word of a sentence, write numbers of 10 or more in figures, not in spelled-out words.

Her tour covered 11 countries in 16 days.

Sixteen days on the road left him exhausted. (Better: He was exhausted after 16 days on the road.)

2.3. Numbers Under 10

Spell out most numbers under 10, but use figures if such numbers are decimals, ages of persons, percentages, specific amounts of money, or numbers used with units of measure other than time.

For five years the county has provided free preschool classes for 5-year-olds.

They visited six countries in Asia, three in Africa, and two in Europe, spending an average of 1.45 days in each country.

He walked 6 kilometers every 2.5 days (but every two days).

She spent 8 percent of her time in Europe.

He overspent his daily allowance by an average of \$7.

The jet's top speed was Mach 2.2.

2.4. Mixes of Numbers Above and Below 10

Combinations of numbers on either side of 10 follow the basic rules governing numbers set forth above.

The estimate covers the period five to 10 years from now.

He packed two suits, 12 shirts, and three ties.

She had 14 children (three daughters and 11 sons).

The measure lacked three of the 34 votes needed for approval.

The attack involved about 200 troops, 12 tanks, and two aircraft.

2.5. Ordinal Numbers

The rules governing cardinal numbers generally apply to ordinal numbers, except that military units are always designated by figures (again, unless the figure unavoidably comes at the beginning of a sentence), and fractions are usually written out.

First Congress	82nd Congress
ninth century	20th century
seventh region	17th region
fifth anniversary	50th anniversary
first grade	11th grade
3rd Army	2nd Infantry Division
323rd Fighter Wing	1028th Brigade
9th Naval District	7th Fleet
VI Corps (Army usage)	XII Corps

2.6. Indefinite Numbers

Except with words such as *about*, *nearly*, *more than*, and *approximately*, references to quantities in an indefinite sense usually are not written with figures.

The project will cost the government tens of millions.

He addressed several thousand people.

She answered hundreds of questions.

but

He spent about 30 hours on his trip report and had to wait more than 15 days to be reimbursed for expenses.

2.7. Figures of 1,000 or More

Numbers with more than three digits are written with commas, except for years, radiofrequencies, military unit designators, clock time, most serial numbers, and the fractional portions of decimal numbers.

She had traveled 6,187 kilometers as of 1400 hours.

A force of 20,000 (never 20 thousand) troops was needed.

According to some sources, there were 1,076,245 US casualties in World War II.

The station operated on a frequency of 1800 kHz.

He was assigned to the 1028th Brigade.

He picked up job number 518225 10-88.

The exact weight is 3.399 243046 grams.

The next step is to multiply by 3.1416.

2.8. Millions and Billions

Numbers over 999,999 are rounded unless an exact amount must be stated. Spell out *million* or *billion* preceded by a figure rounded usually to no more than two decimal places.

The world population today is more than 6.8 billion.

The US population is about 309 million.

The number of Americans dead and wounded in World War II totaled 1,076,245.
 More than 16.35 million Americans served in World War II—more than three times the 4.74 million in World War I.
 Estimates range between \$10 million and \$20 million (not between \$10 and \$20 million) but
 The cost is estimated at \$10-20 million.

2.9. Numerical Unit Modifiers

Numerical unit modifiers are written with hyphens.

third-level decision	five-year plan ¹⁷
20-kilometer (or 20-km) march	105-millimeter (preferred 105-mm) guns
eleventh-hour decision	7-meter (never 7-m) ¹⁸ limit
10-room house	.45-caliber pistol
20th-century progress	50-billion-ruble budget (but \$50 billion program)
200-million-euro loan	2-million-barrel-per-day
(but \$200 million sale)	(or 2-million l/yd) output
3-million-man army	6-percent increase, 6- to 7-percent (or 6-to-7-percent)
a 1-cent increase	increase (but 0 percent short)
one- and two-inch applications	

2.10. Possessives

Numerical expressions in the possessive case require an apostrophe but not a hyphen.

After five years' planning, the project got under way.
 She put 18 days' work into the project.
 The new regime bought several million dollars' worth of arms (but \$20 million worth).

2.11. Ranges of Numbers

2.11a. Below the Millions

In order to prevent typographical error or misreading in ranges of numbers, use prepositions and conjunctions rather than hyphens, except for years, page or paragraph references, and values in the millions.

The march covered 10 to 15 kilometers (not 10-15 kilometers).
 The league membership is between 15,000 and 20,000 (not 15,000-20,000).
 Model numbers 847,312 through 873,214 were recalled (not 847,312-873,214).
 but
 This report covers the years 2005-09.
 For further information, see pages 12-25.

¹⁷The hyphen is retained in capitalized terms of this term.

¹⁸Abbreviations of units of measure, including abbreviations formed by a single letter (such as m for meter), are acceptable in appropriate circumstances, such as in tables or in texts making frequent references to specific quantities. One exception, however, is a hyphenated modifier with a single-letter abbreviation, such as 7-m or 20-L. Such compounds are confusing and should be avoided. Instead, spell them out (7-meter, 20-liter) or change the unit of measure (700 cm, 20,000 mL). Potentially confusing also are the abbreviations m² and m³, which, although proper metric forms, can sometimes be mistaken for footnote references. Spelling out square meter(s) or cubic meter(s) is preferred, or sq m and cu m may be used. So may m² and m³ if there is no possibility of ambiguity.

In tabular material, especially where space limitations apply, the use of hyphens in ranges of numbers is usually more appropriate.

Do not use combinations of prepositions and hyphens, such as *between 15,000-20,000 and from 847,312-873,214*, to express a complete range of values. The final example in section 2.11b below shows the only circumstance in which such a combination would be appropriate.

2.11b. In the Millions

Hyphens may be used in ranges of numbers in the millions and multimillions.

Natural gas reserves are estimated at 20-30 billion cubic feet.

Production rose to 2.0-3.5 million tons annually during the period 1971-75.

The range of estimated construction costs has increased from \$500-600 million to \$2-3 billion. (Do not repeat the dollar sign in ranges like these. Do not write \$500 to \$600 million or \$2 to \$3 billion. Although writing \$500 million to \$600 million or \$2 billion to \$3 billion is correct, such phrasing would be awkward in the sentence above.)

2.12. Numbers in Tables and Graphics and for Pages, Paragraphs, and Footnotes

Such numbers—and sometimes those that immediately follow each bullet or “tick” in a series that highlights quantities—are not subject to the general rules for numerals, nor are numeral designators for tables, graphics, volumes, chapters, and other parts of publications. However, the text portions of footnotes and, unless space constraints dictate otherwise, of tables and graphics are governed by the same rules for numerals that are applicable to the main text.

2.13. References to Numbers as Numbers

Any number referred to as a number is given as a figure unless beginning a sentence with such a reference is unavoidable.

The estimate could be off by a factor of 2 or 3.

The data are rounded to the nearest 5.

Divide by 5 to determine your share.

His lucky number is 7.

but

Seven is his lucky number.

2.14. Numbers in Nonliteral Sense

Numbers used in a metaphorical or figurative sense are spelled out without regard for the basic rules covering numbers above and below 10.

The Minister is famous for eleventh-hour decisions.

Moreover, he is often a hundred percent wrong.

Because he is a shrewd politician he remains number two in the regime instead of number twenty.

There must be a thousand others who could run the Ministry better than he.

2.15. Decimals

Numbers with a decimal point are expressed in figures. Decimal numbers of less than 1 should have a zero before the decimal point except for designations of gun bore or ammunition. Zeros are omitted at the end of a decimal number unless exact measurement is indicated.

0.25 meter (note that the unit of measure is singular)
 1.25 centimeters
 silver 0.900 fine (exact measurement)
 .22-caliber cartridge

2.16. Fractions

Fractions referring to reasonably specific quantities are written out, with a hyphen in both noun and adjective forms.

three-fourths (or three-quarters) of a kilometer¹⁴
 a two-thirds majority; a majority of two-thirds
 one-fifth of the electorate, one-tenth; one-twentieth (or a fifth, a tenth, a twentieth)
 but
 a quarter of a lifetime
 the second quarter of 2009, the last three quarters of 2009, earnings for first quarter 2010,
 first-quarter earnings

2.17. Mixed Numbers

If possible, avoid a combination of a whole number and a fraction by converting the fraction to a decimal quantity.

5.5 percent (or about 5.5 percent, if you wish to avoid a suggestion of precision)

In nonstatistical contexts, written-out phrases are preferred

two and a half (not one-half) years ago
 two-and-a-half-year trial period (better in some contexts: 30-month trial period)

In statistical texts, however, precise reporting may require mixes of whole numbers and fractions ($5\frac{1}{2}$, $4\frac{1}{4}$).

2.18. Expressions of Value

2.18a. US Money

Values expressed in US money are given in figures precoded by a dollar sign. Ordinarily, there is no need for the initials US to precede the dollar sign unless the context could allow the reader to assume that dollars other than US dollars are meant. If this is the case and the dollar amounts appear throughout the text, consider adding a footnote such as "Money values in this paper are in US dollars unless otherwise indicated." The word *dollars* is used in an indefinite expression with no figure given or if some definition of the word is needed—such as the year to which the dollar value applies. The word *cents* is used for amounts less than a dollar.

¹⁴ Fractional quantities such as this one may sound plural but they take a singular verb (three-fourths of a kilometer is too far to walk). The same is true of any quantitative expression in which the emphasis is on its meaning as a single unit of measure—for example, money (\$500 is too expensive) and time (two years is too long).

Russia spent nearly \$50 million to develop the system.
 Motorists in Amsterdam pay about US \$6.50 for a gallon of gasoline; those in Caracas,
 however, pay only 12 cents a gallon.
 Each unit now costs several hundred dollars.
 We estimate the system cost the equivalent of 50-60 billion 1987 dollars.

2.18b. Foreign Money

When values are expressed in foreign money, use figures except for indefinite amounts. Because they are unfamiliar to many readers, do not use symbols for foreign currency.

The Israeli-British talks set the unit price at 1,250 pounds sterling (3,065 Israeli pounds).
 The construction costs averaged 5 rubles per capita.
 The fare is 1 euro.
 A bottle of Japanese beer costs 230 yen in Tokyo.
 but
 Meals in London will cost a few pounds more (sterling is understood).

2.19. Percentages and Times Phrases

Numbers showing the relationship of a smaller to a larger quantity are often expressed in percentages, which are always given in figures (75 percent, 6.2 percent, 1 percent, 0.5 percent).

Numbers showing the relationship of a larger quantity to a smaller one are often accompanied by the word *times* and, unless decimals are used, are governed by the basic rules for numbers on either side of 10 (five times as large, 10 times greater, 50 times more frequently, 2.5 times more powerful, two to three times greater).

2.19a. Percentage

The word *percent* is preferred in ordinary text. The percent sign (%) is acceptable in tables and graphics. Unless space is tight, the text portions of tables and graphics should use the word and not the sign to express percentage. Figures are always used for percentage except at the beginning of a sentence that cannot be reworded.

The current five-year plan projects a 20-percent increase by 2015.
 Voter turnout dropped 5.7 percent in the second round.
 African-Americans make up 5 percent of the student body.

Be careful to distinguish between percent and percentage point.

The inflation rate, which rose only half a percentage point last year, is expected to go up a full 2 or 3 points to 12 or 13 percent in 2010.

2.19b. Times Phrases

Various ways of expressing proportion with the word *times* are shown below. Note that careful wording is needed to avoid a wrong meaning. Sometimes the message is clearer if expressed in percentage. One can also use the suffix *-fold*, although this is somewhat archaic—and awkward when decimal factors are involved. Never use meaningless expressions such as “four times smaller,” which sometimes is written by an author who means to say “one-fourth as large.”

The number of tanks increased to five times the prewar level. (This is a 400-percent, or fourfold, increase.)

The number of tanks is five times greater than before the war. (This is a 500-percent, or fivefold, increase.)

The number of tanks increased five times. (The tank count went up on five separate occasions by unspecified amounts.)

There are five times as many tanks as there were before the war. (The present number is 400 percent, or four times, greater than the prewar number; is five times the prewar number; and has undergone a fourfold increase.)

(If the suffix is attached to a whole number written solid and unhyphenated, spell the resulting word without a hyphen (fourfold, tenfold, twentyfold, hundredfold). Otherwise use a figure and a hyphen (21-fold, 5.75-fold).²⁵)

2.20. Expressions of Time

2.20a. Ages of Persons

These are expressed in figures except at the beginning of a sentence and in approximations by decades.

The general is almost 60 (or 60 years old, but not 60 years of age).

General Manley, 60 (or age 60, but not aged 60), is retiring at the end of the year.

The general must be in his sixties.

Five-year-olds who will reach their 6th birthday by 31 December are eligible.

(Change sentence to begin: All 5-year-olds.)

2.20b. Ages of Inanimate Things

These are given according to the basic rules for numbers above and below 10.

The program is two years old.

Those 30-year-old submarines are being scrapped.

2.20c. Dates²⁶

Intelligence writing follows the military style of stating a date without internal punctuation and with day, month, and year in that order.

The United States declared its independence on 4 July 1776.

Switzerland's Independence Day is celebrated on 1 August.

She graduated in June 1951 (not June, 1951).

Both (word inserted to avoid starting the sentence with a figure) 11 and 26 November were holidays in 2009.

The March-April spring vacation period empties college campuses. (Use a hyphen to separate the months.)

It snowed heavily on the night of 20-21 February. (Use a hyphen to separate the days.)

The play had a three-week run (25 April-14 May). (Use an en dash—see section 5.9—to separate these dates.)

The base rights ended on 30 April 2008.

²⁵The principal advantage of fold is that it sometimes permits a more precise translation of data reported in a foreign (particularly Slavic) language. A 5.75-fold increase, however, can just as easily be expressed as a 575-percent increase, an increase of 5.75 times the previous level, or an increase to 6.75 times the previous level.

²⁶See dates as modifiers in chapter 9.

2.20d. Years

Figures designating a continuous period of two or more years are separated by a hyphen meaning "up to and including." For two years, *and* may be used.

The presidencies of John Adams (1797-1801), William McKinley (1897-1901) and Bill Clinton (1993-2001) were the only ones to span two centuries.
She worked here during the period 1961-96.¹⁷
She worked here in 1961 and 1962.

Do not combine *from* or *between* with a hyphen instead of *to* or *and*. Such combinations (from 1951-77, between 1941-45) are almost always incorrect.

A hyphen may be used to date events that straddle consecutive years representing a continuous period, but do not use one to date related but separate events occurring in two consecutive years.

Training of crewmembers took place during the period 2008-09
during the winter of 2009-10
during the Argentine summer of 2008-09
Cimon was a US Senator (2001-09) before she became Secretary of State.
The first two submarines were launched in 1960 and 1961 (not 1960-61).

Use a slash, not a hyphen, in a combining form designating a 12-month period occurring in two calendar years, such as a fiscal year or an academic year, and state the type of year and, if necessary, the period covered.¹⁸

The farm made a profit in the 2007/08 crop year (1 July-30 June)¹⁹ but not in 2008/09.
Registrations for the academic year 2010/11 are being accepted.
The report covered actual expenditures during fiscal year 2008/09 and made some projections of FY 2009/10 spending. (The abbreviation FY may be used after the first mention of fiscal year, but do not drop the 20. In this illustration it would be equally clear in the second reference to write simply 2009/10, without the FY or the term it stands for.)

2.20e. Decades

Decades are usually expressed with the figure for the initial year followed by an *s* but not an apostrophe.

All those submarines were constructed in the 1960s (not 60s, '60s, or sixties).
Our estimates were intended to cover the early and middle 1990s. Your figures dealt with the middle and late 1980s.

2.20f. Centuries

In certain special contexts, a century may be referred to in a manner similar to that used for decades (the 1800s, the eighteen hundreds), but, in most intelligence writing, ordinal numbers (in the 19th century, 20th-century progress) would be more appropriate.

¹⁷In an expression such as "during the period 1951-77," inclusion of the words "the period" is suggested. If the subject requires repeated reference to such ranges of years, as in economic reporting, the words might be omitted after the first such use. (He composed mainly for motion pictures during the period 1961-64 and twice returned to that medium in 1967-69 and 1974-75. His film music has been compared to that composed at Warners during 1935-50, the heyday of the Viennese-dominated Hollywood school.) In a text prepared for oral presentation write "from 1951 to (or through) 1977."

¹⁸In US Government practice the fiscal year is stated not in a combining form but with the calendar year representing the larger portion of the fiscal year. US fiscal year 2009 began on 1 October 2008 and ended on 30 September 2009. (Japan's fiscal year 2009, on the other hand, began on 1 April 2009 and ended on 31 March 2010.)

¹⁹Note the use of an en dash instead of a hyphen in a timespan joining compound elements: a hyphen would be used if the period were shown as July-June.

2.20g. Clock Time

The time of day is written in the 24-hour system, without internal punctuation.

The managers met at 0845 hours.

The satellite was launched at 1800 EDT (2400 GMT).

The midday break is 1300-1430.

also acceptable

The noon meal was the heaviest of the day.

Many high school students rarely get to bed before midnight.

2.20h. Other Time Expressions

Apart from the situations covered in sections 2.20a through 2.20g, references to time follow the basic rules for numbers above and below 10.

The protest lasted for eight days.

The aircraft were airborne in 11 minutes.

The pulses were seven seconds apart.

Figures are given for three fiscal years.

Some countries structure their economic activities according to five-year plans.

He resigned after his sixth year of service.

Payment is acceptable on the 29th day after the due date.

The Communist regime accounts for just six decades in China's history of more than 40 centuries.

2.21. Units of Measure

The Intelligence Community generally uses the International System of Units (metric system) to express size, specifications, or characteristics of things. Among the acceptable nonmetric units of measure are the kiloton, the nautical mile for sea distances, pounds per square inch (psi), and the knot. Other nonmetric units of measure still in use include barrels (and barrels per day) in reporting on the petroleum industry, the US bushel in reporting on grain production and trade, cubic feet in reporting on natural gas reserves or output, and short tons (not metric tons) in reporting on nuclear weapons.

2.22. Figures With Units of Measure

Figures are used with any unit of measure (excluding units of time) unless an indefinite quantity is stated, in which case the unit is never abbreviated. As a general rule, do not abbreviate units of measure unless they occur frequently in a report. *They advanced several hundred kilometers (never several hundred km).*

1 gallon

3 miles

exceptions

fourfold

one gross

4 bushels

6 meters

92-story building

tenpenny nail

8 acres bushels

8½ by 11 inches

three-ply

two dozen

2.23. Other Number Rules

2.23a. Numbers Close Together

When a cardinal number ordinarily given as a figure precedes a numerical unit modifier that normally would use a figure, try to reword the sentence. If this is not possible, spell out one figure, preferably the smaller one.

- 15 six meter trees (or 15 trees 6 meters tall)
- twelve 250-kilogram bombs (or 12 bombs, each weighing 250 kilograms)

2.23b. Ratios, Odds, Scores, Returns

Use numbers for each of these numerical situations.

- Women were outnumbered 17 to 1.
- The doctor-to-patient ratio was 1:17.
- He had a 50-50 chance of winning.
- The New Orleans Saints won Super Bowl XLIV, 31 to 17.
- The first vote gave the Democrats 21 seats, the Socialists 9, and the Communists 5.
- The measure was approved by a 90-to-9 vote.

2.23c. Indefinite Expressions Using Figures

Illustrated in the following examples are numerical expressions that may be required in certain contexts (such as a direct quotation) but are not recommended. Alternative wording is usually available.

- 100-odd (better: more than 100) species of insects
- reserves of 50-plus (better: 50 or more) vehicles

2.23d. Scientific Notation

A scientific and technical paper may require exponential expression of quantities in the multibillions: 10^{12} watts/cm².

Factors for Converting to Metric Units of Measure

To Convert From ^a	To (Abbreviation or Symbol) ^b	Multiply by
acres	hectares ^c (ha)	0.4047
acres	square kilometers (sq km, km ²)	0.004047
acres	square meters (sq m, m ²)	4,046.8564
bushels	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.03524
degrees Fahrenheit	degrees Celsius (°C)	5/9 (after subtracting 32)
feet	centimeters (cm)	30.48
feet	meters (m)	0.3048
feet, cubic	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.02832
feet, square	square meters (sq m, m ²)	0.09290
gallons, UK (imperial)	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.004546
gallons, UK (imperial)	liters (L)	4.5461
gallons, US	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.003785
gallons, US	liters (L)	3.7854
inches	centimeters (cm)	2.54
inches	meters (m)	0.0254
inches, cubic	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.00001639
inches, square	square centimeters (sq cm, cm ²)	6.4516
inches, square	square meters (sq m, m ²)	0.0006452
miles, nautical	kilometers (km)	1.852
miles, nautical	meters (m)	1,852
miles, nautical, square	square kilometers (sq km, km ²)	3.4299
miles, statute	meters (m)	1,609.344
miles, statute	kilometers (km)	1.6093
miles, statute, square	hectares (ha)	258.9988
miles, statute, square	square kilometers (sq km, km ²)	2.5900
ounces, avoirdupois	grams (g)	28.3495
ounces, troy	grams (g)	31.1035
pints, liquid	liters (L)	0.4732
pounds, avoirdupois	kilograms (kg)	0.4536
pounds, troy	grams (g)	373.217
pounds per square inch	kilopascals (kPa)	6.8948
quarts, liquid	liters (L)	0.9464
tons, long	metric tons (t) ^d	1.0160
tons, short	metric tons (t) ^d	0.9072
yards	meter (m)	0.9144
yards, cubic	cubic meters (cu m, m ³)	0.7646
yards, square	square meters (sq m, m ²)	0.8361

^aThis table covers only a selection of the most frequently encountered nonmetric units. More comprehensive conversion tables are available elsewhere (in *The World Factbook*, for example).

^bSee footnote 13 and section 2.22 for words of caution about proper use of abbreviations of metric units. The National Bureau of Standards holds that shortened forms used to represent units of measure should be called symbols, rather than abbreviations, because no periods are used.

^cIt is best to avoid the word acreage in the metric age, but it has not really been replaced by hectareage in the American vernacular. Try area instead.

^dNot tonnes. Avoid abbreviation, however, because the t, like other one-letter abbreviations, sometimes gets lost in the shuffle. The best approach for metric tons is to establish early in the text of a paper that tons thereafter means metric tons and then just use the four-letter word. Occasionally, MMT is used to abbreviate million metric tons if frequent repetition warrants.



3. ABBREVIATIONS

3.1. General Guidance

Use abbreviations sparingly and only when their meaning is clear. When abbreviations are necessary, use standard forms such as those in the *GPO Style Manual* and *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*, or other forms that have gained acceptance. In CIA usage, periods are usually omitted in all but a few categories of abbreviations, such as academic degrees (B.A., Ph.D.), export/import terms (I.O.B., C.I.F.), and ranks or titles (Gen., Prof., Dr.). (Abbreviations for military ranks are in section 3.7.)

3.2. First Reference

An organization, group, international agreement, unit of measure, weapon system, or the like that is referred to throughout a report is abbreviated after it is spelled out at the first reference, often with its abbreviation following it in parentheses. (In long reports, as a convenience to the reader, repeat the full designation occasionally without respecifying the abbreviation, but continue thereafter to use the abbreviation as before.)

Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT)
 nautical mile (nm)
 multiple reentry vehicles (MRVs)
 airborne warning and control system (The carriers are AWACS aircraft, never AWACs, as in "one AWAC, two AWACs.")

Omit the parenthetical insertion if the first use of the abbreviation closely follows the spelled-out name or term and the connection between the two is clear. This approach is particularly applicable to long country names that, because of repeated mention, need to be abbreviated after the first reference.

The newer models, with a range of 500 nautical miles, are replacing the 400-nm versions now widely deployed.
 The United Arab Emirates is . . . the UAE is . . . a UAE delegation arrived²⁰

Sometimes it is appropriate to give an abbreviation first, with the full title or other identification in parentheses, or set off by commas, immediately afterward.

WHO (World Health Organization)
 ITAR-TASS, the Russian news agency
 Pemex (Petróleos Mexicanos)

²⁰Note that some country names, like this one, are plural in construction but take singular verbs. Some country names are compounds, but that form is ignored for both syntactic and adjectival purposes: *Trinidad and Tobago is* (adjective: *Trinidadian*); *Sao Tome and Principe is* (adjective: *Sao Tomean*).

3.3. Well-Known Abbreviations

Some abbreviations are widely recognized and need no explanation. Even these, however, should be spelled out if the context suggests a need to do so or if there is any doubt about clarity.

ABM (antiballistic missile)	LDC (less developed country)
ANC (African National Congress)	MIRV (multiple independently targetable reentry vehicle)
APEC (Asia Pacific Economic Cooperation)	NAFTA (North American Free Trade Agreement)
ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations)	NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)
AU (African Union)	NSA (National Geospatial Intelligence Agency)
AWACS (airborne warning and control system)	NGO (nongovernmental organization)
BGN (Board on Geographic Names)	NRO (National Reconnaissance Office)
BW (biological warfare)	NSA (National Security Agency)
CIA (Central Intelligence Agency)	OAS (Organization of American States)
CPU (central processing unit)	OECD (Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development)
CW (chemical warfare)	OPEC (Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries)
DHS (Department of Homeland Security)	PLO (Palestine Liberation Organization)
DIA (Defense Intelligence Agency)	R&D (research and development)
ONI (Director of National Intelligence)	S&T (science and technology)
DOD (Department of Defense)	SALT (strategic arms limitation talks)
DOE (Department of Energy)	SAM (surface-to-air missile)
DOJ (Department of Justice)	SLBM (submarine-launched ballistic missile)
EU (European Union)	SRBM (short range ballistic missile)
FBI (Federal Bureau of Investigation)	START (Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty)
FY (fiscal year)	UK (United Kingdom)
GDP (gross domestic product)	UN (United Nations)
GNP (gross national product)	US (United States)
GPS (global positioning system)	USSR (Union of Soviet Socialist Republics)
IAEA (International Atomic Energy Agency)	WHO (World Health Organization)
IC (US Intelligence Community)	WMD (weapons of mass destruction)
ICBM (intercontinental ballistic missile)	WTO (World Trade Organization)
IMF (International Monetary Fund)	
IRBM (intermediate-range ballistic missile)	
KGB (former Soviet State Security Committee)	

3.4. Foreign Terms

The name of a foreign institution is spelled out in English, if possible, but the commonly used abbreviation may be used even if it is drawn from the foreign wording.

Struggle of Filipino Democrats (LDP)

3.5. Incomplete or Possessive References

Avoid wording that would put an abbreviation immediately after an incomplete or possessive form of the name abbreviated.

the ban under the Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT), not the Non-Proliferation Treaty's (NPT's) ban
the platform of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP), or the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP)
platform, not the Liberal Democratic (LDP) platform

3.6. Plural Forms

If the logical place to spell out an abbreviation comes when the term is plural, the abbreviation must also be in the plural form, even though the singular is used thereafter.

mult *pr*s independently targetable reentry vehicles (MIRVs)

3.7. Military Ranks

These abbreviations for the most commonly used military ranks are used only when they precede proper names, preferably full names. In general usage, the ranks are spelled out in lowercase.

Adm.	admiral
Army Gen.	army general
Brig.	brigadier
Brig. Gen.	brigadier general
Capt.	captain
CWO	chief warrant officer
Col.	colonel
Cdr.	commander
Cpl.	corporal
Ens.	ensign
1st Lt.	first lieutenant
Ft. Adm.	fleet admiral
Gen.	general
Lt.	lieutenant
Lt. Col.	lieutenant colonel
Lt. Cdr.	lieutenant commander
Lt. Gen.	lieutenant general
LT (Jg)	lieutenant junior grade
Maj.	major
Maj. Gen.	major general
Mar.	marshal
Pvt.	private
Rear Adm.	rear admiral
Ret.	retired
2nd Lt.	second lieutenant
Sgt.	sergeant
Vice Adm.	vice admiral
WO	warrant officer

3.8. Unusual Forms

3.8a. MIRVs

This acronymic abbreviation is almost always plural as a noun; note the lowercase *s*. The term also has a verb form, which in turn has participial and negative forms.

If the Soviets had decided to MIRV all their ICBMs . . .
 Producing an unMIRVed version of the ICBM system . . .
 Stop deploying non-MIRVed missiles after a certain date . . .

3.8b. SALT, MBFR, INF²³

Sometimes an abbreviation not ending in *s* stands for a plural term, as in *SALT* (strategic arms limitation talks). Note that uppercase is not used in spelling out these terms. The abbreviation *SAL* (strategic arms limitation) is also used and, in context, often is clear enough to preclude any need to spell out. The negotiating rounds at Geneva in the 1970s have generally been abbreviated *SALT I* and *SALT II*. Note that it is redundant to write “*SALT* talks.” This is not the case with “*MBFR* talks,” in which the abbreviation (less familiar than *SALT* and therefore probably requiring explanation) covers only the purpose of the talks—mutual and balanced force reduction. The same logic applies to “*INF* talks”—negotiations concerning intermediate-range nuclear forces. It is customary not to use an article with these abbreviations. Although the term that *SALT* stands for is plural, the abbreviation is construed as singular (*SALT* was a high-priority issue in Brezhnev’s foreign policy).

3.9. Country Names

3.9a. US, UK

The preferred style is to use the abbreviation for our own country only in the adjective form (a US initiative, but favored by the United States). This is not a rigid rule; the abbreviation may be used in graphics or text where space constraints dictate its use. In general, neither the full name *United States of America* nor the abbreviation *USA* is used.

Our style with respect to references to the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland is flexible to the same degree that it is for the United States. *Britain* or *Great Britain* is often used as the shortened form of the country name, but the *United Kingdom* (note the lowercase *t* in *the*) is preferred. *UK* is acceptable as an adjective or, preceded by the definite article, as a noun, except in cases where “sparing use” obliges us to avoid it. *British* is also an acceptable adjective—according to some authorities, it is the preferred one.

3.9b. China

The full name of the People’s Republic of China usually is shortened to *China*, although *PRC* may be used. *Chinese* is the preferred adjective and refers only to the mainland. For what we used to call Nationalist China or the Republic of China, use only *Taiwan*, both as a noun and as an adjective. For variation *Taipei* may be used in either noun or adjective form (for example, the officials in Taipei, or the Taipei authorities), but avoid *Taiwanese* as an adjective referring to the island’s administration or its officials (and do not use the term *Taiwanese government*). The terms *Communist China* (and *Chinese Communist*) and *Nationalist China* (and *Chinese Nationalist*) or *Republic of China* should be used only in historical contexts. (See *China*, *Taiwan* in chapter 9.)

3.9c. Miscellaneous Rules

Do not abbreviate when a country is mentioned only once or twice, or when it is included in a series in which other country names are spelled out. Most countries have long official names that have been shortened to forms now preferred by the US Board on Geographic Names. Some examples are Australia (Commonwealth of Australia), Mexico (United Mexican States), and South Africa (Republic of South Africa; this full name would be preferred in some contexts to avoid confusion—for instance, a text on the situation in southern Africa as a whole).

²³All three of these terms refer to past events and should be used only in a historical context.

3.10. Titles of Persons

3.10a. Civil or Military

Most civil or military titles preceding a name are abbreviated if followed by both a given name or initial and a surname. *Senator*, *Representative*, *Commodore*, and *Commandant* are never abbreviated. *Doctor* is always abbreviated as a title.

Prof. Mary Jones, Professor Jones; Gen. J. F. Smith (note space between initials), General Smith
Representative Henry Brown, Representative Brown
Dr. Robert Young, Dr. Young

3.10b. Complimentary

Complimentary titles (Mr., Mrs., Ms., M., MM., Messrs., Mlle., Mme.) are also abbreviated at all times but are rarely necessary in intelligence writing. Except in biographic reports, the only title we should use is an official one at the first mention of a person's name. After that, refer to the person by last name or by title, treating males and females alike.

Foreign Minister Spinkovskaya is expected to take part in the conference only long enough to deliver her government's opening position statement. After her departure the principal negotiator will be Ambassador Faytinsky, a protégé of the Foreign Minister. He is, in fact, a strong candidate to succeed Spinkovskaya when she retires.

In a biographic report mentioning the spouse or other relatives of a person who is the subject of the report, a complimentary title might be needed to ensure clarity.

President Anigo's family will accompany her on the visit. Her husband, Luis, is a concert pianist. Mr. Anigo, while politically active, has never run for office.

3.11. Latin Abbreviations

Avoid Latin abbreviations (such as *op. cit.*, *et al.*, and *ibid.*) except in footnotes and bibliographies. For the most part, the abbreviations *e.g.* and *i.e.* can be replaced by *for example* or *for instance* (instead of *e.g.*) and *that is* (instead of *i.e.*)—all three phrases followed by a comma. Likewise, use *namely* or *that is* (followed by a comma) instead of *viz.* Another Latin abbreviation to be avoided is *etc.*, because it is, in general, not appropriate in formal writing. [No doubt, some reader will point out that *etc.* is used many times in this publication. The compiler apologizes for confusing anyone but notes that style guides have a somewhat different set of rules from intelligence reports.] If these abbreviations must be used, they retain the periods and are not italicized. *Nor* is *versus* italicized, either spelled out (preferred in a title or heading) or abbreviated (*vs.*).

3.12. Political Subdivisions

As a general rule, do not abbreviate the names of political subdivisions such as provinces, departments, or states (US or foreign). Abbreviation of states of the United States or provinces of Canada is acceptable to distinguish cities of the same names in different jurisdictions if the names are used repeatedly. Most of the time there is no need to use political subdivisions for well-known cities such as Toronto, Montreal, New York, and Washington (the DC is almost never necessary in intelligence contexts). Do distinguish Saint John, New Brunswick, from Saint John's, Newfoundland, if the text does not make clear which one is in question; London, Ontario, from London, England, and Vancouver, Washington, from Vancouver, British Columbia.

It is not necessary to put the name of the country after that of any well-known city (Bern, Islamabad, Cocherra, Brasilia), even if it is not the capital (Geneva, Karachi, Sydney, Rio de Janeiro). Use country names with cities not well known.

3.13. Months and Days

Do not abbreviate the names of months or days except to save space in tables or graphics.

3.14. Percent

Do not abbreviate percent except to save space in tables or graphics, where the symbol (%) may be used.

3.15. Units of Measure

Do not abbreviate a unit of measure used in a general or approximate (dataless) sense. Do not abbreviate or use symbols for one or just a few isolated units of measure²² within text even when precise quantities are given. But do abbreviate units of measure used throughout the text of a report.

This report includes for each city the temperatures (in degrees Celsius) during the trip; the hottest was Washington's (35 °C).

Ranges are given in kilometers.

The opening was several meters wide.

The system has a capacity of 3,000 Btu.

Standard Symbols for Units of Measure:

A	ampere, angstrom	kn	knot (speed)
ac	alternating current	kt	kiloton
AF	audiofrequency	kV	kilovolt
Ah	ampere-hour	kVA	kilovoltampere
A/m	ampere per meter	kW	kilowatt
AM	amplitude modulation	kWh	kilowatthour
avdp	avoidupps	L	liter
b	bit	lb	pound
b/d	barrels per day	LF	low frequency
Btu	British thermal unit	L/s	liters per second
bu	bushel	M	million (3M = 3 million)
C	Celsius (degrees)	m	meter
c	cycle (radial)	m³	cubic meters
cL	centileter	μ	micro (prefix, one-millionth)
cm	centimeter	μF	microfarad
c/m'	cycles per minute	mA	milliampere
cu	cubic	mbar	millibar
cwt	hundredweight	mb/d	million barrels per day
da	deka	Mc	megacycle

²²Note that these abbreviations (symbols) do not have plural forms. Be particularly alert to the fact that the lowercase and uppercase forms of the same letter have different meanings in metric abbreviations (K, Kelvin; A, kilo; M, mega; m, meter). Be aware also that a capital L now is specified as the abbreviation for liter.

dag	dekagram	mc	millicycle
dal	dekaliter	mg	milligram
dam	dekameter	MHz	megahertz
dB	decibel	mHz	millihertz
dBu	decibel watt	min	minute
dBsm	decibels relative to 1 square meter	MJ	megajoule
dc	direct current	mL	milliliter
dg	decigram	mm	millimeter
dL	deoliter	Mt	million metric tons
dm	decimeter	mph	miles per hour
dwt	deadweight ton	Mt	megaton
EHF	extremely high frequency	mV	millivolt
emu	electromagnetic unit	MW	megawatt
F	Fahrenheit (degree), °F and	mW	milliwatt
FM	frequency modulation	n	nano (prefix, one billionth)
ft	foot	nA	nanampere
G	giga (prefix, 1 billion)	nm	nautical mile
g	gram, acceleration of gravity	ns	nanosecond
gal/min	gallons per minute	oz	ounce (avoirdupois)
gal/s	gallons per second	p	pico (prefix, one-trillionth)
GHz	gigahertz (gigacycles per second)	pA	picampere
h	hour	pH	hydrogen-ion concentration
ha	hectare	ps	picoseconds
HF	high frequency	psi	pounds per square inch
hg	hectogram	pt	pint
hL	hectoliter	pW	picowatt
hm	hectometer	qt	quart
hp	horsepower	quad	quadrillion
hph	horsepower-hour	rad	radian
Hz	hertz (cycles per second)	rms	root mean square
in	inch	rpm	revolutions per minute
J	joule	rps	revolutions per second
J/K	joule per kelvin	s	second
K	kelvin (degree not used)	T	tera (prefix, 1 trillion)
k	kilo, thousand (7K = 7,000)	ton	US ton (not abbreviated)
KB	kilobyte	UHF	ultrahigh frequency
kc	kilocycle	V	volt
kg	kilogram	VA	voltampere
kHz	kiloherz (kilocycles per second)	VHF	very high frequency
kL	kilo, liter	V/m	volt per meter
km	kilometer	W	watt
km²	square kilometers	Wh	watthour
km/h	kilometer per hour		

3.16. Ambiguous Abbreviations

Do not use without explanation (if possible, avoid altogether) an abbreviation that can be construed in different ways. *NA*, for example, has been used in tables to mean *not available* as well as *not applicable*. Current practice is to use *NA* only to mean *not available*. The absence of an entry is assumed to mean *not applicable*.

Another ambiguous abbreviation is *MT*, which for some writers stands for *metric tons* (the proper abbreviation for which is *t*), but which others have used to mean *megatons* (correctly abbreviated *Mt*).

Still another source of confusion is the improper *kts* for *knots* (which, if abbreviated at all, should be shortened to *kn*). The *kts* is easily mistaken for *kilotons* (correctly abbreviated *kt*).

Finally, the abbreviation *C³*, *C₃*, *Cg*, or any of its confusing forms is discouraged—it is supposed to mean *command, control, and communications* but, in careless use, often does not. The preferred form requires a larger-than-normal superior number—*C³*—to distinguish it from the smaller variety used for, say, footnote references.



4. ITALICS

4.1. Prominence or Emphasis

The primary purpose of italic type is to give prominence or emphasis to particular words and phrases; italics should be used sparingly so as not to defeat this purpose.

All members of the working group except the representative of the Central Intelligence Agency believed that the Ruritarians would choose a *phased* development over the next five years. CIA held to its position that they would try to complete the project by the end of 2012.

4.2. Titles

Use italic type for titles of books, periodicals, or works of art (including the performing arts—plays, compositions, broadcasts, films, etc.).

Philip Caputo's <i>A Rumor of War</i>	a subscription to <i>The New Yorker</i>
Michael Jackson's <i>Thriller</i>	a showing of da Vinci's <i>Mona Lisa</i>
concert opening with <i>An American in Paris</i>	appearing on <i>American Idol</i>
the television medical drama <i>House</i>	<i>Slumdog Millionaire</i> won the Best Picture Oscar in 2009.

Use quotation marks for titles of articles or other parts within longer works (see section 5.15B2).

"The Style Invitational" in *The Washington Post*

4.3. Foreign Words

The need for italicizing or translating foreign words in intelligence reports depends on whether the word or phrase has been naturalized into English, has not been anglicized but is reasonably familiar to American readers, is the title of a publication or work of art, is the name of an organization, or is otherwise governed by some special consideration.

4.3a. Familiar or Anglicized Foreign Words

Do not italicize foreign words and phrases that have been naturalized into English. Italicize but do not translate foreign words and expressions that have not been anglicized but are familiar to American readers or are easily understood by virtue of their similarity to English (an English equivalent is preferred unless the foreign expression has a special meaning).²³

He served as *aide-de-camp* to the general.

His experience as *chef de cabinet* was a factor in his nomination.

The speaker was shouted down by crowds chanting, "*Democracia, democracia!*"

²³See section 6.13 for guidance on the use of diacritical marks in foreign words and phrases.

4.3b. Other Foreign Words

When a non-English word not covered by section 4.3a is used in ordinary text, italicize it and follow it with a translation in parentheses. This need not be a literal translation; if a freer interpretation or explanation, even an extensive one, would be more helpful to the reader, the translation is not italicized unless it constitutes a title of a publication or work of art.

The achievement of enosis (union)²⁴ with Greece is the all-consuming goal of one segment of the Cypriot population.

Brandt's Ostpolitik (his policy of seeking harmony with the communist world)²⁴ was a hallmark of his chancellorship.

Austria's memories of the Anschluss (annexation by Nazi Germany) in 1938 remain a factor in contemporary politics.

He earned the coveted agregation (secondary-level teaching credential) the following year.

Marcel Proust's *À la recherche du temps perdu* (In Search of Lost Time) is required reading for Dr. Reboussin's course in French literature.

4.3c. Titles of Publications

As stated in section 4.2, any book or periodical title is italicized. A title in a foreign language may or may not be translated, depending on the title and the context. If a translation is given, it should be in parentheses and in italics (see the final example in section 4.3b above and note that the capitalization style of the original title follows that of the French-language press, whereas the translation follows English-language style).

No translation is needed for such familiar titles as *Pravda*, *Truth*, *Der Spiegel*, *Le Monde*, *Izvestiya*, *L'Observatore Romano*, *Paris Match*, and *Kommunist*. Some titles—*People's Daily*, for example—have conventionally been cited only in translated form. For this title sometimes and for other titles almost always, an explanation is more relevant and useful than a translation.

People's Daily, official organ of the Chinese Communist Party

Other titles can go either way. For example, *Krasnaya zvezda* (Red Star) (note that *zvezda* is not capitalized), the newspaper of the Russian armed forces, is sometimes cited in Russian followed by a translation, but just as often the title is given only in translated form. Either way is acceptable as long as that way is used consistently in the issuance in which the publication is cited.

4.3d. Names of Organizations

Whenever possible, use the English translation, rather than the original language, in referring to the name of a foreign organization, government body, political party, educational institution, corporation, or the like. Often, however, there are compelling reasons—including convention, wide recognition, and untranslatability—for giving such a name in the original language. In such cases, do not italicize the name. If a translation is possible, relevant, or unobvious, supply one in parentheses following the foreign-language name. If appropriate, give instead or in addition an explanation of the name or description of the organization.

the joint Bulgarian-Hungarian building enterprise, Intransmex

the Cuban news agency, Prensa Latina

the Portuguese labor organization Intersyndica

the Buddhist organization Soka Gakkai and its political arm, Komeito

chairwoman of Yayasan Harapan Kita (Our Hope Foundation)

²⁴A translation or enosis or explanation of Ostpolitik would not be necessary in every instance.

the Wissenschaftsrat (Science Council)
 debated in the Bundestag (or the Bundesrat)
 the defunct *an-Nahda* (Renaissance) Party
 the Parti Québécois
 graduate of the Sorbonne
 veteran of the Surcouf
 visited the al-Aqsa Mosque in Jerusalem
 vote of confidence in the Knesset (parliament)

4.4. Names of Craft

Do not italicize (or enclose in quotation marks) names of ships,²⁰ aircraft, or spacecraft.

seizure of the *Pueblo*
 launched *Soyuz-3*
 a Yankee-class submarine
 the *Concorde's* noise level

4.5. Cited Letters, Words, and Phrases

This style guide provides numerous illustrations of another use of italic type: the citing of a letter, word, or phrase.

words ending in *s*
 nonabbreviation of percent

²⁰Do not use feminine pronouns to refer to ships or other craft.



5. PUNCTUATION

5.1. General Principles

Most readers of this style guide already know that punctuation is based on meaning, grammar, syntax, and custom and is used to make writing clear. Even so, there are likely to be selected instances when a writer needs guidance. Such guidance is provided in this chapter. The trend should always be toward reducing the amount of punctuation, but be careful to use phrasing that avoids ambiguity and ensures exact interpretation. The sole aim of the choice and placing of punctuation marks should be to bring out the author's thought more clearly. Omit punctuation marks if they do not aid in reading and prevent misreading.

If you would like more information than is given below, consult the *GINO Style Manual*, the *Gregg Reference Manual*, or *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary* for explanation and illustration of punctuation rules that are applicable to intelligence reports.

5.2. Apostrophe

The primary functions of the apostrophe are to show possessive case and, in some cases, to create plural forms. (It is also used to indicate contractions in words such as *can't* and *it's*, but these are not appropriate in written English.)

5.2a. Possessives

The possessive case of most nouns and indefinite pronouns is indicated by some combination of the apostrophe and the letter *s*.

5.2a1. Words That End in an *s* Sound

If the singular of a word (or acronym or abbreviation) ends in an *s* sound, add an apostrophe and an *s* unless the added sibilant is not present in the word's normal pronunciation; in such cases, add only the apostrophe.

the corps' units	Pare's history ²⁶
Dickens's novels	PBS's programs
Juarez's troops	the Philippines' outer islands
Nantes' port	the United Arab Emirates' oil
the Netherlands' canals	

²⁶To avoid a triple sibilant, exceptions are sometimes made for significant names that already end in a double sibilant; for example, convention favors *Jesus's* and *Moses's*. Another exception is *Achilles' heel*.

If the plural of a word ends in *s*, add only the apostrophe.

the boys' team	the two leaders' rift
The Joneses' address	the Russians' policy ²⁷

5.2a2. Words That Do Not End in an *s* Sound

If a word (either singular or plural) does not end in an *s* sound, add an apostrophe and an *s*.

the child's shoes	the children's shoes
each other's home	the officer's report
that Thai's ²⁸ passport	those Thai's ²⁸ passports
the woman's book	the women's books

5.2a3. Compounds

In compounds, make only the last word possessive.²⁹

commander in chief's decision	secretary general's speech
someone else's hat	Shah of Iran's overthrow

5.2a4. Combinations Indicating Joint Possession

In a combination of two or more nouns for which joint possession is to be indicated, make only the last noun possessive; if individual possession, make both or all nouns possessive.

President Obama and Chancellor Merkel's meeting to discuss Afghanistan and international climate change occurred on 3 November 2009.
 Rodgers and Hammerstein's only collaboration specifically for a film was on *State Fair*.
 Clint Eastwood's, Hilary Swank's, and Morgan Freeman's Oscars were all for *Million Dollar Baby*.

5.2a5. Geographic, Firm, or Organization Names or Publication Titles

In geographic names, firm names, the names of organizations and institutions, and the titles of publications, follow the generally accepted form.

Consumers Digest	Johns Hopkins University	People's Republic
Court of St. James's	Lloyds (bank)	Reader's Digest
Harpers Ferry	Lloyd's (insurance)	Reuters (news agency)

5.2a6. Organized Bodies That End in *s*

Do not use an apostrophe after names of states or countries and other organized bodies ending in *s*, or after words more descriptive than possessive, except when the plural does not end in *s*.

Kansas law	Weight Watchers meeting	National Organization of
League of Nations mandate	officers club	Women's headquarters
master's degree	leathers; college	writers guide

²⁷Use of the possessive in a phrase like this is an easy fix for one of the most frequent writing errors, the antecedentless pronoun, as in "the Russian policy toward their minorities." Change the adjective *Russian* to the possessive noun *Russians'* to give them an antecedent. The reference word (usually an antecedent) for a pronoun must be a noun or another pronoun, never an adjective, like *Russian* in the sample phrase. An early CFA style guide writer called the antecedentless pronoun a *moose track*, as in "There were moose tracks in the snow but none of them could be seen"—the pronoun *them* does not have a proper antecedent in the noun-turned-adjective *moose*.

²⁸Note that *Thai* is both singular and plural.

²⁹If the compound is plural (see section 6.5a), use the *of* possessive (section 5.2b) unless the plural is formed in the final word of the compound: decisions of the attorneys general, but the general on/units' decisions.

5.2a7 Personal Pronouns

Do not use the apostrophe with the possessive form of personal pronouns.

his	ours	yours
hers	theirs	its (Do not confuse with the contraction it's [it is].)

5.2b. Possessives With Persons or Inanimate Bodies

As a general rule, the possessive form made up of an apostrophe and an *s* (the Minister's) is used for nouns denoting persons, and the form combining the preposition *of* and a noun object is applied to organizations or inanimate things (a decision of the Ministry). However, the *s* possessive is commonly used for the inanimate in expressions that indicate time (tournament's notice, year's labor, two hours' work, a day's pay) and in other familiar phrases (heaven's sake, heart's content, for pity's sake, for old times' sake).

Which possessive form to use often depends on sound or rhythm: the *s* possessive is more terse than the longer, more sonorous *of* phrase (morning's beauty, beauty of the morning). In some *of* phrases, idiom calls for a sort of possessive redundancy—always for a pronoun (friend of his), usually but not necessarily for a proper noun (friend of John's; friend of John Jones), and optionally for a common noun (friend of the author, friend of the author's).

5.2c. Noun or Pronoun Preceding a Gerund

The possessive case is used for a noun or pronoun preceding a gerund if this syntax is unavoidable (try to rephrase).

London announced it had no objection to Rome's taking part. (Better: London announced it would not object if Rome took part.)

Economy was one reason for George's buying a small car. (Better: Economy was one reason George bought a small car.)

5.2d. Plurals

The apostrophe is inserted before a lowercase *s* to form the plurals of single letters and digits and of abbreviations ending with a period. (Note: an abbreviation of a unit of measure has neither a period nor a plural form [1 km, 2 km].) It is not inserted before the *s* in the plurals of groups of letters or hyphenated letter-number combinations unless needed to enhance comprehension—for example, if the combination ends with a lowercase letter (SS-N-3a's). It is omitted in the plurals of groups of digits designating decades or centuries.

Buick 747s	dotted I's
Pershing 1s's (but Pershing 1ls)	11s and 12s
H-1s and H-1ls (but type 1's)	Kresta-4ls (but Flogget B's)
MiGs	RVs
Ph.D.'s, B.A.'s, M.A.'s ³⁰	7's and 8's (but SS-7s and SS-8s)
the 1980s	SS-N-4s (but Mod 2's, all Mods of the SS-11)

³⁰Academic degrees are in lowercase when spelled out: doctor of philosophy, doctorate, master of arts, bachelor's degree.

To form the plurals of spelled-out numbers, of most words referred to as words, and of words already containing an apostrophe, add just *s* or *es*. But, add *'s* to indicate the plural of words referred to as words if the omission of an apostrophe would cause difficulty in reading.

One of Theodore M. Bernstein's best style books is *Dos, Don'ts & Maybes of English Usage*, but it fails to point out that most incorrect *due to's* can be remedied by changing them to *because of's*. (Note that the *'s* is not italicized when attached to form the plural forms of the italicized *due to* and *because of* in this example.)

5.3. Brackets

5.3a. Inside Parentheses

Brackets are used to enclose a parenthetical word or expression within a set of parentheses.

He was well educated (by tutors in Portland [Vaine]).

5.3b. Editorial Remarks

Brackets are used to set off such remarks within quoted material.

The Minister said, "The election [of 3 March] will be reexamined."

5.4. Bullets (Ticks)

Bullets—usually solid circular symbols—are used to introduce a list of two or more items set off within a column of text. They may be used instead of or in combination with *em dashes* (sometimes called *ticks*), as in a series of indented, itemized blocks of text in which some blocks are subsets of more important ones. Never use a single bullet or tick simply for emphasis; rather, use boldface or italic type.

Capitalize the first letter of all material introduced by a bullet or an *em dash* and end each phrase with a period (or a question mark, if appropriate). Introduce the material with a colon at the end of the introductory sentence or phrase.

The following are examples of bullets used with *em dashes*:

- This would be a primary bullet phrase (or clause).
- This would be another primary bullet phrase.
 - This would be a secondary phrase subordinate to the bullet phrase above.
 - This would be another secondary phrase.
- This would be the next primary phrase.
 - Phrases pertinent to this phrase would be listed under it like this.
 - And this.
- This would be the last primary bullet phrase.

5.5. Colon

5.5a. Summaries or Expansions

Use a colon before a final clause or phrase that summarizes or expands preceding matter. A single space is used after a colon.

Food, clothing, fuel, and building materials: these are the critical items.
 The delegation visited four European cities: London, Paris, Dublin, and Rome.
 Jones served in three Ministries: Economy; Communications, Power, and Industry;
 and Agriculture.

5.5b. Separation of Clauses

A colon is used to separate two main clauses if the second amplifies or explains the first. Otherwise, use a semicolon (see section 5.16b).

Railroading is not a variety of outdoor sport: it is a service.
 He is well qualified to serve as Foreign Minister: he has held posts in the Ministry since 1995 and has served abroad many times.

5.5c. Titles and Subtitles

Use a colon to separate subtitles from titles.

The Tragic Dynasty: A History of the Romanovs
Editorial Consistency: An Agency Goal

5.5d. Ratios

Figures (not spelled-out words) are always used for ratios, but use hyphens if the ratio is used adjectively.

20:1, but a 20-to-1 chance

5.5e. Indented Material

Use a colon to introduce lengthy material set off from the rest of the text by indentation. If the material is a quotation, do not use quotation marks.

5.6. Comma

The comma is the punctuation mark that is both most often used and most often misused. There is a general tendency to use too many commas, but the sin of omission is almost as common as the sin of commission.³¹

5.6a. For Comprehension

Use a comma to separate two words or figures that might otherwise be misunderstood.

Of the total, production was the greatest single item.
 To his younger brother, Murray was a paragon whose every action was to be imitated.
 Instead of thousands, hundreds were built.
 In 2009, 523 units were completed, (but in 2009 about 500 units . . .)

³¹One "sin of commission" is the so-called comma splice, in which a comma is used instead of a semicolon or period to denote cessation rather than pause, as in "Rain is forecast, however, we intend to hold the event anyway." The real comma should be a semicolon (or a period, followed by a new sentence), or the two elements of the compound sentence can be "spliced" properly with *but*. "Rain is forecast, but we intend to hold the event anyway."

5.6b. Separation of Coordinate Modifiers

Use a comma to separate from each other the parts of a series of coordinate modifying words (the words are coordinate if you can substitute *and* for the comma).

short, swift streams long, slender, brittle stems

Do not use a comma if the modifying words are cumulative (cannot be separated by *and*), rather than coordinate—that is, if one modifies another or a unit of which another is a part.

illegal drug traffic short tributary streams

If the modifying words are neither coordinate nor cumulative, they probably constitute a unit modifier (see section 7.3).

5.6c. With Nonrestrictive Words

Use a comma to set off nonrestrictive (nonessential) words, phrases, or clauses.

The chairman, George Smith, spoke last.

The work was, in fact, completed.

The manager, who was dismissed in 2008, was reappointed in 2009.

His brother, Joseph, was appointed. (He had only one brother.)

Mitchell's novel, *Gone With the Wind*, was a bestseller. (She wrote only one novel.)

Actual production, however, was lower.

Whether the element is nonrestrictive is determined by the intent of the sentence. Note that in the following sentences each of the elements that are nonrestrictive in the sentences above is necessary to the meaning of the sentence in which it appears, is therefore restrictive, and is not set off by commas. Compare these examples with the ones above.

Cochairman Smith spoke last (not Cochairman Jones).

The idea must work in fact as well as in theory.

The manager who was dismissed in 2008 was rehired in 2009. (The *who* clause identifies the particular manager being discussed.)

His brother Joseph was appointed. (He had more than one brother.)

James Michener's novel *Fates of the South Pacific* won the Pulitzer Prize for fiction. (He wrote many other novels, but none of them won Pulitzers.)

However hard they tried, production stayed low for several years.

5.6d. With Contrasting Statements

Use a comma to set off contrasting statements in a sentence.

Obama, not Bush, made the decision.

5.6e. Serial Comma

Use a comma after each element except the last in a series of three or more words, phrases, clauses, letters, or figures used with *and* or *or* (as long as none of the elements in the series is a phrase or clause with internal commas). Opinion is divided about whether to use the serial comma, as the comma after the next to last element in a series is called: many publications, especially newspapers, generally omit it so as to save space but sometimes insert it to avoid ambiguity. The question does not arise if the serial comma is always used. Most authorities on English usage recommend that policy, and it is the rule for CIA publications.

Copper, lead, zinc, and tin were mined.
 The contestants may dance, play an instrument, or sing.
 The data were collected, estimates were made, and conclusions were drawn.
 Complete forms A, B, and C by writing 1, 2, or 3.

If one or more of the elements in the series is a phrase or clause with internal commas, use semicolons instead of commas between the elements, rearranging the sentence if necessary to put the series at the end. No matter how short the elements, use the serial semicolon before the end or on.

The chief exports were brass, which is an alloy; platinum, which is a precious metal; and tin.
 (never Brass, which is an alloy; platinum, which is a precious metal; and tin were the chief exports.) (See also section 5.16a.)

5.6f. Compound Sentences

Use a comma before the coordinating conjunction in a compound sentence (a sentence that contains at least two independent clauses).

He served in the Army until 1996, and then he went to work for the telephone company.
 The country imports copper, iron, and lead, but domestic tin is available.

In a simple sentence with a compound predicate do not use a comma before the coordinating conjunction unless it is needed for clarity.

He served in the Army until 1996 and then went to work in a bank.
 He went to Russia to study but decided not to stay.
 but
 He goes to sleep the minute he hits the mattress, and springs out of bed in the morning always eager to begin a new day.

5.6g. Numbers in the Thousands and Higher

Use a comma to separate digits of most numbers in the thousands and unrounded millions.

1,000	250,000
3,399,243,046	5,752,194 (if rounded, 5.75 million, 5.8 million, or 6 million)
6,201	

5.6h. Introductory Phrases

Use a comma to separate from a main clause an introductory clause or phrase that is long or that might cause confusion without a comma.

Because the corporation derived much of its 2008 income from suburban outlets, it established several new ones in 2009. (but After his defeat he retired from public life.)

Use a comma to set off a beginning participial phrase modifying the subject or an absolute phrase before the subject; and, if it contributes to easier reading, an opening adverbial phrase stating a year.

To begin with, Smith worked as an engineer.
 In 1986 the tragedy at Chernobyl occurred.
 In 1987, Gorbachev formulated his policies of glasnost and perestroika.

Note that, whereas no comma is needed after 1986 in the second example, in the next one, when the year is followed by an uppercased word, insertion of a comma aids quick comprehension; such a comma is nevertheless optional.

5.6i. Title of Person and Name of Organization

In the absence of the words *of* or *of the*, use a comma to separate a person's title and the name of an organization.

director, Coal Division, Ministry of Mines

5.6j. Omission of a Word or Words

Use a comma to indicate omission of a word or words, unless the construction is clear enough without commas.

In spring and fall there is hiking in the area; in summer, sailing; in winter, skiing. (but The data were collected, estimates made, and conclusions drawn.)

5.6k. Before Direct Quotations

Use a comma to separate an introductory phrase from a short direct quotation (for long quotations, use a colon instead).

He said, "Now or never."

5.6l. With Geographic, Personal, or Corporate Names

Use a comma to set off a province, state, or country name from a city name; *Jr.* (but not, say, *III* or *IV*) following a personal name; and sometimes (follow the subject's preference) *Inc.*, *Ltd.*, or *S.A.* after a corporate name. If the setting off occurs in midsentence, a comma must be used after as well as before.²²

He lives in Vancouver, Washington, but visited Vancouver, British Columbia, for the Winter Olympics in 2010.

John Jones, Jr., heads Dictionaries, Inc., and his son John Jones III runs the Georgetown branch (not his only son, or the name would be set off by commas—see 5.6c).

5.7. Dash (or Em Dash)

The dash (or *em dash*, not to be confused with the *en dash*—see section 5.9) should be used only when it is needed, and not when such punctuation as a comma, a colon, or parentheses would suffice. Excessive use presents a visual barrier to the reader and interrupts the flow of thought. The dash should never be used immediately after a comma, a semicolon, or, except as described in section 5.4, a colon.

5.7a. Parenthetical Matter

The dash is sometimes used to set off parenthetical matter, although a pair of dashes can often be replaced by parentheses and should be. If there would otherwise be two pairs of dashes within a sentence, if the dash is used to set off material at the end of a sentence, only one dash, at the beginning, is needed. If the material is set off within the sentence, only another dash (not a comma or a semicolon) can be used to end the setoff phrase or clause.

He was a key figure in the successes—as well as the problems, both domestic and international—of Japan's trade policies.

He has three sons—Thomas, 29, Richard, 19; and Henry, 16.

²²Failure to do this results in what usage and style authority Roy Copperud dubs a "one-legged comma." Such an omission can also occur before a setoff clause or phrase.

He goes home twice a year—at Christmastime and on his birthday—and he never stays for more than two days. (In this example, the necessary second dash supersedes the comma that would ordinarily divide the two clauses of this compound sentence.)

The report for 2009 (the calendar, not the fiscal, year) led to an angry exchange—unusual for January—in the legislature.

5.7b. Before a Final Summarizing Clause

The dash is often used interchangeably with the colon to introduce a final summarizing clause.

Freedom of speech, freedom of worship, freedom from want, freedom from fear—these are the fundamentals of moral world order.

5.7c. In Place of a Bullet

The dash is sometimes used instead of a bullet to mark the beginning of each part of a block of material (other than quotations) set off by indentation from the rest of the text. If used in this way, it may be called a *rick*. (See section 5.4.)

5.8. Ellipsis

An ellipsis (the omission of words within quoted material) is represented by three spaced periods. When in the middle of a quotation an ellipsis occurs at the end of a sentence, a fourth period (or other punctuation, if appropriate) precedes the spaced periods. When only part of a sentence is quoted, periods to show omission are required only within the quotation, not at the beginning or the end.

The President began his address with the observation that in 1776 “our fathers brought forth a new nation, conceived in liberty and . . . dedicated to the proposition” of equality for everyone. In his words, “we [cannot] consecrate . . . this ground. The brave men . . . who struggled here . . . have consecrated it. . . . The world . . . can never forget what they did here.”

5.9. En Dash

The en dash (not to be confused with the dash, or *em dash*) is, in effect, a superhyphen, used to “hyphenate” a compound modifier that includes one or more compound elements. It is effective with capitalized compounds but is less so with lowercase compounds, for which use of multiple hyphens is better, even though the lowercase compound is one not normally hyphenated. (The en dash can usually be avoided by rewording.)

Winston-Salem–Fayetteville telephone call (or call between Winston-Salem and Fayetteville)

Saudi Arabia–United Arab Emirates border (or border between Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates)

Health Department–sponsored program (or program sponsored by the Health Department)

post–World War II policies (or policies after World War II)

SS-19-type silos (or silos of the SS-19 type)

but

Echo-II class submarine (Use two hyphens, not a hyphen and an en dash, because this is a special category. See section 7.6e.)

defense industry–based engineers (not defense industry–based engineers, which is confusing) also

a vice-president-elect, but the Vice President–elect

a prime-minister-designate, but the Prime Minister–designate

5.10. Exclamation Point

Because intelligence reports are expected to be dispassionate, this punctuation mark should rarely, if ever, be used.

5.11. Hyphen

Use of the hyphen is well illustrated in the chapters on numbers, spelling, and compound words.

5.12. Parentheses

Parentheses are used as shown in 5.12a through 5.12d. (See also section 5.3 on the use of brackets in functions similar to but distinct from those served by parentheses.)

5.12a. With Comments

Use parentheses to set off a word, phrase, clause, or sentence that is inserted by way of comment or explanation within or after a sentence but that is structurally independent of it.

This style guide (unclassified) will be widely disseminated.

He graduated from Stony Brook University (part of the State University of New York system).

Three old destroyers will be scrapped. (All three have been out of commission for some time.)

Note that the placement of the period above depends on whether the parenthetical insertion is part of the sentence that introduced it or is an independent, complete sentence (see the last two examples above). In the following example, note that the comma follows the parentheses enclosing an insertion made in the middle of a series separated by commas.

He visited Portland (Maine), Philadelphia, and Baltimore.

5.12b. With Cross-References

Use parentheses to enclose cross-references.

Japan's exports have risen steadily for the past 10 years (see figure 3).

... or (annex A).

... or (see the table).

... or (See figure 3.) as a separate sentence.

5.12c. With Numbers or Letters in a Series

Use parentheses to enclose numbers or letters that set off parts of a series.

We must set forth (1) our long-term goals, (2) our immediate objectives, and (3) the means at our disposal. (Be sure to use a set of parentheses with each number, not just a single one after it.)

5.12d. With Foreign Words

Use parentheses to enclose translations or explanations—if necessary—of foreign words or to enclose the original language following the English version (see section 4.3).

He referred to the document as an estimate (*otsenka*).

Sagan's best known novel is *Aimez-vous Brahms?* (*Do You Like Brahms?*). (Italicize the translation because it is still a title.)

Pointing to the skyline as we neared the capital, he trumpeted the nation's new grandezza—even as we passed one of the *favelas* (shantytowns) outside the city.

5.13. Period

The use of the period is so elementary that it hardly needs to be discussed in this guide except to point out that it is not generally used in CIA for abbreviations and that a single space is used between sentences. The placement of the period in its principal function, to terminate a nonexclamatory or noninterrogative sentence, is discussed and illustrated in other parts of this chapter on punctuation—under “Parentheses” and “Quotation Marks,” for example. (See section 5.8, which discusses one of the period’s sidelines.)

5.14. Question Mark

As with the period, a discussion of the function of the question mark borders on stating the obvious. Note, however, that, apart from its principal function of terminating interrogative sentences, the question mark is used:

5.14a. To Show Uncertainty

A question mark may be used to show uncertainty (or ignorance), as when it is placed next to (or instead of) a figure in a tabulation. Similar application can be made within the text, but this should be kept to a minimum.

The paper was a hodgepodge, trying to deal with poets as diverse as Omar Khayyam (7-1132?) and Geoffrey Chaucer (1340?-1400).

5.14b. In a Title

A question mark may be used as part of an appropriate title.

Moscow and the Eurocommunists: Where Next?
A Credible Nuclear Deterrent?

5.15. Quotation Marks

Quotation marks may be double or single and must always be used in a pair. Single quotation marks never appear in American usage unless double marks are present.

5.15a. Double Quotation Marks

5.15a1. Direct Quotations

Use a set of double quotation marks around a short direct quotation. (If the quotation is long—say, half a dozen lines or more—set it off by indentation within the text column and omit the quotation marks.)

“The President,” he said, “will veto the bill.”

Who asked, “Why?”

Why label it a “gentlemen’s agreement”?

The citation read: “For meritorious service beyond the call of duty.”

5.15a2. Titles That Do Not Merit Italicization

Use quotation marks to set off titles of poems, songs, short stories, and other parts of a longer work (see section 4.2).

Many people consider "Billie Jean" to be the most influential song in Michael Jackson's album *Thriller*.

Who wrote the article "Thermonuclear Processes" in that issue of *Survey*?

Have you read Robert Frost's poem "Fire and Ice"?

"Punctuation" is one of the chapters in the *GPO Style Manual*.

5.15a3. Selected Words or Phrases

Use quotation marks to set off words or phrases—but usually not letters, for which *italic type* is better—used or cited in a special sense. (For this function, quotation marks are sometimes used interchangeably with *italic type*.)

Do not capitalize the *s* in *socialist* in the phrase "most British socialists join the Labor Party."

The North Korean press put the blame on "US imperialism."

If this is a "working" vacation, why are you lying there doing nothing?

Do not *italicize*, or use quotation marks for, the *Y* in "the inverted-T-shaped building."

Be careful not to overuse or misuse quotation marks. Use them to enclose words used in a special sense (such as communist jargon), but do not use them to apologize for acceptable English words or in an attempt to redeem slang. Never allow the reader to wonder why they were used. For example, the wording "the Russians took a 'pragmatic' approach" is obscure; it probably means "the Russians took what they called a pragmatic approach," but the reader may assume that the quotation marks around *pragmatic* denote some "special" meaning and may waste time looking for an explanation.

5.15b. Single Quotation Marks

A pair of single quotation marks is used to enclose a quotation within a quotation. But, if a quotation is set off by indentation, rather than by quotation marks, a quotation within it would use double, not single, quotation marks.

He said, "I used the term 'gentlemen's agreement.'"

He asked, "Why label it a 'gentlemen's agreement'?"

"Remember," she said, "what Grandfather used to advise: 'When other people run, you walk.'"

"Do you remember," she asked, "that Grandfather used to advise: 'When other people sin, you walk?'"

5.15c. Punctuation With Quotation Marks

Also illustrated in the examples already given are the positions of various punctuation marks with relation to quotation marks.²⁷

- Commas and periods always go inside quotation marks (single or double).
- Semicolons and colons always go outside the final quotation mark.
- Other punctuation marks are placed inside quotation marks at the end of a sentence only if they are part of the matter quoted.

²⁷An asterisk or a superior reference number or letter normally follows all punctuation marks except a dash out falls inside a closing parenthesis or bracket if it applies only to the matter within the parentheses or brackets.

5.15d. Terms Precluding Need for Quotation Marks

Quotation marks are usually not necessary to enclose expressions following terms such as *known as*, *called*, or *so-called*.

Aluminum is known as *aluminium* in Canada.

Your so-called investigating body has not done much investigating.

If this is called profit and loss, when do we start *profiting*?

They may be used even here, however, to give special emphasis to the quoted or verbatim nature of the expression given, especially if sarcasm or bad grammar is involved:

He criticized what he called the "looks funny" school of editing.

They are following the so-called "where it's at" lifestyle.

Other such terms—*entitled*, *named*, *endorsed*, and *signed* or their equivalent—clearly call for either italicizing or enclosing in quotation marks the word or words that follow them.

The card was signed "You know who."

His housemates named him "chief cook and bottle washer."

The word *radar* is an acronym derived from the term "radio detecting and ranging."

5.16. Semicolon

The semicolon can be regarded to some extent as a supercomma because it supersedes the comma in cases where a comma is not clear enough for the function intended.

5.16a. Series

Use a semicolon to separate the elements in a series that falls at the end of a sentence and cannot be separated by commas without risk of making the sentence difficult to understand. If such a series is in midsentence, reword the sentence to put the series at the end. (See section 5.6c.)

The major inputs are iron ore, which comes from Poland, nitric acid, which is imported from the Czech Republic, and nickel, which is furnished in adequate quantities by domestic producers.

The principal legacies were a niece, Jane Wilson; a longtime friend, Samuel Jones; and the city library.

5.16b. Compound Sentence

Use a semicolon to separate the clauses of a compound sentence when a coordinating conjunction is not used.

He received a degree from the University of Vermont in 1976; after he attended Dartmouth College.

A fool babbles continuously; a wise man holds his tongue.

5.16c. With Conjunctive Adverbs

Use a semicolon before an independent second clause introduced by a conjunctive adverb (accordingly, also, consequently, furthermore, hence, however, indeed, moreover, nevertheless, otherwise, so, still, then, therefore, thus, yet).

Some Americans spend millions of dollars for junk food; consequently, the national obesity rate is growing rapidly.

Smith speaks English, French, German, and Russian well; moreover, he understands Persian, Urdu, and Vietnamese.

In monsoon season you should take your umbrella with you; otherwise, you may get soaked.

5.17. Slash

The slash (also called diagonal, oblique, schll, slant, solidus, and virgule) should be used sparingly and never in place of a hyphen or dash.

5.17a. To Show a 12-Month Period Occurring in Two Calendar Years

fiscal year 1965/66
marketing year 1973/74
crop year 2005/06
academic year 2009/10

5.17b. To Represent Per in Abbreviations

km/h (kilometers per hour)
b/d (barrels per day)

5.17c. To Separate Alternatives

These designs are intended for high-heat and/or high-speed applications. (Usage guides generally discourage and/or encourage one or the other of the two words instead. In this example *and* alone would suffice.)

She sat at her computer for hours in a catatonic/frenzied trance trying to cover every possible contingency of style usage in the Agency. (And in this one, *or* could replace the slash with no confusion of meaning.)

5.17d. To Show Combination in Certain Instances

Russian support was pivotal for this Japanese/US-backed proposal. (Use of an en dash or another hyphen would be awkward.)

Insurgent forces were armed with Cuban/Russian-supplied weapons. (Use of a slash here could indicate either a combination or alternatives, the latter reflecting Moscow's practice of sometimes using surrogates to supply its clients.)

The goal of one-man/one-vote was never forgotten. They campaigned on a one-man/one-vote platform. (Keep the hyphen and slash whether a noun form or an adjective form.)

The group endorsed the Christian Democratic Union/Christian Social Union platform.



6. SPELLING

6.1. General Principles

The majority of the words given as examples in this chapter are also found in chapter 8 (Spelling and Compound Words List), where all entries are listed in alphabetical order. A writer seeking the correct spelling or hyphenation of a word or words may find it easiest to look there first.

The *GPO Style Manual* and *Webster's Third New International Dictionary*, published by the G. & C. Merriam Company—or the abridged version, *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*—are the authorities for the guidance provided in this chapter and in chapters 7 (Compound Words) and 8. Where there is a difference, the GPO version usually prevails over Merriam. For a word not given in this style guide, consult first the GPO manual and then the Merriam dictionary. For guidance on the spelling of proper names—geographic, personal, and organizational—see sections 6.11 and 6.12.

6.2. Preferred and Difficult Spellings

Words frequently misspelled and the preferred forms of words with variant spellings are included in the list in chapter 8. Many other such words are dealt with in special categories in this chapter.

6.3. British Terms

When the American and British spellings of common English words differ, the American spelling is always used, even when these common words form part of a proper name usually spelled with British English.

Industrialization (not industrialisation) Board
Labor (not Labour) Party

Minister for Defense (not Defence)
Programs (not Programmes) Chairman

6.4. Anglicized Foreign Words

Many foreign words and phrases have been thoroughly anglicized. Others are not as easily comprehended by American readers and should not be used unless there is no equivalent English expression (for example, *ad hominem*, *passim*). Still other foreign expressions should be avoided because they sound hackneyed (*apropos*, *confere*, *faux pas*, *inter alia*, *piece de resistance*, *tete-a-tete*). Foreign-derived words sufficiently common or functional to be used (without italic type) can be found in chapter 8.

6.5. Plural Forms

6.5a. O Endings

Nouns ending in *o* preceded by a vowel add *s* to form the plural; most nouns ending in *o* preceded by a consonant add *es* to form the plural. Following are selected exceptions.

commandos	magnitos	solos
dynamos	mamontos	tobaccos
egos	mestizes	Tornados (aircraft name), but tornadoses (common noun)
escudos	octavos	twos
ghettos	provisos	virtuosos
kimonos	solvos	zeros

6.5b. Compound Terms

For the plurals of compound terms, whether hyphenated or not, use the plural form of the significant word or words. If there is no significant word, the plural is formed on the last word.

adjutants general	courts-martial	inspectors general
aides-de-camp	deputy chiefs of staff	major generals
also-rans	directors general	ministers-designate
ambassadors at large	general counsels	passers-by
assistant comptrollers general	gentlemen farmers	pick-me-ups
attorneys general	go-betweens	presidents-elect
brothers-in-law	goings-on	rights-of-way
charges d'affaires	governors general	secretaries general
chiefs of staff	grants-in-aid	trade unions
commanders in chief	hangers-on	under-secretaries
consuls general	higher ups	vice chairmen

6.5c. Other Difficult Plurals

Other words with plural forms that might cause difficulty are listed in chapter 8. If you are unsure of a word's plural, look there.

6.6. Endings -yze, -ize, and -ise

A verb whose last three letters are pronounced like eyes is usually spelled in one of three ways. The letter *i* is followed by *-yze* if the verb expresses an idea of loosening or separating. The related noun ends in *-lysis*.

analyze (analysis)	paralyze (paralysis)
--------------------	----------------------

Most other words in this class end in *-ize*. Common exceptions are the following:

advertise	disguise	incise
advise	emancipate	merchandise
amaze	enterprise	revise
chastise	excise	rise
comprise	exercise	supervise
compromise	exorcise	surmise
despise	franchise	surprise
devise	improvise	televisé

6.7. Endings *-cede*, *-ceed*, and *-cede*

A verb with a final syllable that sounds like *seed* is usually spelled in one of three ways. As shown below, only one such word ends in *-cede*, only three end in *-ceed*, and the others end in *-cede*.

supersede	exceed	apocryphal
	proceed	concede
	succeed	intercede
		precede

6.8. Endings *-ible* and *-able*

If you are not sure whether a word ends in *-ible* or *-able*, look it up in chapter 8.

6.9. Doubled Consonants

There is no firm rule about whether to double a single consonant following a single vowel at the end of a word before adding a suffix beginning with a vowel. For one-syllable words the consonant is almost always doubled (rob, robbed, robber, robbing; kiss, kissed, kisses, kissing). For words of more than one syllable the consonant is usually not doubled unless the accent in the derivative falls on a syllable containing the troublesome consonant or its double (cancel, canceled, canceling, but cancellation; refer, referred, referring, but reference).

Inevitably, however, there are exceptions to both the rules stated above. The derivatives of *bus*, for example, break the rule for one-syllable words (bus, bused, buses, busing). The derivatives of *handicap* run counter to the formulation for words of more than one syllable (handicap, handicapped, handicapping). The Merriam dictionary sometimes gives first spelling preference to a doubled-consonant derivative (programmed) but also approves a single-consonant variation (programed).

Spelling preferences in this guide usually accord with the tendency in American (as opposed to British) usage to use a single consonant in most cases where there is a choice. The first order of preference is the GPO choice if there is one; otherwise, our spelling is taken from Merriam. If Merriam gives a choice, the single-consonant version is generally preferred.

6.10. Indefinite Articles

6.10a. With Consonants and Vowels

The indefinite article *a* is used before a consonant and an aspirated *h*; the article *an* is used before a silent *h* and all vowels except *u* pronounced as in *usual* and *o* pronounced as in *one*.

a historical review	a once-over	an honor
a hotel	a union	an hour
a humble man	an herb, but a herbicide	an onion

6.10b. With Initials That Begin With a Consonant Sound

When a group of initials pronounced as letters begins with *b, c, d, g, j, k, p, q, r, s, v, w, y, or z*, each having a consonant sound, use *a*.

- | | | |
|-------------------|----------------------------|----------------|
| a BGN compilation | a DVD player | a TV program |
| a CIA position | a GPO Style Manual chapter | a JPI dispatch |
| a DC tax form | a PBS special | a VCR tape |

6.10c. With Initials That Begin With a Vowel Sound

When a group of initials pronounced as letters begins with *a, e, f, h, i, l, m, n, o, r, s, or x*, each having a vowel sound, use *an*.

- | | | |
|---------------|---------------|----------------|
| an FDA recall | an ICBM site | an NBC program |
| an HHS report | an MRV system | an SLBM system |

6.10d. With Acronyms

When initials form an acronym that is pronounced as a word, the use of *a* or *an* is determined by the sound, according to the guidance given in section 6.10a.

- | | | |
|----------------|---------------|------------------|
| a HAWA missile | a NASA launch | a UN mission |
| a MIRV system | an NREM sleep | an UNCTAD report |

6.10e. With Abbreviations That Have Variable Pronunciations

If pronunciation of an abbreviation is variable or borders on slang, use the article appropriate to sounding the group of initials as letters.

- a AAA battalion, not a AAA (pronounced "triple A") battalion
 an SLBM system, not a SLBM (pronounced "slubum") system
 but
 because of entrenched Pentagon and State Department usage: a SLCM
 (pronounced "sl-kkum") system

6.10f. With Numerical Expressions

The rule on use of *a* or *an* also applies to numerical expressions and letter-number designators.

- | | | |
|-----------------|--------------------------|------------------------|
| an 11 year old | a onetime winner | an VIII classification |
| a IV-F category | an Su-20 Fitter aircraft | a MiG-21 Fishbed |

6.11. Geographic Names

CIA's authority for the spelling of geographic names is the US Board on Geographic Names (BGN). The official repository of standard spellings of all BGN-sanctioned foreign place names is the GEOnet Names Server of the National Geospatial Intelligence Agency (NGA), which can be found online []

Refer also to maps or other references issued by []
 [] for consult a regional specialist [] Such consultation is automatic
 when a cartographer is preparing a map to accompany the paper in which the place names appear.
 Be sure that the spellings of place names in the text of the paper agree with those on the map. If
 the approved spelling is markedly different from a more familiar and recognizable spelling, the

more familiar spelling should be inserted in parentheses after the place name on the map. In the text, however, use the more familiar spelling, with the other version following it in parentheses at the first reference. In a paper on Tunisia, for example: Gulf of Gabes (Khalij Qabis); Menzel Bourguiba (Manzil Bu Roqaybah) Shipyard.

Follow: _____ advice in the use of hyphens and apostrophes in transliterations (Anse-d'Hainault, Komsonol'sk, N'Djamena). Diacritical marks used in place names on the map, however, are usually omitted in the text. (See section 6.13.)

6.12. Names and Titles of Persons and Organizations

The DI regional leadership analysts and _____ in the Office of Policy Support are the points of contact at CIA for the spelling of foreign personal names. CIA normally follows the Intelligence Community transliteration standards developed under the DNI Foreign Language Program Office. Current standards for personal names exist for Arabic, Hindi/Urdu, Iranian Farsi and Afghan Dari, Korean, and Russian, with an additional set available for Cyrillic Slavic languages (Belarusian, Bulgarian, Macedonian, Serbian Cyrillic, and Ukrainian). Other standards are currently in development.

At times, a prominent foreigner expressly indicates a preference for, or the media or official documents regularly use, a spelling of his or her name that differs from the IC transliteration standard. In such cases, CIA uses the alternative spelling—for example, former President Mohamed Hosni Mubarak of Egypt. For assistance in the spelling of names and titles of foreigners, consult either: _____ in the Office of Policy Support or the appropriate regional leadership analyst, or, if the person in question is a government leader, refer to *Chiefs of State and Cabinet Members of Foreign Governments*, available online at _____.

6.13. Diacritical Marks

Diacritics are used on maps and in *The World Factbook* but not in other intelligence writing.

6.14. Transliteration Guidance

Under the guidance of the DNI Foreign Language Program Office, the Intelligence Community has approved standards for the transliteration into the Latin alphabet of personal names originally rendered in a language that uses another alphabet. The transliteration standards are an agreed-upon set of symbols to represent non-Latin alphabets. They are not meant to be a pronunciation guide, and they assume that the audience does not know the foreign language. They are designed to be easy to apply, readable, and recognizable to the educated English reader. As a result, transliterated names may contain ambiguities (for example, "Samir" may refer to two distinct Arabic names). IC guidelines require that variant transliterations for an individual already encountered be noted in parentheses or footnotes in order to ensure that vital forensic information is not lost.

For transliteration of place and personal names, consult first the authorities named in sections 6.11 and 6.12.

It is mandated that these standards be used in official intelligence reports and finished intelligence products. Other standards may be employed in other cases (for example, technical standards for transcription), although widespread use of the IC standards may help facilitate name retrieval and linkage.

When names of individuals from cultures outside the language in question are encountered (for example, "Hilary Clinton" appearing in Russian Cyrillic), use the established spelling for that person's culture rather than transliteration.

For organizational names, transliterate proper nouns according to the IC standards. Translate common nouns and other words: for example, Al-Nakhl Sugar Company, *not* Sharikat al-Nakhl lil-Sukkar or Palms Sugar Company. For well-known entities, use the established English name and spelling: for example, Arab League.

For terms that are not personal or place names, adhere to the following guidance: use the IC standard for terms not translated into English, as in *intifada*. Use the dictionary spelling for words in general use in English, as in *minaret*. If there is a good English translation of a word, use it: *pilgrimage*, *not* *hajj*, for example.

§

7. COMPOUND WORDS

7.1. General Rules

When an idea cannot be expressed in a single word, we use a compound—the combination of two or more words—to express the thought. A compound can be created by writing the words in unconnected sequence, by hyphenating them, or by connecting them to form a solid, single word. This chapter summarizes various rules governing the formation of compounds. Chapter 8 lists thousands of compounds, so look there if you need to find the preferred spelling of a particular one.

7.1a. Separate Words

One may write two words in sequence, without connecting them with a hyphen or merging them into a single word, if this formulation causes no ambiguity in sense or difficulty of comprehension.

blood pressure	living costs	real estate
eye opener	music teacher	word combination

7.1b. Joined or Hyphenated

Often, words have to be joined into a solid form or connected with a hyphen to express an idea that would not be as clear if they were not so compounded.

18-year-olds	bookkeeping	need-to-know	right-of-way
afterglow	cross-reference	newsprint	whitewash

Derivatives of a compound usually retain the hyphenated or solid form of the original.

coldbloodedness	footnoting	praiseworthiness	stick-to-it-iveness
cost-effectiveness	ill-advisedly	railroader	X-rayed

7.2. Solid Compounds

7.2a. Combinations of Nouns

When two nouns form a compound that then has a primary accent, it is written solid (joined without a hyphen), especially when the prefixed noun consists of only one syllable or when one of the elements loses its original accent.

bathroom	bookseller	pipeline
----------	------------	----------

7.2b. Combinations of Verbs and Adverbs

A noun formed by combining a short verb and an adverb is usually written solid, but it is hyphenated when the solid form risks misinterpretation. The verb (v) forms of such combinations usually remain two words.

buildup (v build up)	giveaway (v give away)	setup (v set up)
cut-in (v cut in)	run-in (v run in)	tie-in (v tie in)

7.2c. Compounds Beginning With Certain Nouns

Compounds beginning with the following nouns are usually solid.

book (bookstore)	house (housekeeping)	shop (shopworn)
eye (eyeglasses)	school (schoolteacher)	work (workday)

7.2d. Compounds Ending With Certain Words

Compounds ending in the following words are usually solid when the prefixed word consists of one syllable, but are less often so written when the prefixed word has several syllables (spaceborne, but satellite-borne, helicopter-borne).

boat (rowboat)	man (lobsterman)	time (halftime)
book (textbook)	master (harbormaster)	ward (homeward)
borne (spaceborne)	mistress (choirmistress)	way (seaway)
bound (landbound)	owner (homeowner)	wide (worldwide)
hearted (halfhearted)	person (salesperson)	wise (engawise)
holder (shareholder)	piece (mouthpiece)	woman (chairwoman)
house (boathouse)	power (awpower)	work (artwork)
keeper (beekeeper)	proof (blastproof)	worker (pieceworker)
light (moonlight)	room (chartroom)	working (woodworking)
like (bowl-like)	shop (toolshop)	writer (speechwriter)
maker (steelmaker)	tight (airtight)	yard (shipyard)

7.2e. Any, Every, No, or Some Combined With Body, Thing, Where, or One

Write solid a combination of *any*, *every*, *no*, or *some* and *body*, *thing*, or *where*. When one is the second element, write as two words if the meaning is a particular person or thing; to avoid mispronunciation, write *no one* as two words at all times.

anybody	everything	nowhere	someone
but			

Some one choice must be made, and any one of you can make it. Will no one volunteer?

7.2f. Self or Selves

Pronouns ending in *self* and *selves* are always solid compounds.

himself	oneself	themselves
itself	ourselves	yourself

7.2g. Compass Directions

Write as one word a compass direction consisting of two points, but use a hyphen after the first point when three points are combined.

northeast

north-northeast

7.3. Unit Modifiers

A unit modifier functions as an adjective. It contains more than one word but acts on the noun it modifies as a unit. Examples are civil defense plan, wholly owned subsidiary, policymaking level, and most-favored-nation clause. Unit modifiers always precede the word they modify; if a modifier is located elsewhere in the sentence, it cannot be a unit modifier.

Unit modifier: The Secretary of State occupies a policymaking position.

Not a unit modifier: A decision is policymaking only if effective.

If the modifiers are coordinate (see section 5.6b) or cumulative—that is, if either word could serve as a single modifier—they do not constitute a unit modifier. In “migrant construction workers,” for example, the modifiers are cumulative because *migrant* or *construction* alone could modify *workers*. In “40-horsepower engine,” however, neither *40* nor *horsepower* could logically serve as a single modifier. In “carefully prepared report” only the second word could modify *report*. Both of these phrases are unit modifiers.

7.3a. Hyphenated

Unit modifiers immediately preceding the word or words modified are usually hyphenated but sometimes are written as one word.

1-meter-diameter pipe	low-price model	Six-Day War
4-percent increase	most-favored-nation clause	Third Five-Year Plan
drought-stricken area	number-one priority	UN-initiated talks
English-speaking nation	part-time job	US-owned property
high-level post	policymaking level	value-added tax
longtime friend	rightwing group	well-known name

7.3b. Unhyphenated

When the meaning is clear and readability is not aided, hyphens may be omitted from a compound that precedes the word modified, especially if the compound is an established or familiar phrase. But refrain from an accumulation of modifiers that defies comprehension and impedes readability.

atomic energy program	flight test program	human rights position
ballistic missile submarine	free enterprise system	life insurance company
civil defense plan	ground attack aircraft	natural gas exports
current account deficit	hard currency loan	surface ship deployment

but
no-hyphen rule (readability aided; no hyphen rule would be ambiguous)

areas in which ballistic missile submarines normally operate (readable); not normal ballistic missile submarine operating areas (difficult to comprehend)

ballistic missile early warning radar (established use)

7.3c. With Ordinal Numbers

In general, the omission of hyphens is not recommended in a compound containing an ordinal number used in its literal sense, no matter how familiar and frequent the expression.

first-quarter report	second-half performance
fourth-grade class	third-country involvement
but	
first aid station	Third World delegates

Similarly, in a unit modifier containing a prepositional phrase, comprehension is enhanced if hyphens are used for even the best known expressions.

balance-of-payments problem	right-to-work law
cost-of-living study	under-the-counter sales

No hyphen is required if the compound preceding the word or words modified is already tied together with a conjunction.

cold but sunny day	medium and high altitude
command and control echelons	middle or late 1970s

An improvised compound (euphemism for cliché) such as that in “hand-and-fast rule” or “bread-and-butter issue” is an exception (see section 7.6c).

7.3d. Predicates

A unit modifier must be distinguished from a compound predicate adjective, in which the hyphen is usually omitted.³⁴

His future was still <i>undetermined</i> while he was a student.
Most of the transactions in that deal were foreign financed, and the exchanges were <i>under the counter</i> .
The talks were US initiated, and the agenda well prepared.
The increase was 4 percent in 2008 and 5 percent in 2009.
The majority of the population was English speaking.
The government has been socialist leaning in recent years.

7.3e. Comparatives and Superlatives

The hyphen is usually—although not always—omitted in a two-word unit modifier in which the first word is a comparative or superlative. For clarity’s sake, however, it should be retained in certain three-word modifiers.

best liked books	less developed countries	lowest priced model
highest level meeting	lower income group	worst case scenario
but		
bestselling novel (derived from bestseller)	lighter-than-air craft	
higher-than-market price	most-favored-nation clause	
lighter-colored paper	most-sought-after tickets	

³⁴In this sense, do not confuse a unit modifier with a hyphenated compound formed by adding a prefix or suffix (see sections 7.4b to 7.4g). Such a compound (for example, self-educated or rent-free) would retain its hyphen in the predicate form. Also, note that entries in chapter 8 labeled um (Unit modifier) generally conform to section 7.3d, but entries labeled ad (adjective) do not. Was the call local or long-distance? This approach was low key.

7.3f. Adverbs Ending in -ly

Do not use a hyphen in a two-word unit modifier in which the first word is an adverb ending in *-ly*.

recently designed logo	wholly owned subsidiary
but	
lonely-hearts club	only-child complex

7.3g. Three-Word Modifiers

Do not use hyphens in a three-word unit modifier in which the first word is an adverb modifying the second word.

unusually well preserved specimen	very well defined line	
exceptions		
extremely-low-frequency communications	very-high-frequency broadcasts	very-low-frequency transmissions

If the first word of a three-word unit modifier modifies the other two, the hyphen is used between those two.

a formerly well-known person	a nearly right-angle bend	a virtually self-educated man
------------------------------	---------------------------	-------------------------------

7.3h. Foreign Phrases

Do not use a hyphen in a unit modifier consisting of a phrase of foreign origin.

bona fide transaction	ex officio member	per capita tax
carte blanche policy	per diem allowance	prima donna behavior

7.3i. Proper Nouns

Do not use a hyphen in a compound proper noun or in a capitalized coined name used as a unit modifier, in either its basic or derived form.

Cold War tensions	Latin American states
French Revolutionary period	World War II period

Do, however, use one if the proper noun is normally a combined form.

Afro-American program	French-English descent
Franco-Prussian War	Indo-Pakistani relations

This rule does not apply to numerical compounds in an expression such as *Fifth Five-Year Plan*, nor would it apply entirely in an expression incorporating an already-hyphenated coined name (*Six-Day War euphoria*).

7.3j. En Dash in Proper Noun Compounds

In a unit modifier made up of proper adjectives or proper nouns of which one or more is a compound, the en dash is used between the parts.

North American–South American sphere
Dominican Republic–Haiti border
Ulan-Ude–Chita–Ulanbaatar triangle

7.3k. Quotation Marks

Do not use a hyphen in a unit modifier enclosed in quotation marks unless it is actually a hyphenated form, and do not use quotation marks in lieu of hyphens.

- a "spare the rod" approach to parenthood
- the "one-man woman" plots of many operas
- a "damn it all" attitude toward writing style

7.3l. Chemical Terms

The hyphen is not used in a unit modifier composed of chemical terms.

- carbon monoxide poisoning

7.3m. Letter or Number Elements

Do not use a hyphen in a unit modifier containing a letter or numeral as its second element (but see section 7.6e).

- | | | |
|------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|
| annex B maps | level 4 alert | Proposition 13 backlash |
| Article III provisions | Mod 3 missile | Type 59 tank |
| grade A milk | number 2 fuel oil | |

This rule does not, however, apply to certain terms established by long usage for military aircraft and naval ships.

- | | | |
|----------|--------|--------|
| An-22 | MiG 19 | Su-7 |
| Kresta-I | Dsa-II | Yak-40 |

7.3n. Common Basic Elements

When two or more hyphenated compounds have a common basic element and this element is omitted in all but the last or first term, the hyphens are retained.

- | | |
|---|----------------------------------|
| the British- and French-produced Concorde | two- or three-year period |
| first-, second-, and third-grade students | US-owned and -operated companies |
| ground- and air-launched missiles | |
| but | |
| firsthand and secondhand (not first- and secondhand) | |
| twofold or threefold (not two or threefold) | |
| oil and gas fields, or oilfields and gasfields (not oil- and gasfields) | |
| mid- and late 1990s (but mid-to-late 1990s) ³⁵ | |
| early or mid-1990s (but early-to-mid-1990s, ³⁶ better: early-to-mid-1990s) | |

³⁵Use of the hyphenated prefix *mid-* in the examples shown is not incorrect, but the hyphen makes it awkward to combine *mid-* with the other, unhyphenated elements, *early* and *late*. For this reason it is recommended that *middle* rather than *mid-* be used when a combination is involved: *middle and late 1990s*, *early and middle 1990s*, *early or middle 1990s*, *early-to-middle 1990s*.

7.4. Prefixes and Suffixes

7.4a. Unhyphenated

Prefixes other than *ex*, *self*, *quasi*, and *vice* and suffixes other than *-free*, *-designate*, and *-elect* usually form a solid compound with a noncapitalized word.

afterhours	clockwise	multicolor	semiofficial
antedate	counterintelligence	neofascist	subcommittee
antiaircraft	fourfold	nonferrous	transship
biweekly	hydroelectric	northward	ultramodern
byproduct	life-size	partnership	unofficial

7.4b. Hyphenated*

A hyphen is used in compounds formed with the prefixes and suffixes noted as exceptions in the preceding section.

ex-serviceman	rent-free
minister-designate	self-control
President-elect Jones	vice chairmanship (but vice chairman)
quasi-academic	

7.4c. Doubled Vowels or Tripled Consonants

Except after the short prefixes *co*, *de*, *pre*, and *re*, which are generally written solid, a hyphen is used to avoid doubling a vowel when adding a prefix or tripling a consonant when adding a suffix.

anti-inflation	half-less	shell-like	
brass-smith	semi-independent	ultra-atomic	
but			
cooperation	nonnuclear	posttreatment	reestablishment
deemphasize	overreact	preelection	subbasement

7.4d. To Avoid Confusion

A hyphen is used with a prefix that normally forms solid compounds if omission of the hyphen would lead to mispronunciation or cause confusion with a word spelled identically but without a hyphen.

co-op (but cooperative)	re-cover (cover again)	re-treat (treat again)
multi-ple (several ones)	re-create (create again)	under-co
pre-position (position in advance)	re-form (form again)	un-ionized
pro-state	re-present (present again)	

*The hyphenated compounds discussed in sections 7.4b through 7.4g are not subject to the rule in section 7.3d and would retain their hyphens in the predicate form.

7.4e. Duplicated Prefixes

A hyphen is used to join duplicated prefixes.

counter-countermeasures sub-subcommittee

7.4f. Prefixes or Suffixes In Compounds With Capitalized Words

A hyphen (unless an en dash is called for) is used to join a prefix or a suffix in a compound with a capitalized word.³⁷

Africa-wide	neo-Nazi	pre-British
anti-Castro	pre-Renaissance	un-American
exceptions		
nonMIRVed	unMIRVed	
en dash called for		
Latin America-wide	pre-World War II	

7.4g. Unit Modifier Containing a Multiword Compound

A prefix (except *un*) normally forming a solid compound is often followed by a hyphen when joined with a two-word or hyphenated compound to form a unit modifier.

anti-guided-missile	non-nuclear-powered	pre-martial-law
non-missile-equipped	post-target-tracking	semi-land-mobile
but		
antiballistic missile	uncalled-for	unself-conscious

For many of the terms used above to illustrate the rule in this section, rephrasing of the sentence might be preferable to insertion of the extra hyphen.

defense against guided missiles (instead of anti-guided-missile defense)
 aircraft not equipped with missiles (instead of non-missile-equipped aircraft)
 a system that is partially land mobile (instead of a semi-land-mobile system)

Do not insert a hyphen after a prefix joined to a solid (unhyphenated, one-word) compound.

ant gunrunning	nonoceangoing	submachinegun
non-felike	postentry	ultrarightwing

7.5. Numerical Compounds³⁸

7.5a. Spelled Out

Use a hyphen between the elements of compound numbers from 21 to 99 when they must be spelled out (bear in mind that figures, rather than spelled-out words, are generally used for numbers of two or more digits).

twenty-one	ninety-nine	one thousand one hundred forty-one
twenty-first	one hundred forty-one	

³⁷For similar reasons, retain the hyphen if *un* is part of an established formal name such as Non-Proliferation Treaty (abbreviated NPT) and Multi-Fiber Arrangement (MFA), even though the spelling differs from our normal style (nonproliferation, multiaarr).

³⁸See chapter 2.

7.5b. Adjective Compounds With Numerical First Element

10- to 20-year period (or 10-to-20-year period)	eight-time Olympic medalist
18-year-old student	medium-to-high altitude
20th-century progress	medium-to-high altitude interceptors
3-meter (never 3-m) railing	multimillion-dollar loan
5-to-4 vote	the Six-Day War
8-kilogram (or 8-kg) turkey	Third Five-Year Plan
but	
\$20 million loan	

7.5c. Fractions

Use a hyphen between the elements of a fraction whether it is a noun or an adjective.

a two-thirds majority	two-thirds of the legislature
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7.6. Other Compound Words**7.6a. Titles**

Do not use a hyphen in a compound title denoting a single civil or military office, but do use one in a double title.

ambassador at large	manager-director	secretary-treasurer
commander in chief	minister counselor	under secretary
editor in chief	secretary general	vice president
but		
under-secretaryship	vice-presidency	

7.6b. Noun Compounds Containing a Prepositional Phrase

Apart from titles, hyphens are used in some noun compounds containing a prepositional phrase.

government-in-exile	man-of-war
grant-in-aid	mother-in-law
but	
next of kin	state of the art
prisoner of war	state of war

7.6c. Improvised Compounds

bread-and-butter issue	hard-and-fast rule
classroom full of know-it-alls	need-to-know
first-come-first-served basis	technical know-how

7.6d. Verb Forms of Noun Forms Written as Two Words

turn a cold shoulder (to cold-shoulder an idea)
proof with blue pencils (to blue-pencil galley)
missile in flight test (to flight-test a missile)

7.6a. Single Capital Letter Plus a Noun or Participle

H-bomb	L-shaped room	T-shaped
H-beam	T-jetty	X-ray

Use hyphens (*not* en dashes) in the compounds designating Russian submarine classes when the compounds are used adjectively.* If the meaning is clear, refer to these submarines by the class designator alone.

Yankee-class, Delta-class, Victor-class, etc.

Echo-II-class, Charlie-I-class (two hyphens, *not* hyphen and en dash)

submarines of the Yankee class (no hyphen)

a Delta-class unit, a Delta-I-class unit

Delta and Yankee units (acceptable to omit word class)

a Victor tracking a Yankee

Four Yankees, two Delta-IIs, and a Victor have been observed in the submarine yard.

The characteristics of the Delta-I and -II were compared.

The same rules apply essentially to surface ship classes (Kumar, Osa) and non-Russian submarine classes (Han, Xia).

*In CIA publications the full designator, not just its first letter, is preferred: Delta-class (not D-class), Yankee-class (not Y-class). Note, however, that the designator is spelled with only the first letter capitalized, not in all capital letters, as seen in military usage. Designators for Russian submarines, according to CIA, are as follows: Akula, Alfa, Brevu, Charlie, Delta, Echo, Foxtrot, Golf, Hotel, India, Juliet, Kilo, Lima, Mike, November, Oscar, Papa, Romeo, Sierra, Tango, Typhoon, Uniform, Victor, Whiskey, Yankee, and Zulu. (All are phonetics except Akula and Typhoon.)



8. SPELLING AND COMPOUND WORDS LIST

Including inflections, plurals, and other word forms, there are more than 13,000 words listed in this chapter. Many are familiar and are not likely to cause a problem for any writer. Others may be unfamiliar or confusing.⁴⁰ Rules for spelling and compounding may be found in chapters 6 and 7, but if you want only to determine the correct spelling or compound form of a word or phrase, you are likely to find your answer below. Note that a word followed by (s) (antibiotic(s)) and marked as both *n* and *adj* or *u/m*, takes the *s* only in the noun form. Similarly, if a word is shown with several inflections (airmail(s), airmailed, airmailing) and is marked as both *n* and *v*, usually only the first form (airmail(s)) is the noun, although sometimes the present participle is also a noun (back(s), backed, backing) or an adjective (wind(s), wound, winding).

adj (adjective)	mas (masculine)	prep (preposition)
adv (adverb)	n (noun or modified noun)	sing (singular)
cf (combining form)	pl (plural)	syn (synonym)
comp (computer term)	pred (predicate)	um (unit modifier)
fem (feminine)	pref (prefix)	v (verb)

A

- aberration(s)**
able-bodied (um)
ABM (antiballistic missile) **system**
about-face
above-average (um)
aboveboard
abovedeck
aboveground (um)
above water (pred)
abridgment(s)
absentminded
accede(s), acceded, acceding
access code(s)
accessible
access line(s)
accommodate(s), accommodated, accommodating
accommodation(s)
accords (Anman, Camp David, Dayton, Geneva, Helsinki, Paris)
accoutrement(s)
Achilles' heel(s)
acknowledgment(s)
acoustic (adj)
acoustic(s) (n)
acquiesce(s), acquiesced, acquiescing
 (takes preposition *to*, not *to*)
across-the-board (um)
active-duty (um)
A.D. (*anno domini*, refers to years since the birth of Christ; see B.C.)
adapter(s)
addendum, addenda (pl)
additionally (adv, of addition; do not use for in addition)
add-on(s) (n)
ad hoc
adjutants general
ad lib (adv)
- ad-lib(s)** (n, adj, v), **ad-libbed, ad-libbing**
admissible
advertise(s), advertised, advertising
advertisement(s)
advice (n)
advise(s), advised, advising
adviser(s); advisor (used in the legal field and by others by preference)
advisory
agist
aesthetic(s) (n, adj)
affect(s), affected, affecting (v, influence, see effect)
affection(s) (n, fondness)
affection(s) (n, insincere attitude)
A-frame(s)
Africa-wide
Afrikaans
after (cf. all one word)
 aftereffect
 afterglow
 afterward
agenda(s)
agents-of-influence
age-old
aging
agitprop
agree(s), agreed, agreeing (with a person, to a proposal, on a plan)
agreed-to (um)
agreed-upon (um)
agribusiness
agro (cf. all one word)
 agroindustrial
aid(s) (n, assistance)
aid(s), aided, aiding (v, assist)
aide(s) (n, assistant)
aide(s)-de-camp
aide-memoire, aides-memoires (pl) (memory jog)
AIDS (acquired immunodeficiency syndrome)
aim point(s)
air and sea ports

airbag(s)
 airbase(s)
 air-based (um)
 airblast(s)
 airborne warning and control system
 (AWACS) aircraft
 air-breathing
 airburt(s)
 aircargo(es)
 air-condition(s), air-conditioned, air-conditioning
 air-conditioner(s)
 air cover(s)
 aircraft
 air crash(es)
 aircrew(s)
 air-cushion vehicle(s) (ACV(s))
 air defense(s) (n, um)
 air-dried (um)
 airdrop(s), airdropped, airdropping (n, v)
 airdroppable
 airfield(s)
 air fleet(s)
 airflow(s)
 airframe(s)
 air-handling (um)
 air intercept(s) (n, um)
 airland(s), airlanded, airlanding
 air-launched (um)
 airlift(s), airlifted, airlifting (n, v)
 airlink(s)
 airmail(s), airmailed, airmailing (n, v)
 airman, airman (pl)
 airmass(es)
 airmobile (adj)
 airpower
 but
 naval and air power
 air quality (n, um)
 air raid(s)
 air show(s)
 airspace(s)
 airspeed(s)
 airstrike(s)
 but
 naval and air strike(s)
 airstrip(s)
 airtight
 air time(s) (broadcast media)
 air vent(s)
 air war(s)
 airwave(s)
 airway(s)
 airworthy
 alias(es)
 align(s), aligned, aligning
 alignment(s)
 all-absorbing (um)
 all-around (um)
 all-clear(s) (n, um)
 all-day
 Alliance, Allied, Allies (In reference to NATO;
 otherwise lowercase)
 all-inclusive (um)
 all-knowing (um)
 allot(s), allotted, allotting
 allotment(s)
 all-out
 all ready (prepared; see *already*)
 all right
 all-round (um)
 all-source (adj)
 all-star(s)
 all time(s) (n, full time)
 alltime (adj)
 all together (collectively, in unison; see *altogether*)
 all-weather
 alongside
 a lot (never *alot*, even if you do often see that
 form elsewhere)
 alphanumeric
 already (previously; see *all ready*)
 also-ron(s)

- alter ego(s)
 alternate(s), alternated, alternating (n, v rotating, following by turns)
 alternative(s) (n, adj; pertains to a choice between possibilities)
 altogether (completely, see all together)
 a.m.
 alumna, alumnae (pl) (fem)
 alumnus, alumni (pl) (masc)
 ambassador(s) at large
 Ambassador-designate
 ambli (cf, all one word)
 ambidextrous
 American-flag (Liberian flag, Yemeni-flag) ship
 but
 in a naval context, US flagship
 amidships
 amino (as prefix, all one word)
 amino acid(s)
 among (use when the relationship of more than two things is vague or collective)
 amorphous
 analog(s) (comp)
 analogue(s) (all other meanings)
 analysis, analyses (pl)
 analytic (adj)
 analyze(s), analyzed, analyzing
 anchorperson(s)
 anemic(s)
 anesthetic(s) (n, adj)
 aneurysm(s)
 anglophone (adj)
 Anglophone(s) (n)
 annul(s), annulled, annulling
 annulment(s)
 anomalous
 antedate(s), antedated, antedating
 antenna(s)
 antennae (pl, zoology only)
 anti (pref, usually one word)
 antibircraft
 antiparthen
 antiballistic missile(s) (n, um, ABM)
 antibiotic(s) (n, adj)
 antichrist(s)
 antidefense
 antiestablishment
 antigravrunning
 antimissile
 antiradiator
 antiradiationforming (adj)
 antiship cruise missile (n)
 antitank guided missile(s) (n, ATGM)
 antitrust program
 antwar
 but
 anti-American
 anti-arms-control
 anti-cruise-missile(s) (n, um)
 anti-guided-missile (um)
 anti-imperial
 anti-inflation
 anti-inflationary
 anti-insurgent
 anti-money-laundering (um)
 anti-nuclear-weapons
 anti-Semite(s)
 anti-Semitic
 anti-Semitism
 antiship cruise-missile (um)
 anti-submarine-warfare (um)
 anti-tactical-ballistic missile(s) (n, ATBM)
 anti-tactical-ballistic-missile (um)
 antipathy, antipathies (pl)
 anybody
 anyone
 any time
 anyway (adv)
 APEC (Asia Pacific Economic Cooperation)
 apocalypse(s)
 appeal(s), appalled, appealing
 apparatus(es)
 appealing
 appendix B
 appendix(es)
 apprehensible
 April Fools' Day
 a priori
 A-priority (or priority A)
 Arab-Israeli war
 arched-roof (adj)

arch-enemy, arch-enemies (pl)
 archeology
 archival(s)
 arch-roofed (um)
 archetypal
 archetypally
 archetype(s)
 arise(s), arose, arising, arisen
 armor-heavy (um)
 arms control(s) (n)
 arms-control (um)
 arms-exporting (um)
 arm's-length (um)
 armsmaker(s)
 arms-producing (um)
 arms-supplying (um)
 arm-twisting (n)
 army-group-level (um)
 armywide
 Army-wide
 around-the-clock (um)
 artificial intelligence
 artificial language(s)
 artilleryman, artillerymen (pl)
 artwork(s)
 ascend(s), ascended, ascending
 ascendancy, ascendances (pl)
 ascendant
 ascent(s) (rise, climb; see ascent)
 ASCH (American Standard Code for Information Interchange)
 Asia Pacific Economic Cooperation
 but
 Asia-Pacific region
 assassinate(s), assassinated, assassinating
 assassination(s)
 assembly line(s)
 assemblyman, assemblymen (pl)
 assemblywoman, assemblywomen (pl)
 assent(s), assented, assenting (consent;
 see ascent)
 assistant comptroller(s) general

assure(s), assured, assuring (affirm;
 see ensure, insure)
 asylee(s) (person seeking asylum or one
 given asylum)
 ATBM(s) (anti-tactical-ballistic missile)
 at-large (um)
 atomic energy, atomic energies (pl) (n, um)
 at-sea (um)
 attache(s)
 attorney(s) general
 audible
 audiocassette(s)
 audiosurveillance(s)
 audiotape(s)
 audiovisual(s) (n, adj)
 auger(s) (n, hole-boring tool)
 augur(s), augured, auguring (v. predict from
 signs or omens)
 automaker(s)
 autoworker(s)
 auxiliary, auxiliaries (pl)
 AWACS (airborne warning and control system)
 avant-garde
 a while (n. a period of time)
 awhile (adv. for a time)
 ayatollah(s)
 ax, axes (pl)
 axle, axes (pl)

B

B.A. (bachelor of arts)
 baby boomer(s)
 bachelor's degree(s) (B.A. | s |)
 back(s), backed, backing (n, v)
 backbench(es)
 backbencher(s)
 backbite(s), backbit, backbiting
 backbiter(s)
 backbone(s)
 back burner(s)

- back-channel (um)
backdoor (um)
back(s) down, backed down, backing down
backfit(s), backfitted, backfitting (n, v)
background processing
backlash(es)
back play
backpedal(s), backpedaled, backpedaling
backroad (um)
backroom (um)
backseat(s) (n, um)
backslide(s), backslid, backsliding
backstage
backstop(s), backstopped, backstopping (n, v)
backtrack(s), backtracked, backtracking
back(s) up, backed up, backing up
backup(s) (n, um)
backup system(s)
backward (no s)
backwater(s)
backyard (um)
bagful(s)
Bahamas, The
Bahamian (n, adj)
bail(s) out, bailed out, bailing out
bailout(s) (n, um)
balance-of-payments (adj)
Balkanize(s), Balkanized, Balkanization
ball bearing(s)
ballistic missile (um, of submarines, defense, radar)
ballistic missile early warning (BMEW) radar(s)
ballistic-missile-related (um)
ballistic missile submarine(s) (SSB)
ballpark(s) (n, adj)
Baltic republics/states (not the Baltics;
citizens are referred to as Estonians, Latvians,
or Lithuanians, not Bolts)
bandwagon(s)
bandwidth(s)
banknote(s)
bankrupt(s), bankrupted, bankrupting
bar code(s)
barebones (um, nonliteral)
base camp(s)
baseline(s)
basis, bases (pl)
battalion(s)
battlefront(s)
battleground(s)
battle group(s)
battleline(s)
battle management (n, um)
battle readiness
battle-ready (um)
B.C. (before Christ, comes after the number;
see A.D.)
beam width(s)
Bear G('s) (Russian aircraft)
bedouin (sing, pl)
bed rest
bedrock (n, adj)
behind-the-scenes (adj)
belowground
below-market (um)
belt-tightening (um)
beltway bandit(s)
benchmark(s) (nonliteral)
beneficent
benefit(s), benefited, benefiting (n, v)
Benelux
Berlin Wall (the Wall)
beside (alongside)
besides (except, other than)
best seller(s)
bete noire, betes noires (pl)
better-than-even (um)
biannually (prefer semiannually, but consider
replacing with twice a year, see biennially)
bias(es), biased, biasing (n, v)
biennially (consider replacing with once every two
years; see biannually, semiannually)
big-power (adj)
big shot(s)
big-ticket (adj)

binary system(s)	blue-chip (um)
binational	blue-collar (nonliteral um)
bipolar	blue-pencil(s), blue-penciled, blue-penciling (v, um)
birder	blueprint(s)
bird's-eye (adj)	blue-ribbon (nonliteral um)
birdshot	blue-water navy, blue-water navies (pl)
birdwatch(s), birdwatched, birdwatching	boardroom(s)
birthdate	boatbuilding
birthplace(s)	boathouse(s)
birthrate(s)	boatload(s)
bistatic	boat people
bitmap(s), bitmapped, bitmapping (n, v)	boast(s)
bitmapped (um)	body bag(s)
biweekly (once every two weeks; see semiweekly)	bodyguard(s)
blacklist(s), blacklisted, blacklisting (n, v)	body politic
blackmail(s), blackmailed, blackmailing (n, v)	Boeing 747(s)
black market(s) (n)	boilerplate
black-market(s), black-marketed, black-marketing (um, v)	boldface
black-market(eering) (n)	bomb bay(s)
black-marketer(s)	bombdrop(s)
blastmark(s)	bomb load(s)
blastproof	bombmaker(s)
blind eye(s)	bombmaking
blitzkrieg(s)	bombproof
bloc(s) (group)	bombsight(s)
block(s) (form)	bombsquad(s)
blog(s) (n, slang; for weblog)	bona fide (adj)
blog(s), blogged, blogging	bona fides (n, sing. pl)
bloggar(s)	boobytrap(s), boobytrapped, boobytrapping (n, v)
blond(s) (masculine, female)	bookkeeper(s)
bloodbath(s)	bookkeeping
bloodletting(s)	bookmark(s), bookmarked, bookmarking (n, v)
bloodlust	bookseller(s)
blood pressure(s)	bookstore(s)
bloodshed	Boolean logic
bloodthirsty	boot camp(s)
blowdown(s)	booting software
blow(s) out, blew out, blowing out (v)	border guard(s) (n, um)
blowout(s) (n, adj)	borderland(s)
blue chip(s) (n)	borderline(s)

border post(s)	broadband (n, adj)
boresight(s)	broad-based
born (given birth)	broadcast(s), broadcast, broadcasting (n, adj, v)
born-again (n, adj)	broadcloth(s)
borne (carried)	broad gauge(s) (n)
bottleneck(s)	broad-gauge (adj)
bottom line(s) (n)	broadleg(s) (n, adj)
bottom-line (adj)	broadminded
bourgeois (adj)	broken-down (um)
bourgeoisie(s) (n)	brother(s)-in-law
boxcar(s)	brunet(s) (masc, 'em)
boxlike	brushpays(s)
brain child, brain children (pl)	budget-busting (um)
brain trust(s)	building block(s) (n)
brainwash(es), brainwashed, brainwashing	building-block (adj)
brand name(s) (n, um)	build(s) up, built up, building up
breach(es) (gap, see breach)	buildup(s) (n)
bread-and-butter (adj)	built-in(s) (n, adj)
breadbasket(s)	built-up (um)
break(s) down, broke down, breaking down	bulletin board(s)
breakdown(s) (n, um)	bulletproof
break(s) even, broke even, breaking even	bullheaded
break-even (um)	burdensharing
break(s) in, broke in, breaking in	bureau(s)
break-in (n)	burgeoning
break(s) out, broke out, breaking out	burka(s)
breakout (n, um)	burn bag(s)
breakpoint(s)	burnout(s) (n)
breakthrough(s)	burnup(s)
break(s) up, broke up, breaking up	bus(es), bused, busing (n, v)
breakup(s) (n, um)	busdriver(s)
breathtaking	busfare(s)
breach(es) (lower part, part of a gun barrel; see breach)	businesslike
breeding ground(s)	busline(s)
bridgebuilder(s)	busload(s)
bridgehead(s)	busting (used in terms like budget busting and trust busting; hyphenate as a um)
bridgeway(s)	buy-back (um)
bridgework(s)	buy(s) in, bought in, buying in
briefcase(s)	buy-in (n, adj)
brinkmanship	buy(s) out, bought out, buying out

buyout(s) (n, um)
 burnword(s)
 BW-agent (um)
 by [cf., usually one word]
 byelection(s)
 bylaw(s)
 bypass(es)
 byproduct(s)

C

cache(s)
 caldron(s)
 caliber(s)
 caliph(s)
 caliphate(s)
 call(s) back, called back, calling back
 callback(s) (n, um)
 call(s) in, called in, calling in
 call-in (n, um)
 call sign(s)
 call(s) up, called up, calling up (n, v)
 callous (adj), unforgiving; see *cellus*)
 callup(s) (n, um)
 callus(es) (n, thickening of the skin; see *callous*)
 camouflage(s)
 cancel(s), canceled, canceling
 cancelable
 cancellation(s)
 candor(s)
 canister(s)
 cannon (pl *cannon* or *cannons*,
 depending on usage)⁴¹
 cannot
 canoe(s), canoed, canoeing (n, v)
 canvas(es) (cloth)
 canvas-covered (um)
 canvass(es), canvassed, canvassing (solicit)
 capital(s) (city, money)
 capital-intensive (um)
 capitol(s) (building)
 caplet(s)
 carat(s) (unit of weight; see *carat*)
 carban(s)
 car-bomb(s), car-bombed, car-bombing (n, adj, v)
 carbon footprint(s)
 carbon monoxide
 carcinogen(s)
 carcinogenic
 card-carrying (um)
 carefree
 caret (insertion mark; see *carat*)
 car ferry, car ferries (pl)
 cargo(es)
 Caribbean
 carline(s)
 carload(s)
 car-mile(s)
 carpal tunnel syndrome
 carrier-based (um)
 carrierborne
 carry over, carries over, carried over,
 carrying over
 carryover(s) (n, um)
 carte blanche, cartes blanches (pl)
 cartels(s) (even with specific name)
 cartilage(s)
 car wash(es)
 case-by-case (adj)
 caseload(s)
 case officer(s)
 caseworker(s)
 cash-and-carry (adj)
 cash-flow(s) (n, &c)
 cashier's check(s)
 cash-strapped (um)
 cast(s) off, cast off, casting off
 castoff(s) (n, um)
 casual (informal; see *causal*)
 casualties (include persons injured, captured,
 or missing in action, not just those killed)

⁴¹Use *cannon* if such weapons are referred to collectively (Cannon were deployed on the surrounding hillsides) but *cannons* when the weapons are discussed individually (Wing-mounted cannons, two on each side, augment the aircraft's firepower.)

casus belli (sing. pl)	chairman, chairmen (pl)
catalog(s), cataloged, cataloging (n, v)	chairperson(s)
cataloger(s)	chairwoman, chairwomen (pl)
cat-and-mouse (um)	chancellery, chancelleries (pl)
catchall(s) (n, um)	chancellor(s)
catchphrase(s)	chancellor-candidate(s)
catch(es) up, caught up, catching up	chancery, chanceries (pl)
catch-up(s) (n, um)	changeable
catchword(s)	change(s) over, changed over, changing over
cat's-paw(s)	changeover(s) (n, um)
cattle breeder(s)	channel(s), channeled, channeling (n, v)
cattlemen, cattlemen (pl)	chaperon(s)
cattle raiser(s)	charge-coupled
cattle-raising (um)	charge(s) d'affaires
cattle ranch(es)	chartronn(s)
caudillo(s)	chassis (sing, pl)
causal (of cause; see casual)	chastise(s), chastised, chastising
cause celebre, causes celebres (pl)	chastisement(s)
causeway(s)	chateau(s)
cave(s) in, caved in, caving in	chauvinism
cave-in(s) (n, um)	checkbook(s)
CD-ROM(s) (compact disk read-only memory)	check-clearing (um)
cease(s) fire, ceased fire, ceasing fire	check(s) in, checked in, checking in
cease-fire(s) (n, um)	check-in(s) (n, um)
cell phone	checklist(s)
Celsius	check(s) out, checked out, checking out
campaigning	checkout(s) (n, um)
census taker(s)	checkpoint(s)
census-taking (um)	checksheet(s)
center(s), centered, centering (as a verb, is used with on, upon, in, or at, but not around)	check(s) up, checked up, checking up
center-left	checkup(s) (n, um)
centerline(s)	check valve(s)
centerpiece(s)	checkwriting
centerpole(s)	chef(s) de cabinet
center-right	chemical-weapons-free (um)
cent) (cf, all one word)	chemical-weapons-related (um)
centri (cf, all one word)	cherry-picker(s)
chain(s) of command	chief(s) of staff
chain-smoke(s), chain-smoked, chain-smoking	childcare
chain-smoker(s)	childlike
	chisel(s), chiseled, chiseling (n, v)

chladler(s)	close(s) out, closed out, closing out
chitchat(s)	closeout(s) (n, um)
chlorofluorocarbons	close-range (um)
chokoplat(s)	close(s) up, closed up, closing up (v)
church(es), the but the Catholic Church	closeup(s) (n, um)
churchgoer(s)	cloth-backed (um)
churchgoing	clothbound
CI (um, counterintelligence)	clothesline(s)
CIALink	clue(s), clued, cluing (n, v; meanings other than nautical; see <i>clue</i>)
c.i.f. (cost, insurance, and freight)	co (pref, usually one word)
circa	coauthor(s), coauthored, coauthoring (n, v)
circuit breaker(s)	cochair(s), cochaired, cochairing (n, v)
citable	coexist(s), coexisted, coexisting
City, the (London financial district)	cofound(s), cofounded, cofounding
city dweller(s)	cofounder(s)
citywide	cooperate(s), cooperated, cooperating
civil defense(s) (n, um)	coauthor(s)
clamor(s)	coprocessor(s)
clamp(s) down, clamped down, clamping down	coproduction(s)
clampdown(s) (n)	but
clean(s) up, cleaned up, cleaning up	co-deputy-chair(s)
cleanup(s) (n, um)	co-op(s)
clear-cut (distinct)	co-opt(s), co-opted, co-opting
clearcut(s), clearcut, clearcutting (n, v, forestry)	co-otation(s)
clearheaded	co-owner(s)
clearinghouse(s)	co-vice-chair(s)
clear(s) up, cleared up, clearing up	coarbed(s)
cleave(s), cleaved, cleaving	coal-black (um)
claw(s), clawed, clawing (n, v; nautical; see <i>clue</i>)	coalboat(s)
cliche(s)	coal car(s)
climactic (climax, highest point)	coalfield(s)
climatic (of climate, weather)	coal gas(es)
clip art	coal-laden (um)
clockwise	coal mine(s) (n)
closed-circuit (um)	coal-mining (um)
closed-door (adj)	coalpit(s)
close-hold (adj)	coal-shury (um)
close-in (um)	coast guard(s)
close-knit (um)	coastline(s)
closemouthed	coca grower(s), coca growing (n)
	coca-growing (um)
	cocaine(s)
	c.o.d. (cash on delivery)
	codename(s)

codeword(s)	common sense (n)
coffee grower(s) coffee growing (n)	commonsense (ad)
coke oven(s)	commonwealth(s)
coldblooded	communications system(s)
coldbloodedness	communiqué(s)
cold-roll(s), cold-rolled, cold-rolling	communitywide
cold shoulder(s) (n)	Community-wide (IC)
cold-shoulder(s), cold-shouldered, cold-shouldering	companywide
Cold War	compatible
collapsible	compel(s), compelled, compelling
collateral	compendium(s)
collocate(s), collocated, collocating (to set in a place or to occur in conjunction with something; see collocate)	complement(s), complemented, complementing (n, v, complete)
colloquy, colloquies (pl)	compliment(s), complimented, complimenting (n, v, praise)
colocate(s), colocated, collocating (to locate together; see collocate)	compose(s), composed, composing (to constitute or to make up; see comprise)
color(s), colored, coloring (n, v)	comprehensible
combat(s), combated, combating (n, v)	comprise(s), comprised, comprising (to contain or to consist of; see compose)
combatant(s)	compromise(s), compromised, compromising (n, v)
combat-capable (um)	computer-generated (um)
combat-ready (um)	computer literate
combat support (n, ad)	concede(s), conceded, conceding
combined-arms (adj)	concerted (mutually contrived or agreed upon)
combustible(s) (n, ad)	conclave(s) (secret meeting, not just any gathering)
comeback(s)	concomitant
comedown(s)	cone-shaped (um)
come-on(s)	confectionery, confectioneries (pl)
comeuppance(s)	confidant(s) (n, one with whom confidences are shared; see confident)
command and control	confidence- and security-building (um)
command, control, and communications (C3)	confidence-building (um)
command, control, communications, computers, and intelligence (C4)	confident (adj, self-assured; see confident)
commander(s) in chief	Congressional (non-US)
commando(s)	Congressional (US)
command post(s)	con man
commingle(s), commingled, commingling	connoisseur(s)
commiserate(s), commiserated, commiserating	consensus(es) (an opinion held collectively, not simply by a majority)
commit(s), committed, committing	consensus builder
common law(s) (n)	consensus building (n)
common-law (adj)	
commonplace	

consensus-building (um)
consortium(s)
constitution(s) (a state's)
Constitution (a country's)
consul(s) (n, foreign service officer;
 see council, counsel)
consul(s) general
consumer price index(es)
consummate
containership(s)
contemptible
continental shelf, continental shelves (pl)
contra (pref, usually one word)
 but
 contra-acting
 contra-approach
 contra-ion
contraband (no s)
control(s), controlled, controlling (n, v)
controllable
converter(s)
convertible(s) (n, adj)
conveyor(s)
coolheaded
coolly
copper mine(s) (n)
copper-plated (um)
copperplate(s)
copperworker(s)
copperworks
cornerstone(s)
corn growing (n)
corollary, corollaries (pl)
corps (sing, pl)
corral(s), corralled, corralling (n, v)
corroborate(s), corroborated, corroborating
cost-cutting (n, um)
cost-effective (adj)
cost-effectiveness (n)
cost-free (adj)
cost-of-living (um)
cost-reduction (um)
council(s) (n, deliberative assembly, its works or
 membership; see consul, counsel)
councilor(s) (council member; see counselor)
counsel(s), counseled, counseling (v, n; advice
 and the person offering it; see consul, council)
counselor(s) (adviser; see councilor)
counter (cf, usually one word)
 counterclockwise
 counterintelligence (C I)
 counterrevolutionaries
 counterstealth
 but
 counter-countermeasures
country-specific (um)
country-western
countrywide
coup(s) d'état
coupmaker(s)
course work
courthouse(s)
court-martial(s), court-marshaled,
 court-marching
court(s)-martial (n)
covername(s)
coversheet(s)
cover story, cover stories (pl)
cover(s) up, covered up, covering up
coverup(s) (n, um)
crack (cocaine)
crack(s) down, cracked down, cracking down
crackdown(s) (n, um)
crackhead(s)
cradle-to-grave (um)
crankcase(s)
crank-driven (um)
crankshaft(s)
crash-land(s), crash-landed, crash-landing
crash landing(s) (n)
credence (belief or mental acceptance)
credible (worthy of belief and judged plausible)
credibility (the quality of being believable)
credit card(s) (um)
credit-starved (um)
creditworthiness

- crownmember(s)
 crew-training (um)
 crimeware(s)
 crisis, crises (pl)
 crisscross(es), crisscrossed, crisscrossing
 (n, adj, v)
 criteria (the singular, criterion, is rarely used)
 critical thinking (adj)
 crop-dusting(s) (n)
 crop index(es)
 crop-year(s)
 cross-border (adj)
 crossbreed(s)
 cross-channel
 cross-check(s), cross-checked,
 cross-checking (n, v)
 cross-connect(s), cross-connected,
 cross-connecting (n, v)
 cross-country (adj)
 crosscurrent(s)
 crosscut(s), crosscut, crosscutting (n, adj, v)
 cross-examination(s)
 cross-examine(s), cross-examined,
 cross-examining
 crossfire(s)
 cross-functional
 crosshaul(s), crosshauled, crosshauling
 crossline(s) (n, um)
 cross-national (um)
 crossover(s) (n)
 cross-pressure(s)
 cross-purposes
 crossrange(s)
 cross-reference(s), cross-referenced, cross-
 referencing (n, v)
 crossroads
 cross section(s) (n)
 cross-section(s), cross-sectioned,
 cross-sectioning (v)
 cross-sectional
 cross-strait (adj)
 cross-target(s)
 crosstrading
 crosstrained
 crosswalk(s)
 crosswise
 cruise missile(s) (n, um)
 cruise-missile-armed (um)
 cruise-missile-related (um)
 cryptanalysis, cryptanalyses (pl)
 crypto (cf, usually one word;
 but
 crypto-Christian
 crystal-clear (um)
 crystalline
 crystallize(s), crystallized, crystallizing
 culminate(s), culminated, culminating
 (takes the preposition in)
 Cultural Revolution
 cum laude
 cure-all(s) (n)
 current account(s) (n, um)
 current-generation (um)
 curriculum(s)
 cursor(s)
 custom-built (um)
 custom-made (um)
 culaway(s)
 culback(s) (n)
 cut(s) in, cut in, cutting in
 cul-in(s) (n)
 cut(s) off, cut off, cutting off
 cutoff(s) (r, um)
 culouts (n)
 cutover (um, of timberland)
 culrate (adj)
 cutting-edge (um)
 cutthroat(s) (n, adj)
 cyber (cf, usually one word)
 cybercrime
 cyberjack(s), cyberjacked, cyberjacking
 cyberspace
 czar(s)
 czarist(s)

D

- dairy farm(s)
 dairyman, dairymen (pl)
 damask(s)
 dark horse(s) (n)
 darkhorse (um, nonliteral)
 data (the singular, *datum*, is rarely if ever used)
 database(s)
 data link(s)
 data print(s)
 data-processing (um)
 data transfer rate(s)
 dateline(s)
 data stamp(s) (n)
 date-stamp(s), date-stamped, date-stamping
 daughter(s)-in-law
 daylong
 day school(s)
 day shift(s)
 daytime(s)
 day-to-day
 dayworker(s)
 D-day
 D-day plus 4
 de (pref, all one word)
 deemphasize(s), deemphasized, deemphasizing
 deemphasis
 deenergize(s), deenergized, deenergizing
 deescalate(s), deescalated, deescalating
 deice(s), deiced, deicing
 deeddrop(s) (nonliteral)
 dead end(s)
 dead heel(s)
 dead-in-the-water (um)
 deadline(s)
 deadload(s)
 deadlock(s)
 dampen(s)
 deadweight(s) (n, um)
 deadwood
 dealmaker(s)
 dealmaking
 deathbed(s)
 deathblow(s)
 deathlike
 death rate(s)
 death squad(s)
 debris
 debt-rescheduling (um)
 debt service(s)
 decade/long, decades-long (pl)
 decadent
 decade-old
 decisionmaker(s)
 decisionmaking
 but
 economic decision making (it is the decisions that
 are economic, not the making, hence *decision* and
 making are separated)
 deckhand(s)
 deductible(s) (n, adj)
 deep cover
 deep-ocean (adj)
 deep-sea (adj)
 deep-seated (um)
 deep-space (adj)
 deep underground
 deepwater (um)
 de facto
 defense(s)
 defense attache(s)
 defense-industrial (um)
 defensible
 defuse(s), defused, defusing (to remove a fuse; to
 deintensify; see *diffuse*)
 degrees Celsius (or Fahrenheit)
 déjà vu
 de jure
 demagogue(s)
 demarcation(s)
 demarche(s)
 denouement(s)

deorbit(s), deorbited, deorbiting (n, v)	director(s) general
dependent(s) (n, adj)	disastrous
deploy(s), deployed, deploying	discernible
deprecate(s), deprecated, depreciating (express disapproval of something)	discreet (cautious, prudent)
depreciate(s), depreciated, depreciating (besides its applications to prices and values, means to belittle something)	discrete (separate, distinct)
depth charge(s)	discussible
deputy chief(s) of staff	disequilibrium(s)
Deputy Permanent Representative to the UN	disinformation (the deliberate planting of false reports)
descendant(s) (n, adj)	disinterested (impartial; see <i>uninterested</i>)
desiccate(s), desiccated, desiccating	disk(s)
desktop(s)	disk drive(s)
desperate (distressed; see <i>disparate</i>)	disparate (different; see <i>desperate</i>)
despise(s), despised, despising	dispatch(es), dispatched, dispatching
detente(s)	dispel(s), dispelled, dispelling
deter(s), deterred, deterring	dispensable
deterrence(s)	dissension
deterrent(s)	distill(s), distilled, distilling
detriment(s)	distillation(s)
devastate(s), devastated, devastating	distribute(s), distributed, distributing
develop(s), developed, developing	distribution(s)
development(s)	distributor(s)
developed-country (adj)	districtwide
developing-country (adj)	divisible
device(s) (n)	dockworker(s)
devis(s), devised, devising	doctrine
devotee(s)	DOD (Department of Defense)
dexterous	dogfight(s)
diagram(s), diagramed, diagraming	doggerel
diagrammatic	dogma(s)
dialogue(s)	dollar-peso exchange rate
die(s), died, dying	dominance
diehard(s) (n, adj)	dominant (adj)
diesel-driven (um)	dominate(s), dominated, dominating
diesel-electric	donor-country (um)
diesel engine(s)	doomsday
diffuse(s), diffused, diffusing (to spread; see <i>defuse</i>)	Doppler
directed-energy (adj)	dossier(s)
direction-finding (um)	dot-com
	double agent (n)
	double-agent (adj)

double-barrel (n, um)	downsize(s), downsized, downsizing
double-barreled (um)	downstream (adj, adv)
double check(s) (n)	downswing(s)
double-check(s), double-checked, double-checking	Down syndrome
double-count(s), double-counted, double-counting (um, v)	downtime(s)
double cross(es) (n)	down-to-earth (adj)
double-cross(es), double-crossed, double-crossing	downtrend(s)
double-crosser(s)	downturn(s)
double-dealer(s)	downward
double-dealing (n, um)	downwind
double-decker(s)	draconian measures
double-digit (um)	draft(s), drafted, drafting (n, v)
double-duty (um)	draft age (um)
double-edged (um)	drawbridge(s)
double-entry (um)	drawdown(s) (n, um)
double play(s)	drawn-out (um)
double space(s) (n)	deadlocks
double-space(s), double-spaced, double-spacing	drive-by (n, adj)
doubletalk	drive-in(s) (n, adj)
double time	drive shaft(s)
double-track(s), double-tracked, double-tracking (v, um)	drive-through(s) (n, adj)
down-and-out (um)	drive(s) up, drove up, driving up
dovetail(s), dovetailed, dovetailing	drive-up (um)
downcast	drop(s) off, dropped off, dropping off (v)
downcraft(s)	dropoff (n, um)
downfall(s)	drop(s) out, dropped out, dropping out
downflow(s)	dropout(s) (n)
downgrade(s), downgraded, downgrading (n, v)	drought(s)
downhill(s) (n, adj, adv)	droughtlike
downtime(s)	drought-stricken (um)
down-link(s)	drug czar(s)
download(s), downloaded, downloading (n, v)	drug-free (um)
downpayment(s)	drug lord(s)
downplay(s), downplayed, downplaying	drug money (n, um)
downpour(s)	drug mule
downrange (adv)	drug-producing (um)
downriver (adj, adv)	drug runner
downside(s)	drug-smuggling (um)
	drug traffic
	drug trafficker
	drug-trafficking (um)

dry cleaner(s) (n. um)
 drycleaning
 drydock(s)
 dry-season (um)
 dual-purpose (adj)
 dual-use (um)
 due date(s)
 dues-paying (um)
 dumpster(s)
 duo (cf. all one word)
 dutybound
 duty-free (um, adv)
 dye(s), dyed, dyeing (coloring)
 dysfunction
 dysfunctional

E

18-year-olds

e- (cf. usually hyphenated)
 e-book(s)
 e-business(es)
 e-commerce
 e-mail(s), e-mailed, e-mailing (n, v)
 e-trade(s)
 e-trading
 e-zine(s)

earful(s)
 early-1980s-vintage (um)
 early or mid-1980s
 early or mid-March
 early-model (um)
 early-to-mid(dle) 1990s
 early-to-mid-March
 early warning (um, cf radar)
 earthmover(s)
 earthmoving
 east-southeast
 eastward
 easygoing
 economic decision making
 economic policy making

edgewise
 editor(s) in chief
 effect(s), effected, effecting (n, result, outcome; v, bring about, perform; see affect)
 ego(s)
 either (as a subject takes a singular verb and pronoun)
 elan
 elbowroom
 eldercare
 elect (suffix, hyphenated)
 President elect
 Senator-elect
 election (singular unless the context is plainly plural, as in the last four national elections)
 electro (cf. usually one word)
 electromagnetic
 electrotechnics
 but
 electro-optics
 electro-ultrafiltration
 eleventh-hour (adj)
 elicit(s), elicited, eliciting (v, to draw out; see illicit)
 eligible
 elite(s) (n. sc)
 ellipse, ellipses (p)
 elusive (hard to capture; see illusive)
 embargo(es)
 embarkation(s)
 embarrass(es), embarrassed, embarrassing
 embarrassment(s)
 embed(s), embedded, embedding
 embellish(es), embellished, embellishing
 embellishment(s)
 emigrant(s) (person moving to a new country; see immigrant)
 emigrate(s), emigrated, emigrating (leave one's country for a new one; see immigrate)
 emigre(s) (an emigrant)
 eminence grise, eminences grises (pl)
 emptyhanded
 encase(s), encased, encasing
 enclose(s), enclosed, enclosing
 enclosure(s)

encumber(s), encumbered, encumbering	entreat(s), entreated, entreating
encumbrance(s)	entry into force
encyclopedia(s)	entwine(s), entwined, entwining
end date(s)	envelop(s), enveloped, enveloping
endgame(s)	envelope(s) (n)
endgame(s)	environmental impact (um)
end item(s)	environmental protection (um)
endorse(s), endorsed, endorsing	environmental technology (um)
endorsement(s)	epilogue(s)
end point	equal(s), equaled, equaling (n, v)
end run (n)	equality, equalities (pl)
end-run(s), end-ran, end-running (v)	equal rights (n, um)
end use(s) (r)	Equator
end-use (adj)	equilibrium(s)
end-use item(s)	equip(s), equipped, equipping
end user(s) (n)	equipment
end-user (adj)	erector-launcher(s)
enforce(s), enforced, enforcing	erratum, errata (pl)
enforcement(s)	error message(s)
enfranchise(s), enfranchised, enfranchising	escapable
engine-driven (um)	escudo(s)
engine driver(s)	esprit de corps
enginehouse(s)	et al (see section 3.11)
engine room(s)	ethno (cf, usually one word)
English-speaking (um)	euro(s) (n, currency)
en masse	euro zone (n)
enrol	euro-zone (um)
enormity, enormities (pl) (great wickedness)	Euro (cf, usually one word)
enormousness (n, great size)	Eurodollar
enroll(s), enrolled, enrolling	Euroden
enrollment(s)	Eurotunnel
en route	European Central Bank (ECB)
ensure(s), ensured, ensuring (guarantee; see assure, insure)	European Union
enterprise(s)	evacuee(s)
entrench(es), entrenched, entrenching	evanished
entrap(s)	even-numbered (um)
entrepreneur(s)	even-keeled (um)
entrepreneurial	even-tempered (um)
entrepreneurialism	ever-present (um)
entrepreneurship	everyday
	ex cathedra
	ex-serviceman, ex-servicemen (pl)

exceed(s), exceeded, exceeding
 excel(s), excelled, excelling
 exchange rate(s) (n, um)
 excise(s), excised, excising (n, v)
 ex-civil-servant (n, adj)
 excommunicate(s), excommunicated,
 excommunicating
 Executive Order(s) (US President)
 exercise(s), exercised, exercising (Implement.
 train; see *exercise*)
 ex-Governor(s)
 exhibitor(s)
 exhilarate(s), exhilarated, exhilarating
 exhort(s), exhorted, exhorting
 exhortation(s)
 ex officio
 exonerate(s), exonerated, exonerating
 exoneration(s)
 exorbitant
 expel(s), expelled, expelling
 (purge; see *exercise*)
 expediter(s)
 expel(s), expelled, expelling
 export-control (adj)
 expose(s), exposed, exposing (v [two syllables],
 to 'sy open)
 expose(s) (n [three syllables], an exposure)
 ex post facto
 expulsion(s)
 extant (in existence)
 extol(s), extolled, extolling
 extra(s) (n)
 extra (as pref, usually one word)
 extracurricular
 extra-heavy (um)
 extra-large (um)
 extra-long (um)
 extramural
 extraordinary
 extraterrestrial
 extremely-low-frequency (adj)
 eye(s), eyed, eying
 eye-catching (um)

eyeglasses
 eye opener(s)
 eye-opening
 eye to eye
 eyewitness(es)

F

facade(s)
 face-saving (um)
 face-to-face (adj, adv)
 factbook(s)
 factfinding
 factsheet(s)
 Fahrenheit
 fail-safe(s) (n, adj)
 fair-haired (um)
 fairminded
 fair-skinned (um)
 fail accompli, fails accomplis (pl)
 fall(s) (autumn)
 fallback(s) (n, um)
 fall guy(s)
 fallible
 falling-out (n)
 falloff(s) (n)
 fallout(s) (n, um)
 fall wheat
 faraway (um)
 far cry, far cries (pl)
 farfetched
 fartling
 far-left (adj)
 far-leftist (um)
 farm bloc(s)
 farm-bred (um)
 farmland(s)
 farmwork
 farmworker(s)

far-reaching (um)	fiber optics (n)
far-right (adj)	field day(s)
far-rightist (um)	field-deployed
farseeing	field grade(s) (n)
far-sighted	field-grade (adj)
farther (physical or literal distance, see further)	fieldpiece(s)
farthest	field-test(s), field-tested, field-testing (v)
fast-breaking (um)	fifth column(s)
fast breeder reactor(s)	fighter-bomber(s)
fast-moving (um)	fighter-interceptor(s)
fast-food (adj)	fighter pilot(s) (n, um)
father(s)-in-law	fig leaf, fig leaves (pl)
fatwa(s)	figure 4 (reference)
faultfinding (n, adj)	figure eight(s)
faultline(s)	figurehead(s)
favor(s), favored, favoring (n, v)	file clerk(s)
fax(es), faxed, faxing (n, v)	file name
fearmongering	filmmaker(s)
feasible	filmmaking
featherbedding (n)	final assembly area(s)
fedayeen (sing, fedayea, rare)	fine-tune(s), fine-tuned, fine-tuning (v)
federal government(s) (non-US)	finger pointing (n)
Federal Government (US only)	fingerprint(s)
feedback (n)	firearm(s)
feedgrain(s)	fireball(s)
fellow traveler(s)	firebomb(s), firebombed, firebombing
fence jumper(s)	fire control(s) (n)
fence-rudding	fire-control (adj)
fence-sitter(s)	firecracker(s)
fence-sitting	fire drill(s) (n, adj)
ferro (cf, usually one word) but ferro-carbon-titanium ferro-uranium	firefight(s)
ferryboat(s)	firefighter(s)
fiasco(es)	firefighting
fiber(s)	fire-hardened (um)
fiberboard(s)	firepower
fiberglass but trade name Fiberglas	fireproof(s), fireproofed, fireproofing (adj, v)
fiber-optic (um)	fire-resistant (um)
	firesafe
	fire storm(s)
	fire-support (adj)
	firetruck(s)

firewall(s)	flaunt(s), flaunted, flaunting (to display conspicuously; see flout)
firewood	flagging(s)
firm-banded (um)	flexibility
first aid (n, um)	flexible
first-ballot (adj)	flier(s)
firstborn	flight control (adj)
first-class (adj)	flightcrew(s)
first-come-first-served	flight deck(s)
first-echelon (adj)	flight-hour(s)
first-half (adj)	flightline(s)
firsthand (adv, um)	flightpath(s)
First Family	flight test(s) (n, adj)
First Lady, First Ladies (pl)	flight-test(s), flight-tested, flight-testing (v)
firstline (adj)	flight time(s)
first-quarter (adj)	flip-flop(s), flip-flopped, flip-flopping (n, v)
first-rate (adj)	floodgate(s)
first-stage (adj)	floodlight(s)
first-time (adj)	flood plain(s)
flirt(s)	floodwater(s)
fit(s) out, fitted out, fitting out	floor-length
fitting-out (um)	floor plan(s)
fivefold	floorspace(s)
five-pointed (um)	flounder(s), floundered, floundering (to stumble about clumsily; see founder)
Five-Year Plan (if specific)	flout(s), flouted, flouting (to treat with contempt; see flaunt)
fixed-rate (adj)	flow chart(s)
fixed-wing (adj)	fluorescent(s) (n, adj)
fjord(s)	fluoro (cf, all one word)
flagship(s)	flyaway (adj)
but American flag ship	flyover(s)
flameproof(s), flameproofed, flameproofing (adj, v)	Lo.b. (free on board)
flamethrower(s)	focus(es), focused, focusing (n, v)
flammable (literal)	fold (suffix, usually one word) twofold fourfold
flare(s) up, flared up, flaring up	foldout(s)
flareup(s) (n)	follow-on(s) (n, um)
flashpoint(s)	followthrough(s) (n, um)
flatbed(s) (n, adj)	follow-up(s) (n, um)
flatcar(s)	follow(s) up, followed up, following up (v)
flatfoot, flatfoot (pl, physical condition of foot), flatfoots (pl, policemen)	
flat-footed	

- foodgrain(s)
 food grower(s) (n)
 food-processing (um)
 foodstore(s)
 foodstuff(s)
 foolhardiness
 foolhardy
 foolproof
 foot-and-mouth (adj)
 footbridge(s)
 foot-dragging
 foothill(s)
 foothold(s)
 footnote(s), footnoted, footnoting (n, v)
 foot-pound(s)
 footprint(s)
 foot soldier(s)
 footstep(s)
 forbear(s), forbore, forbore, forbearing
 (v, tolerate; see forbear)
 forbid(s), forbade, forbidding
 force majeure
 forbear(s) (n, ancestor; see forbear)
 forced labor
 force-feed, force-fed, force-feeding
 forefront(s)
 forgo(es), forwent, forgone, forgoing
 (precede; see forgo)
 forgone conclusion
 foreground(s)
 foreign decisionmaking
 foreign exchange(s) (n, um)
 foreign-government-backed (um)
 Foreign Military Sales (a US Government program)
 foreign policy making
 Foreign Service (JS only)
 foremost
 foresee(s), foresaw, foreseen, foreseeing
 foreseeable
 forestall(s), forestalled, forestalling
 forest-covered (um)
 forest land(s)
 foreword(s) (prefatory note)
 forgettable
 forgo(es), forwent, forgone, forgoing
 (do without; see forgo)
 forkoff(s)
 format(s), formatted, formatting (n, v)
 formatteur(s)
 forsake(s), forsook, forsaken, forsaking
 forswear(s), forswore, forsworn, forswearing
 forte(s)
 forthcoming
 forthright
 forthwith
 fortuitous (happens by chance or accident)
 fortune-teller(s)
 forum(s)
 forward (adj, adv, opposite of backward)
 forward-based (um)
 forward-looking (um)
 founder(s), founded, foundering (to go lame,
 collapse, sink, fail; see founder)
 four-star (adj)
 fourth-quarter (adj)
 four-wheel drive(s) (n)
 four-wheel-drive (um)
 framework(s)
 Franco-Prussian War
 fraught
 free (suffix, usually hyphenated)
 duty-free
 rent-free
 but
 carefree
 freedom fighter(s)
 free enterprise(s) (n, um)
 free-fall(s)
 free-for-all(s)
 free hand(s) (n)
 freehand (adj, adv)
 freelance(s), freelanced, freelancing (n, adj, v)
 freelancer(s)

free market(s) (n, um)
 free-marketeer(s) (n)
 free-market-oriented (um)
 free port(s)
 freer
 free-spoken (um)
 freestanding
 freethinker(s)
 freethinking
 free trade (n, um)
 free-trade-oriented
 freeway(s)
 freewheeling
 free will (n)
 freewill (um)
 freeze-dry, freeze-dries, freeze-dried,
 freeze-drying
 freight car(s)
 French Canadian
 but
 Italian-American
 Chinese-American
 French-English
 Fresh Revolutionary period
 freshwater (um)
 frogmen, frogmen (pl)
 front burner(s)
 front-end (ac)
 front-load(s), front-loaded, front-loading (v)
 frontline(s)
 front man, front men (pl)
 front page(s)
 frontrunner(s)
 frontrunning
 frontseat(s)
 frost-free (um)
 frostlike(s)
 frostproof(s), frostproofed, frostproofing (adj, v)
 fruit growing (n)
 fuel pump(s)
 full-blown
 fullblooded

fullface
 fulfill(s), fulfilled, fulfilling
 fulfillment(s)
 full-fledged
 full-grown (um)
 full load
 full-scale (adj)
 full-scope (adj)
 full-speed (adj)
 full-strength (adj)
 full-time (adv)
 fulsome (adj, offensive to the senses or unattractive,
 not complete or full)
 fundraiser(s)
 fundraising(s)
 funnel(s), funneled, funneling (n, v)
 funnel-shaped (um)
 further, furthest (generally conveys notion of
 additional degree, time, or quantity. see farther)
 fuse(s), fused, fusing (n, v, preferred spelling
 except for missile and other military applications;
 see fuze)
 fuselage(s)
 fuze(s), fused, fusing (certain military senses;
 see fuse)
 FY 2010

G

gainsay(s), gainsaid, gainsaying
 gallbladder(s)
 Gambia, The
 game plan(s)
 gas-canister bomb(s)
 gas-driven (um)
 gasfield(s)
 but
 oil and gas fields
 gas-fired (um)
 gas-flow (adj)
 gas-gathering (um)
 gas-heated (um)

gas-laden (um)
 gaslight(s)
 gasoline(s)
 gas main(s)
 gas mask(s)
 gas oil
 gastro (cf. usually one word)
 gas well(s)
 gasworker(s)
 gasworks
 gatekeeper(s)
 gauge(s)
 gasolite(s)
 GDP (gross domestic product)
 gearbox(es)
 gear-driven (um)
 gearshift(s)
 gendarme(s)
 gendarmerie (collective)
 general counsel(s)
 general-purpose (adj)
 gentlemen farmer(s)
 geopolitics
 ghetto(s)
 ghostwrite(s), ghostwrote, ghostwriting
 ghostwriter(s)
 gibe(s), giber, gibing (n, v, taunt or sneer,
 see jibe with)
 gigawatt-hour(s)
 give-and-take(s) (n)
 give(s) away, gave away, giving away (v)
 giveaway(s) (n)
 glad hand (n)
 glad-hand(s), glad-handed, glad-handing (v)
 glamorous
 glamour
 glasnost
 glassmaking
 globetrotting
 glove box(es)
 GmbH (German equivalent of the US Inc.)

GNP (gross national product)
 go-ahead(s) (n)
 go-around(s)
 go-between(s) (n)
 go-gutter(s)
 going(s)-on
 gold mine(s)
 goodbye(s)
 good-faith (adj)
 good-hearted (um)
 good-heartedness
 good-humored (um)
 good offices
 good-quality (adj)
 good-to-excellent (um)
 goodwill (in economics)
 good will (usually literal senses)
 go-slow(s)
 gossiped-about (um)
 gossipmonger(s)
 government(s) (when referring to a sovereign state,
 capitalize in phrases like Egyptian Government;
 lowercase when used alone or with nonsovereign
 entities; see Hong Kong government;
 government(s)-in-exile
 governmentwide
 governor(s) general
 grab bag(s)
 graded earth runway(s)
 grainfield(s)
 grainland(s)
 grandstanding
 grant(s)-in-aid
 grapevine(s)
 grassroots (nonliteral)
 gravesite(s) (n)
 gray(s), grayed, graying (adj, v)
 gray arms broker(s)
 gray arms market(s)
 gray-market (um)
 great-aunt(s)
 Greater London

great-grandfather(s)
 great-grandmother(s)
 Great Himalaya Range
 great-power (adj)
 great-uncle(s)
 greenbelt(s)
 green card(s)
 greenhouse(s)
 grievous
 ground attack (adj, of aircraft)
 ground-based (um)
 groundbreaking(s) (n, adj)
 groundburst(s)
 ground-controlled (um)
 ground crew(s)
 ground-effect vehicle(s) (generic for a Hovercraft
 or similar machine)
 ground fire
 ground force(s) (n, adj)
 ground-launched (um)
 ground-mobile (um)
 ground rules
 ground station(s)
 ground support (adj, of equipment)
 ground swell(s)
 ground test(s) (r, adj)
 ground-test(s), ground-tested, ground-testing (v)
 ground war(s)
 groundwater(s)
 groundwave(s)
 groundwork
 groupthink
 growth rate(s)
 gruesome
 G-7 summit(s)
 guarantee(s), guaranteed, guaranteeing (n, v)
 guaranty, guaranties (pl) (n, used only in
 legal sense)
 guardhouse(s)
 guerrilla(s)
 guesswork

guest worker(s)
 guidance and control (um)
 guided-missile (adj)
 guided-missile cruiser
 guideline(s)
 guide rail(s)
 Gulf state(s) (Persian)
 Gulf war (Persian understood)
 gun-barrel (adj)
 gun battle(s)
 gunbearer(s)
 gun-bore (adj)
 gundeck(s)
 gunfighting
 gunfire
 gun(s)-for-hire (n)
 gunmaking
 gunman, gunmen (pl)
 gun mount(s)
 gunpoint
 gunpowder(s)
 gunrunner(s)
 gunrunning
 gunship(s)
 gunshot(s)
 gunsight(s)
 gun tube(s)
 gunsmith(s)
 Gypsy, Gypsies (pl)

H

habeas corpus (sing, pl)
 Hague, The
 halibone
 hailstorm
 hairbreadth
 hairline
 hairsplitting

hajj(es) (Muslim pilgrimage)	hand-holding
hajj(s) (Muslim pilgrim; capitalize only if it precedes a person's name)	handicap(s), handicapped, handicapping
half brother(s)	hand-in-hand
half-day (ac)	handmade
half-dozen (adj)	hand-me-down(s) (n, um)
halfhearted	hand(s) off, handed off, handing off
half hour	handoff(s) (n, um)
half-hourly (um)	hand(s) out, handed out, handing out
half-life	handout(s) (n, um)
half load	hand(s) over, handed over, handing over
half-mast	hand-over(s) (n)
half measure	handpicked
half-mile (adj)	handrail(s)
half-million (adj)	handshake(s)
half-monthly (adj)	hands-off (adj)
half moon	hands-on (adj)
half-ripe (um)	hand-wringing
half sister(s)	handwritten
half-speed (adj)	hangers-on
half-stop	hangup(s)
half-strength (adj)	harass(es), harassed, harassing
halftime	harbormaster(s)
halftrack	hard-and-fast
half-truth	hardball
halfway	hard-charging (um)
half-yearly	hardcopy
Halley's comet	hard core (n, adj)
hallmark	hardcover
ham-fisted (adj)	hard currency (n, um)
hamstring(s), hamstrung, hamstringing (n, v, adj)	hard drive(s)
handbook	hard-driving (um)
hand-built (um)	hardhat(s)
hand-carry(s), hand-carried, hand-carrying	hardheaded
handclasp(s)	hard-hit (um)
handcuff(s)	hard-hitting (um)
hand-deliver(s), hand-delivered, hand-delivering (v, adj)	hard line(s)
handgrenade(s)	hardline (adj)
handgun(s)	hardliner(s)
handheld (adj)	hard-nosed (adj)
	hard-pressed (um)
	handstand(s)

hard-target (adj)	heavy-lift (adj)
hard up	heavy-set (um)
hardware	heavy-water (adj)
hardwired (adj)	heavy-water-moderated (um)
hard-won (um)	heavyweight (n, um)
hard work	hedgehop(s), hedgehopped, hedgehopping
hardworking (adj)	height-finding (adj)
hardbrained	heir(s) apparent
harvesttime	helicopter-borne (um)
has-been(s)	hemisphere(s) but Western Hemisphere
have-not(s) (n, adj)	hemorrhage(s)
H-bomb(s)	Her Majesty's Government
headfirst	hereafter
headlight(s)	hereby
headline(s)	harcin
headlong	heretofore
head-on (adj, adv)	herewith
headquarter(s), headquartered, headquartering (n, v)	heterogeneous
headrest(s)	heyday(s)
headroom	hidebound
headstart(s)	hideout (n, um)
headstrong	high-altitude (adj)
heads-up (n, adj)	highborn
head-to-head (um)	high-caliber (adj)
headwaters	high-class (adj)
headway(s)	high-density (adj)
health care (n)	high-end (adj)
health-care (um)	high-energy (adj)
healthful (producing health)	higher-income
health worker(s)	higher-level (um)
healthy (in good health)	higher-paying
heartbeat(s)	higher-ranking
heartland(s)	higher-than-market price
heat-resistant (um)	higher-ups
heat-seeking (um)	highest-altitude (um)
heavy bomber(s) (n, um)	highest-ranking
heavy bomber base(s)	high-explosive (um)
heavy-duty (adj)	high fidelity
heavyhanded	highflier(s)
heavy hitter(s)	

high-frequency (adj)	hodgepodge(s)
high-frequency direction-finding (um)	hold off, held off, holding off
highhanded	holdout(s)
high-intensity (adj)	holdover(s) (n, adj)
highland(s) (n, um)	hold time(s)
high-level (adj)	holdup(s)
high light(s) (literal)	Holocaust (thel)
highlight(s) (nonliteral)	home base(s)
high-minded (um)	homebrew(s)
high point(s) (literal, nonliteral)	homebuilding
high-power (adj)	home buyer(s)
high-precision (adj)	homecoming(s)
high-pressure(s), high-pressured, high-pressuring (v, adj)	home front(s)
high-priced (um)	homegrown
high-priority (adj)	home guard(s)
high-profile (adj)	homeland(s)
high-protein (adj)	homemade
high-quality (adj)	homeowner(s)
high-ranking (um)	home page(s)
high-resolution (adj)	home port(s)
high-rise (adj)	home-port(s), home-ported, home-porting
high school (s, um)	home rule
high-speed (adj)	homesick
high-strung (um)	homestead(s)
high-tech(nology) (adj)	homestretch(es)
high-tension (adj)	hometown(s)
high-value (adj)	homeward
high water mark	homogeneous
hijack(s), hijacked, hijacking (n, v)	honeymoon(s)
hijacker(s)	Hong Kong Government
hilltop(s)	honorbound
hill tribe(s)	hookup(s) (n, adj)
hindsight	horselaugh(s)
hit-and-miss (adj)	horseman, horsemen (pl)
hit-and-run (adj)	horseplay
hit list(s)	horsepower
hit man, hit man (pl)	horserace(s)
hit-or-miss (adj)	horseshoe(s)
HIV	horsetrade(s), horse-traded, horsetrading (n, v, nonliteral)
HIV-positive (um)	horse trader(s) (nonliteral)

hostage taker(s)
 hostage taking
 host-country (adj)
 host-government (adj)
 host-nation (adj)
 hothead(s)
 hot-blooded (um)
 hot-button (adj)
 hotheaded
 hothouse(s)
 hotline(s) (nonliteral)
 hot-pursuit (adj)
 hotspot(s)
 hour-long
 housebuilding
 house call(s)
 house-clean(s), house-cleaned, house-cleaning
 housecleaner(s)
 house-cleaning (um)
 houseguest(s)
 household(s)
 housekeeping
 but
 safehouse keeper
 safehouse keeping
 housework
 hover craft (unless trade name Hovercraft)
 HTML (hypertext markup language)
 hull-less
 human rights (n, um)
 human-rights-related (um)
 human-source (adj)
 humdrum
 HUMINT
 hundredfold
 hundredweight
 hunger strike(s)
 hunker(s) down, hunkered down, hunkering down
 hush money
 hush(es) up, hushed up, hushing up
 hushup(s) (n, adj)

hydro (cf, usually one word)
 hydroelectric
 hydropower
 hydrostatic
 hyper (pref, usually one word)
 hyperinflation
 hyperlink(s), hyperlinked, hyperlinking (r, v)
 hypertext system(s)
 but
 hyper Dorian
 hypocrisy
 hypothesis, hypotheses (pl)

I

I-beam(s)
 Iberian Peninsula
 Ibid. (see 3.12)
 iceberg(s)
 icebound
 icebreaker(s)
 icecap(s)
 ice-covered (um)
 icefield(s)
 ice-free
 icemaking
 icepack(s)
 ice shelf, ice shelves (pl)
 ice skate(s) (n)
 ice-skate(s), ice-skated, ice-skating
 ice storm(s)
 idiosyncrasy, idiosyncrasies (pl)
 idiosyncratic
 idyll(s)
 ill-advised (um)
 ill-advisedly
 ill-at-ease (um)
 illegible
 ill-equipped (um)
 ill health
 illicit (n, illegal; see elicit)
 illicit drug trafficking

illiquid	in-country (adj., adv)
illiquidity	incredible
ill-prepared (um)	incur(s), incurred, incurring
ill-timed (um)	indefensible
illusive (deceptive; see elusiv)	indelible
ill will	Independence Day
image-building (um)	in-depth (um)
image-conscious (adj)	indestructible
image-enhancing (um)	indeterminate
imm(s)	index, indexes (pl); indices (pl, scientific only)
immersible	indications-and-warning intelligence
immigrant(s) (coming into; see emigrant)	indict(s), indicted, indicting (to accuse; see indite)
impasse(s)	indigestible
impel(s), impelled, impelling	indite(s), indited, inditing (to compose; see indite)
impending (hint of threat or menace)	indivisible
imperceptible	Indo-European
imperial(s), imperial, imperiling	industrialization
immissible	industrywide
imperturbable	inedible
impersuasive	ineligible
implausible	inequity, inequities (pl) (unfairness; see iniquity)
implanter(s)	inexhaustible
imply (implies), implied, implying (state something indirectly; see infer)	in extremis
impostor(s)	infallible
imprimatur(s)	infantryman, infantrymen (pl)
improvise(s), improvised, improvising	infeasible
in absentia	infer(s), inferred, inferring (draw a conclusion or make a deduction; see imply)
inaccessible	inferable
inadmissible	inference(s)
inaudible	infighter(s)
inbound	infighting
in-board (adj)	inflammable (figurative)
inbox(es)	inflexible
inc.	in-flight (um)
incise(s), incised, incising	inflow(s)
incompatible	influence-buying
incomprehensible	information processing
incontrovertible	infra (pref. usually one word)
incur(s)	but
indefensible	infra-axillary
indelible	infra-esophageal
Independence Day	infra-umbilical
in-depth (um)	
indestructible	
indeterminate	
index, indexes (pl); indices (pl, scientific only)	
indications-and-warning intelligence	
indict(s), indicted, indicting (to accuse; see indite)	
indigestible	
indite(s), indited, inditing (to compose; see indite)	
indivisible	
Indo-European	
industrialization	
industrywide	
inedible	
ineligible	
inequity, inequities (pl) (unfairness; see iniquity)	
inexhaustible	
in extremis	
infallible	
infantryman, infantrymen (pl)	
infeasible	
infer(s), inferred, inferring (draw a conclusion or make a deduction; see imply)	
inferable	
inference(s)	
infighter(s)	
infighting	
inflammable (figurative)	
inflexible	
in-flight (um)	
inflow(s)	
influence-buying	
information processing	
infra (pref. usually one word)	
but	
infra-axillary	
infra-esophageal	
infra-umbilical	

INF (intermediate-range nuclear forces) Treaty

in-garrison

ingenious (skillful)

ingenuous (without guile)

in group(s)

in-house (adj, adv)

iniquity, iniquities (pl) (sin; see *iniquity*)

ink jet(s)

in-law(s)

inner-city (adj)

inner tube(s)

innocuous

innuendo(s)

inoculate(s), inoculated, inoculating

input(s), input, inputting (n, v)

inquire(s), inquired, inquiring

inquiry, inquiries (pl)

inshore

insignia (the singular, *insigne*, is rarely used)

in situ

insofar as

inspector(s) general

install(s), installed, installing

installation(s)

installment(s)

instill(s), instilled, instilling

insure(s), insured, insuring (cover by an insurance policy; see *assure*, *ensure*)

insurgency, insurgencies (pl)

insurgent(s)

intangible(s) (n, adj)

Intellink

intelligence-gathering (um)

intelligentia

intelligible

integrity

inter (pref, usually one word)

interactive processing

inter alia

but

inter-American

inter-European

intercede(s), interceded, interceding

interceptor(s)

Interests Section (capitalize if US)

interfere(s), interfered, interfering

interleaving

intermediate-range ballistic missile (IRBM)

internment(s) (bureau; see *internment*)

intermittent

intern(s)

internally displaced person(s) (IDP)

Internet

internment(s) (detention; see *internment*)

INTERPOL

interrepublic

interruptible

in-theater (adj)

intifada(s)

in toto

intra (pref, usually one word)

but

intra-atomic

intra-German

intransigent (n, adj)

intro (pref, at one word)

invincible

invisible

ipso facto

Iran-Contra

Iran-Iraq war

irascible

IRBM (intermediate-range ballistic missile)

iridescence

ironclad

ironfisted

ironically (involves incongruity between what might be expected and what actually occurs)

iron lung(s)

ironmaking

ironworking

ironworks

irreducible

irreplaceable

irrepressible

irresistible

irresponsible

irreversible

Islamization

issues (are resolved, not solved)

iteration(s)

its (possessive of it; compare it's, the contraction of *it is*; contractions are rarely appropriate in formal writing)

J

jailbreak(s)

jawbone(s), jawboned, jawboning (n, v)

jerry-build(s), jerry-built, jerry-building

jerry-built (um; see *jerry-rigged*)

jet aircraft

jet airliner(s)

jet bomber(s)

jetliner(s)

jet-powered (um)

jet-propelled (um)

jet propulsion

jet set(s)

jibe with (informally, be consonant with; see *gibe*)

jihad(s)

jobholder(s)

jobseeker(s)

joint-service (adj)

joint-stock (adj)

joint-venture (adj)

journeyman, journeymen (pl)

judgment(s)

jump(s) off, jumped off, jumping off

jumpoff(s) (n, um)

jump-start(s), jump-started, jump-starting (n, v, adj)

jury-rigged (um; see *jerry-built*)

just-completed (um)

just-in-time (um)

K

kaleidoscope

keel-lying (um)

kerosene(s)

ketchup(s)

keypad(s)

keyword(s)

kick(s) back, kicked back, kicking back

kickback(s) (n, um)

kick-start(s), kick-started, kick-starting

kidnap(s), kidnapped, kidnapping

kidnapper(s)

kidney stone(s)

killjoy(s)

kill rate(s)

kilobyte(s) (KB)

kilo-class (um)

kilowatt-hour(s) (kWh)

kimono(s)

kingmaker(s)

kingpin(s)

king-sized (um)

knot (kilometers per hour)

knee-jerk (um)

know-how

know-it-all(s) (n)

knowledgeable

know-nothing(s) (n, adj)

Korean war

kowtow(s), kowtowed, kowtowing

Kresta-II(s)

kudos (never kudo)

L

label(s), labeled, labeling

labeler(s)

Labor Day

labor-intensive (um)

laborsaving

labor union(s)

lackluster

laid-back (adj)

laid-off (um)

laid-up (participle)

laissez-faire (n, adj)

lambled(s)

lakefront(s)

lameduck(s) (noun/rai)

LAN (local area network)

land-attack (adj, of a missile)

land base(s)

land-based (um)

landborne

landbound

land bridge(s)

landfill(s)

landgrab(s)

landholding

landline(s)

landlocked

landlord(s)

landmass(es)

landmine(s)

land-mobile (um)

landowner(s)

landownership

landowning

land-poor (um)

Land Rover(s)

Landsat (US Earth resources satellite)

landslide(s)

land tax(es)

land-use (adj)

landward

landwire(s)

lapdog(s)

large-scale (adj)

largess

last-ditch (adj)

last-minute (adj)

last resort(s) (n)

last-resort (adj)

latecomer(s)

late-model (adj)

late-night (adj)

late-payment (adj)

Latin American country (countries)

letter-day (adj)

launch crew(s)

launch(es), launched, launching on
tactical warning

launch-on-tactical-warning (n, um)

launch(es), launched, launching on warning

launch-on-warning (n, um)

launchpad(s)

launch point(s)

launchsite(s)

but

space launch site

launch stand(s)

launch weight(s)

law-abiding (um)

law-and-order (adj)

lawbreaker(s)

lawmaking

lawsuit(s)

lay(s), laid, laid (to put, place, or prepare: always
takes a direct object, see lie)

layoff(s) (n, adj)

layout(s) (n, adj)

layover(s) (n, adj)

layperson, laypeople (pl)

lay(s) up, laid up, laying up

layup(s) (n, um)

LCD(s) (liquid crystal display)

lead-in(s) (n, um)

leading edge(s) (n)

leading-edge (um)

leading-edge (adj)

leadtime(s)

lead(s) up, lead up, leading up

lead-up(s) (n, um)

League of Nations

leakthrough(s)

leapfrog

leap year(s)

leather-bound (um)

leatherworking

lee shore(s)

leeward

left-hand (adj)

left-leaning (adj)

left-of-center (um)

left wing(s) (n)

leftwing (adj)

leftwinger(s)

legible

legman, legmen (pl)

legwork

lend-lease(s)

less (suffix, usually not hyphenated)

dataless

weaponless

but

hull-less

shell-less

less developed (no hyphen)

lesser-known

less-than-even (um)

letter bomb(s)

letter-perfect (um)

letterspacing

letterwriting

let(s) up, let up, letting up

letup(s) (n)

level(s), leveled, leveling

leveler(s)

levelheaded

liaison(s)

license(s)

license plate(s) (n, um)

lie(s), lay, lain (to recline or be situated; never takes a direct object; see *lay*)

lifeblood

lifeboat(s)

life cycle(s) (n, um)

lifeguard(s)

life insurance (r, um)

life-like

lifeline(s)

lie-long

liferaft(s)

lifesaving

life-size (adj)

lifespan(s)

lifestyle(s)

lifetime(s)

lift(s) off, lifted off, lifting off

liftoff(s) (n)

lighter-than-air craft

lighthearted

light-water (adj, in reference to nuclear power)

light-water-reactor (um)

lightweight(s) (n, adj)

light-year(s)

like (suffix, usually one word)

businesslike

lifelike

but

bell-like

hull-like

likable

likelihood

like-minded (um)

Likud party

linchpin(s)

line-item (adj)

line-of-sight (um)

- line(s) up, lined up, lining up
 lineup(s) (n, um)
 line width(s)
 link(s) to, linked to, linking to
 link(s) up, linked up, linking up
 linkup(s) (n, um)
 lipservice
 liquefy (liquefies), liquefied, liquefying
 liquid-propellant (adj)
 liquid-propelled (um)
 little-known (um)
 little-used (um)
 livedrop(s) (nonliterat)
 live-fire (um)
 livewire(s) (nonliteral)
 living costs
 (lano(s)
 Lloyd's (insurance)
 Lloyds (bank)
 loan-sharking (n, um)
 loath (adj, reluctant)
 loathe(s), loathed, loathing (delect)
 locavore(s)
 lock(s) on, locked on, locking on
 lockon(s) (n, adj)
 lock(s) out, locked out, locking out
 lockout(s)
 locus, loci (pl)
 logbook(s)
 loggerheads
 log(s) in, logged in, logging in
 logistic (adj)
 log(s) slice (n)
 logjam(s)
 log(s) off, logged off, logging off
 log(s) on, logged on, logging on
 London Summit(s)
 lonely-hearts club(s)
 long ago (adv)
 long-ago (um)
 long-awaited (um)
 long-bed(s) (n, adj; truck)
 long-delayed (um)
 long-distance (adj)
 longest-ruling leader(s)
 long-lasting (um)
 long-lived (um)
 long-range (adj)
 long run(s) (n)
 long-run (adj)
 long shot(s) (n)
 long-shot (adj)
 long-sought (um)
 longstanding (adj)
 long-term (adj)
 longtime (adj)
 long-winded
 look-alike(s) (n, adj)
 lockdown/shutdown (um, of aircraft radar)
 lookout(s) (n, um)
 loop (as in, in the loop)
 loophole(s)
 loose-knit (um)
 looseleaf (adj)
 lopsided
 loss-making (um)
 loudspeaker(s)
 low-altitude (adj)
 low-cost (adj)
 low Earth orbit(s) (n)
 low-Earth-orbit (adj)
 lowercase(s), lowercased, lowercasing (adj, v)
 lower-class (adj)
 lower-cost (adj)
 lower-echelon (adj)
 lower-profile (adj)
 lower-grade (adj)
 lower-house (adj)
 lower-income (adj)
 lower-level (adj)
 lower-middle-class (adj)

low-flying (um)
 low-frequency (adj)
 low-income (adj)
 low-key (adj, adv)
 lowland(s) (n, um)
 low-level (adj)
 low-light (adj)
 low-lying (um)
 low-observable(s) (n, um)
 low-paying (um)
 low-power (adj)
 low-pressure (adj)
 low-priced (um)
 low-profile (adj)
 low-quality (adj)
 Lid.
 lukewarm
 luncheon(s)
 lump-sum (um)
 lunchtime(s)

M

M.A.(s)
 machine-building (um)
 machine dependant
 machinegun(s)
 machine-made (um)
 machine readable
 machine shop(s)
 machine tool(s)
 machismo
 macho (adj)
 macro (cf, all one word)
 made-over (um)
 made-up (um)
 moderate(s)
 magnate(s) (VIP)
 magnet(s) (metal attractor)
 magneto(s)

mah-jongg
 mail merge(s), mail-merged, mail-merging (n, v)
 mainframe(s)
 mainland(s)
 main line(s) (n, literal)
 mainline(s), mainlined, mainlining
 (adj, v, nonliteral)
 mainspring(s)
 mainstay(s)
 mainstream(s) (n, adj)
 major general
 make-believe (n, adj)
 makeshift
 makeup(s) (n, um)
 make-work
 mal (cf, all one word)
 malware
 manageable
 manager-director(s)
 man-day(s)
 maneuver(s), maneuvered, maneuvering (n, v)
 man-for-man
 manhandle(s), manhandled, manhandling
 manhole(s)
 man-how(s)
 manic-depressive (avoid; prefer bipolar)
 manifold(s) (n, adj, adv)
 man (men) in the street
 manmade (um)
 man-of-war, men-of-war (pl)
 manpack (adj)
 man-portable (um)
 man-portable air defense system (MANPADS)
 manpower
 mantle(s) (shelf)
 mantle(s) (cloak)
 man-year(s)
 many-sided (um)
 mapmaker(s)
 mapreading
 maquiladora(s)

marijuana
 market-oriented (um)
 marketplace(s)
 marshal(s), marshaled, marshaling
 mass-produce(s), mass-produced,
 mass-producing
 masterful (domineering, powerful)
 mastery (knowledgeable, skillful)
 mastermind(s)
 master's degree(s)
 master stroke(s)
 matrix, matrices (pl)
 matter-of-fact (adj)
 matter-of-factly (adv)
 max(s) (n)
 maxi (pref, all one word)
 maximum(s)
 May Day (1 May)
 mayday(s) (distress call)
 mea culpa
 mealtime(s)
 mean-spirited (um)
 mean time (astronomical)
 meantime (meanwhile)
 meanwhile
 meatpacking
 media (always use pl)
 media-savvy (um)
 Medicaid
 Medicare
 medieval
 medium- and high-altitude (adj)
 medium and high altitudes
 medium-size(d) (adj)
 medium-to-high altitude (n)
 medium-to-high-altitude (adj)
 meetingplace(s)
 mega (cf, usually one word)
 megabyte(s) (MB)
 megadose(s)
 megaproject(s)
 member state(s) (n)
 member-state (adj)
 memento(s)
 memoir(s) (person's reminiscence)
 memorandum(s)
 memorandum(s) of understanding (MOU)
 menu driven
 merchandise
 merchantman, merchantmen (pl)
 merchant ship(s)
 Mercosur
 messhall(s)
 messkit(s)
 mestizo(s)
 metal-coated (um)
 metal-cutting (um)
 metal-smelting (um)
 metalworker(s)
 metalworkers union (no apostrophe)
 metalworking
 metamorphosis, metamorphoses (pl)
 metaphor(s) (implied comparison of
 dissimilar things)
 meteorology
 meter(s)
 Metro Manila
 Metropolitan London
 Metropolitan Moscow
 but
 the Moscow metropolitan area
 micro (cf, usually one word)
 but
 micro-organism
 mid (cf)
 mid- and late 1990s
 mid-April
 midcareer
 midday
 mid-decade
 mid-18th century (n)
 mid-18th-century (adj)
 mid-ice
 midinfrared
 midlevel

midmorning
 mid-1960s-style (adj)
 mid-1989
 mid-1990s
 mid-Pacific
 midpoint(s) (n, adj)
 mid-sixties
 midterm(s) (n, adj)
 midtwenties
 mid-to-late 1990s
 mid-to long-term (um)
 midyear
 middle age(s)
 middle-aged (um)
 middle class(s) (n)
 middle-class (adj)
 Middle East (n, adj)
 Middle Eastern (adj)
 Middle East war
 middle ground
 middle-income (adj)
 middle-level (adj)
 middleman, middlemen (pl)
 middle-of-the-roader(s)
 middle-size(d) (adj)
 MIG-21(s)
 mild-mannered (um)
 mileage(s)
 mile-long (um)
 milepost(s)
 milestone(s)
 mile-wide (um)
 milieu(s)
 militate(s), militated, militating (to have weight or effect, for or against; see mitigate)
 militiaman, militiamen (pl)
 millennium, millennia (pl)
 minable
 mindreading
 mind-set(s)
 mineclearing (um)
 minefield(s)
 minehunter(s)
 minehunting
 minelayer(s)
 minelaying
 mineship(s)
 minesite(s)
 minesweeper(s)
 minesweeping
 mine warfare (n, um)
 mineworks
 mini (n)
 mini (pref, usually all one word)
 miniature(s)
 but
 mini-estate
 minimum(s)
 minimum-security (adj)
 minister-counselor(s)
 minister(s)-designate
 minister-president(s)
 minuscule
 minutes' (possessive case)
 minutiae (the singular, *minutia*, is rarely used)
 MIRVs (multiple independently targetable reentry vehicles)
 unmIRVed
 nonmIRVed
 mischief-maker(s)
 mischiefmaking
 missile-equipped (um)
 missile-related (um)
 missile support(s) (n, um)
 missile suspension(s) (n, um)
 Missile Technology Control Regime (MTCR)
 Mission (US, to the UN; not to be capitalized for other diplomatic offices, JS or otherwise)
 misspell(s), misspelled, misspelling
 mitigate(s), mitigated, mitigating (to moderate or alleviate; see militate)
 mixup(s)
 mnemonics
 mobile-erector-launcher(s) (n)
 mobile missile(s) (n, um)
 mockup(s) (n)

Mod 4

but
modified HY-4

model(s), modeled, modeling

modeler(s)

modern(s)

moderate-to-high (um)

modern-day (um)

modus operandi, modi operandi (pl)

modus vivendi, modi vivendi (pl)

mold(s), molded, molding (n, v)

molotov cocktail(s)

money laundering (n)

money-laundering (um)

money-losing (um)

moneymaker(s)

moneymaking

money market(s)

monies (preferred plural of money [rather than monies]; sounds stilted in most contexts; use cash, funds, and similar everyday words)

monysaving

monogram(s), monogrammed, monogramming

monologue(s)

monthend

monthlong (adj)

month-old (um)

months-long (adj)

mop(s) up, mopped up, mopping up

mopup (n, um)

moratorium(s)

mosque(s) (like)

most-favored-nation (adj)

most-sought-after (adj)

mothballed

mother(s)-in-law

motherland(s)

mother ship(s)

motor torpedo boat(s)

motorboat(s)

motorcycle(s)

motor-driven (um)

motorized rifle regiment(s)

motorship(s)

MOU (memorandum of understanding)

mountainside(s)

mouthful(s)

mouthpiece(s)

movable

moviemaking

MRV(s) (multiple reentry vehicle)

MTCR (Missile Technology Control Regime)

much-discussed (um)

much-needed (um)

muckrake(s), muckraked, muckraking

muckraker(s) (n)

mudbank(s)

mudflat(s)

mudslinging

Muhammad

mulah(s)

mult (cf, usually one word)

multicolor(ed)

mult fiber

mult-ply (adj, several plies)

multitasking

mult-user system(s)

multimillion-dollar (adj)

multiple independently targetable

reentry vehicles (MIRVs)

multiple-purpose (adj)

multiple reentry vehicles (MRVs)

multiple-restart (adj)

multiple rocket launcher(s)

multiplex(es), multiplexed, multiplexing

multiplexer(s)

musclebound

music teacher(s)

Muslim(s)

mutually agreed on

N

naivete

NAM (Nonaligned Movement)

name-calling (um)

nameplate(s)

Napoleonic code

narco (cf, all one word)

narcissurgent

Note: narco (sometimes just narc) can also be a separate word. Both the noun and the adjective should be limited to informal use.

narrowband (adj)

narrow-beam (adj)

narrow-body (n, adj, of aircraft)

narrow gauge(s) (n)

narrow-gauge (n)

narrowminded

nation-building

nation-states

nationwide

native-born (um)

natural gas

natural gas field(s)

nearby

near-Earth orbit

near miss(es)

near-real time (n)

near-real-time (adj)

near-record (adj)

nearsighted

near success(s)

near-term (um)

neck and neck

need-to-know (um)

ne'er-do-well(s)

negligible

neo (cf, usually one word)

neocolonist(s) (n, adj)

neofascist(s) (n, adj)

but

neo-Communist(s) (n, adj)

neo-Nazi(s) (n, adj)

nerve-racking

Netherlands, the

network(s), networked, networking (n, v)

net worth(s)

neuro (cf, all one word)

never-ending (um)

nevertheless

newcomer(s)

newfound

new-generation (adj)

newly industrializing countries (NICs)
or economies (NIEs)

newsbroadcast(s)

newscaster(s)

news editor(s)

news-gathering (um)

newsgroup(s)

newsletter(s)

newsmagazine(s)

newsmaking

newspaper(s)

newspaper reporter(s)

newsprint(s)

newsstand(s)

newsweekly, newsweeklies (pl)

news wire(s)

newsworthy

New Year (the)

New Year's Day

next-generation (adj)

next of kin

nightclub(s)

night-flying (um)

night letter(s)

nightlong (um)

night school(s)

night shift(s)

nighttime(s)

night-vision (adj)

nightworker(s)

Nile Delta

ninefold	non-nuclear-armed
nitpick(s), nitpicked, nitpicking (n, v)	non-nuclear-weapon state
nitpicker(s)	non-oil-producing
nitpicky	non-party-member(s)
Nobel laureate(s)	non-printing character(s)
Nobel prize(s)	Non Proliferation Treaty (NPT, spell out for first use)
noblesse oblige	non-rare-earth
nobody, nobodies (pl)	nonetheless
no-confidence (adj)	no-no, no-no's (pl)
No Dong(s) (missile)	no-nonsense (adj)
no-fault (adj)	nonplussed
no-first-strike (adj)	non sequitur(s)
no-first-use (adj)	no one
no-fly zone(s)	northbound
noise-free	north-central
noisemaker(s)	northeast
noisemaking	northeastern
noisome (offensive and disgusting, like a noisome odor, or harmful)	north end(s)
no man's land(s)	Northern Atlantic
nom(s) de guerre	north-northeast
nom(s) de plume	North Rhine-Westphalia
non (as prefix, usually one word)	north shore(s)
nonaligned	northward
Nonaligned Movement (NAM)	nosecone(s)
Nonaligned summit	nosedive(s)
nonattributable	no-show(s) (r. adj)
noncommissioned officer	notebook(s)
noncombat	note paper(s)
nonferrous	noteworthy
nonfelix	noticeable
nonfired	notwithstanding
nongovernmental organization (NGO)	nouveau riche, nouveaux riches (pl)
nonnuclear	novel-writing (um)
nonoccursing	no-war/no-peace
nonoil	now-dominant (um)
nonproliferation	nowhere
nonplanetary Earth (unl. extraterrestrial context)	NPT (Non-Proliferation Treaty; Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, spell out on first use)
nonuse of force (n)	nuclear-armed (um)
nonuse-of-force (adj)	nuclear-capable (um)
but	nuclear delivery (n, um)
non-CIA	nuclear-free (um)
non-civil-service	Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT, spell out on first use)
non-European	
non-intelligence-related	
non-interest bearing (um)	
non-life-threatening (um)	
non-missile-equipped	
non-nuclear-powered	

nuclear power(s) (n, um)
 nuclear-powered (um)
 nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN)
 nuclear-related (um)
 nuclear strike(s) (n, um)
 nuclear-war-fighting (um)
 nuclear weapon(s) (n, um)
 nuclear-weapons-free (um)
 nuclear-weapon-sized (um)
 nuclear-weapons-related (um)
 nuclear-weapon state(s)
 nucleus, nuclei (pl)
 number-one, number-two (um)

O

oasis, oases (pl)
 oblast(s)
 occasional
 occupied territory, occupied territories (pl)
 occur(s), occurred, occurring
 occurrence(s)
 oceanborne
 oceangoing
 oceanside
 oceanwide
 octave(s)
 October War
 odd number(s)
 odd-numbered (um)
 off-and-on (um)
 off-balance (adj)
 off-base (adj)
 off-campus (adj)
 offcenter (um)
 off chance
 offcolor (um)
 offday(s)
 off-duty (adj)
 offer(s), offered, offering
 offguard
 offhand
 off-hours
 officeholder(s)
 officer-in-alias
 officers club(s)
 officeseeker(s)
 office-seeking (um)
 officeworker(s)
 off-Hail
 off line (pred)
 offline (adj, adv, comp)
 off-load(s), offloaded, offloading
 off-lying (um)
 off-road (adj)
 off-season(s)
 offsets(s), offset, offsetting
 offshoot(s)
 offshore
 off-site (adj, adv)
 offstage
 off-the-record (um)
 off-the-shelf
 off-track
 but
 offtrack betting
 off year(s)
 oilfield
 but
 oil and gas fields
 oil-processing (um)
 oil-producing (um)
 oil-rich
 oil sands (n, um)
 oilseed(s)
 oil shale (n, um)
 oil slick(s)
 oilspill(s)
 oil-soaked (um)
 oil well(s)
 oil workers

- old-boys network(s)
 old-fashioned (um)
 old-guard (adj)
 old-line (adj)
 old-style (adj)
 oldtime
 Olympic Games
 Olympics
 Summer Olympics
 Winter Olympics
 ombudsman, ombudsmen (pf)
 on-and-off (um)
 on-again/off-again
 on board (pred)
 onboard (adj)
 once-impressive
 once-over
 one-half
 one-man (adj)
 one-man/one-vote (n, adj)
 one-on-one (adj, adv)
 oneself
 one-sided (um)
 one-time (adj, single instance)
 onetime (um, former)
 one up (adj)
 one-up(s), one-upped, one-upping
 one-upmanship
 one-way
 ongoing
 on line (pred)
 online (adj, comp)
 on-screen
 onshore
 on-site (adj)
 on-station (adj)
 onstream (um)
 on-the-job training
 on-time (adj)
 OPEC summit(s)
 open-air (adj)
 open-door (adj)
 open-ended (um)
 openhanded
 open-heart (adj)
 open house(s)
 open-market (adj)
 openminded
 open-ocean (adj)
 open pit(s) (n, um)
 open-sea (adj)
 open-source (adj)
 opium poppy field(s)
 but
 poppy field(s)
 opium poppy grower(s), opium poppy growing (n)
 opium-poppy-growing (um)
 optoelectronics
 orbit(s), orbited, orbiting (n, v)
 orbital
 orbiter(s)
 order-of-battle (um)
 ordinance(s) (law)
 ordnance (weapons)
 orthodox
 ostensible
 out (prefix, one word except with of)
 outfit(s), outfitted, outfitting
 outfitter(s)
 outmigration(s)
 outnumbered
 out-of-area (um)
 out-of-date (um)
 out-of-pocket (um)
 out-of-touch (um)
 out patient(s) (n, um)
 outermost
 over (cf, one word)
 Exception: over-snow vehicle(s)
 overflow(s), overflowed, overflowing (n, adj, v)
 overhead(s) (all senses)
 overland radar(s)
 overlap(s), overlapping, overlapped
 overnight

overreaching
 overreact(s), overreacted, overreacting
 overstaff(s)
 overwrite(s), overwrote, overwriting
 ozone-depleting (um)

P

pacemaker(s)
 pace-setting (um)
 Pacific Rim
 page proof(s)
 painstaking
 palate(s) (roof of mouth)
 palette(s) (range of colors, paint mixing tray)
 palisade(s)
 pallet(s) (bed, platform)
 pan (cf. one word except with uppercase words, and then uppercase P)
 panchromatic
 pannational
 pantheism
 Pan-American
 Pan-Slavic
 pandemic(s)
 panic buying
 papacy, papacies (pt)
 paper
 papermaker(s)
 papermaking
 permit(s)
 paperwork
 paragraph 12
 parallel(s), paralleled, paralleling (n, v)
 parallel processing
 paralysis, paralyzes (pt)
 paralyze(s), paralyzed, paralyzing
 paraphernalia
 parastatal (state administered)
 parcel(s), parceled, parcelling (n, v)
 parenthesis, parentheses (pt)
 per excellence
 Paris accords
 parkland(s)
 particle beam weapon(s)
 partisan(s) (n, adj)
 part owner(s)
 part-time (adv, adj)
 part way
 party giver(s)
 party goer(s)
 party line(s)
 partywide
 passageway(s)
 passenger car(s)
 passer(s)-by
 passport(s)
 pass(es) through, passed through,
 passing through
 passthrough(s) (n, adj)
 password(s)
 past-due (um)
 pastureland(s)
 pathbreaker(s)
 pathfinder(s)
 patrol(s), patrolled, patrolling (n, v)
 pay(s) back, paid back, paying back
 payback(s) (n)
 paycheck(s)
 payload(s)
 pay(s) off, paid off, paying off
 payoff(s) (n, um)
 payroll(s)
 peacekeeping
 peace-loving (um)
 peacemaking
 peace talks
 peacetime(s)
 pedal(s), pedaled, pedaling (n, v)
 pending (yet to come or not yet settled)
 peninsularwide
 pen name(s)

pent-up (um)
 petal(s)
 per capita
 percent(s)
 percentage(s)
 percentile(s)
 perceptible
 per diem
 peremptory
 perestroika
 permafrost
 Permanent Representative(s) to the UN
 Permanent Five (in UNSC)
 permissible
 permit(s), permitted, permitting (n, v)
 perquisite(s) (privilege; see *prerequisite*)
 per se
 Persian Gulf state(s)
 Persian Gulf war (Gulf war)
 persistent
 personal (of the individual)
 persona non grata, personae non gratae (pl)
 personnel (staff)
 perspective(s) (view; see *prospective*)
 persuadable
 persuasible
 petro (cf. usually one word)
 petrodollars
 but
 petro-occipital
 phased-array (adj)
 phase(s) down, phased down, phasing down
 phasedown(s) (n, um)
 phase(s) in, phased in, phasing in
 phasein(s) (n, um)
 phase(s) out, phased out, phasing out
 phaseout(s) (n, um)
 Ph.D.(s)
 phenomenon, phenomena (pl)
 Philippines, the (n)
 phone-in (um)
 photo (cf. usually one word)
 photocopy, photocopies (pl)
 photomap(s)
 photorecognition satellite(s)
 but
 photo allies(es)
 photo-offset(s)
 photo-oxidation
 picayune
 picket line(s)
 pick-me-ups
 pickpocket(s)
 pick(s) up, picked up, picking up
 pickup (n, um)
 picnicking
 piece goods
 piecemeal
 piece rate(s)
 piecework(s)
 pieceworker(s)
 piggyback
 piledriver(s)
 pinpoint(s), pinpointed, pinpointing (n, v, adj)
 pinstripe(s)
 pin-striped
 pipe bomb(s)
 pipedream(s)
 pipefitting(s)
 pipelaying
 pipeline(s)
 pipe smoker(s)
 place name(s)
 plainclothes
 plainclothesman, plainclothesmen (pl)
 plain-spoken (um)
 plaintext
 planeload(s)
 plantlife
 plaster of Paris
 plateau(s)
 plate glass
 plausible
 playboy(s)
 plea-bargain(s), plea-bargained, plea-bargaining
 (n, um, v)

plenum(s)	posttreatment
PLO Chairman	posttreaty
plowshare(s)	but
plug-in (n, um)	post-9/11 (adj)
plus or minus (adj, adv)	post bellum
p.m.	post-civil-war (um)
pock-marked (um)	post-target-tracking
pointblank	postcard(s)
point man, point man (pl)	potbelled
police (always plural)	potboiler(s)
polycymaker(s)	potluck
polycymaking (spell as two words when accompanying adjective modifies only policy as in economic policy making—but <i>unauthorized</i> <i>polycymaking</i>)	potpourri(s)
politicizing	potshot(s)
politico (cf, usually one word) but politico-orthodox	poultryman, poultrymen (pl)
politics (always singular)	poultry-raising (um)
pollwatcher(s)	poverty-stricken
poor-quality (adj)	power base(s)
poppyfield(s) but opium poppy field(s)	power breakfast(s)
poppy grower(s), poppy growing (n)	power broker(s)
poppy-growing (um)	power-driven (um)
poppyseed(s)	power-generating (um)
popular-front (adj)	power grab(s)
populate(s), populated, populating	power grid(s)
popup(s) (n, um)	powerhouse(s)
park-barrel (adj)	powerline(s)
portentous	power plant(s)
porthole(s)	power play(s)
portside	power-projection (adj)
post (pref, usually one word) postattack postboost postcoup postgraduate posthaste postmortem postmortem postmortem posttest	power-sharing (n)
	power-sharing (um)
	power station(s)
	practice(s), practiced, practicing (n, v)
	praiseworthiness
	praiseworthy
	pre (pref, usually one word) predelente preelection preexisting preindependence premed (adj) prewar but pre-flight test (um) pre Incan

- pro-position(s), pre-positioned, pre-positioning
(position in advance)
pre-marital-law
- precede(s), preceded, preceding (go ahead of)
- precedence (priority)
- precedents (prior instances)
- precis (sing. pl)
- precision-guided missile(s) (PGM)
- predilection(s)
- predominant (adj)
- predominate(s), predominated, predominating
- preempt(s), preempted, preempting
- prefer(s), preferred, preferring
- preferable
- preference(s)
- prerequisite(s) (need; see *perquisite*)
- present-day (adj)
- presidential (now-US)
- Presidential (US; see footnote 8)
- presidential guard(s)
- president(s)-elect
- President-elect (US)
- press agent(s)
- press-gang(s), press-ganged, press-gangling (n, v)
- prestige(s)
- prevaricate(s), prevaricated, prevaricating
- price-sharing (um)
- prima donna behavior
- prima facie
- prime minister(s)
- prime-minister-designate (general sense)
but
the Prime Minister-designate
- prime-ministerial
- prime-ministership(s)
- prime-ministry, prime-ministries (pl)
- prime mover(s)
- prime-time (adj)
- principal (sum of money, chief)
- principle(s) (proposition)
- printout(s)
- printshop(s)
- prisoner(s) of war (n)
- prisoner-of-war (um)
- private-sector (adj)
- privilege(s)
- prizewinner(s)
but
Nobel Prize winner
- prizewinning
- pro (as a prefix meaning "in favor of,"
generally one word)
proactive
proapathoid
procedural
progovernment
properform
proregime
prover
but
pro-African
pro-arms-control (um)
pro-free-market (um)
pro-free-trade
pro-ruling-party
Note: When used as part of a Latin phrase, *pro*
stands alone and is not hyphenated.
pro forma
pro rata
pro tem
pro tempore
- problem solver(s)
- problem-solving (um)
- proceed(s), proceeded, proceeding (n, v)
- processable
- producible
- production-sharing (um)
- proffer(s), proffered, proffering
- profit(s), profited, profiting (n, v)
- profitable
- profit-and-loss (un')
- profitmaking
- profit-sharing (um)
- program(s), programmed, programming (n, v)
- programmable
- programmatic
- programmer(s)

prologue(s)
 proofread(s), proofread, proofreading
 propel(s), propelled, propelling
 propellant(s)
 prophecy, prophecies (n)
 prophet(s)
 prophesy, prophesies, prophesied, prophesying
 propjet(s)
 prospective (anticipated, see *perspective*)
 protégé(s)
 protester(s)
 protocol(s)
 prove(s), proved, proving
 proved (adj, for energy reserves only)
 proven (adj, except energy reserves)
 proviso(s)
 pseudo (cf, usually one word;
 but
 pseudo-Messiah
 pseudo-official
 pseudo-peace-loving
 publicity-conscious (um)
 public-sector (adj)
 public-spirited (um)
 public works
 pullback(s) (n, um)
 pullout(s) (n, um)
 pulsed Doppler effect
 pulse-Doppler
 pulsewidth(s)
 pummel(s), pummeled, pummeling
 pump house(s)
 pump-priming (um)
 pump station(s)
 purse strings
 pushover(s) (n, um)
 pushup(s) (n, um)
 put-on(s) (n, um)
 put-up(s) (n, um)

Q

quality-of-life (um)
 quarrel(s), quarreled, quarreling
 quarterdeck(s)
 quartermaster(s)
 quadripartite
 quasi (pref, all hyphenated)
 Note: quasi can also be a separate adj.
 quasi currency board
 questionnaire(s)
 queue(s)
 quick-count polling
 quick fix(es)
 quick-reaction (adj)
 quicksilver (n, adj)
 quick time
 quick-witted (um)
 quid pro quo(s)
 quitclaim(s)

R

rabble-rouser(s)
 racehorse(s)
 racetrack(s)
 rack(s), racked, racking (n, v: see *wrack*)
 radar-absorbing (um)
 radar-cross-section(s)
 radar tracking
 radio (cf, usually one word)
 radioactive
 radiobroadcast(s)
 radioelectronics (n, adj)
 radiofrequency, radiofrequencies
 radioisotope(s)
 radioteletype(s)
 radiotelephone(s)
 but
 radio amplifier(s)
 radio antenna(s)
 radio-cassette(s)

radio channel(s)	RAM (random-access memory, read/write memory)
radio communication(s)	Ramadan
radio control(s)	ramjet(s)
radio engineer(s)	ramrock(s)
radio engineering	ramshackle
radio link(s)	rangefinder(s)
radio navigation	rangehead(s)
radio range(s)	range rate(s) (n)
radio receiver(s)	range-rate (adj)
radio relay(s)	rank and file (n)
radio set(s)	rank-and-file (adj)
radio station(s)	rapid fire (n)
radio transmitter(s)	rapid-fire (adj)
radio tube(s)	rapid transit
radio wave(s)	rapid-reaction (adj)
radius, radii (pl)	rapid-response (adj)
rag-tag	rappoteur(s)
raiborne	rapprochement(s)
raider(s)	rare-earth (um)
railehead(s)	rate-cutting (um)
rail line(s)	rate-fixing (um)
rail-mobile (um)	ratesetting
rail net(s)	rat-infested (um)
railroad(s)	ratline(s)
railroader(s)	rat race(s)
rail shed(s)	ravels, raveled, raveling
rail spur(s)	razor-sharp (um)
rail train(s)	re (pref, usually one word)
railway(s)	realign(s), realigned, realigning
railwayman, railwaymen (pl)	redirect(s), redirected, redirecting
railyard(s)	reemerge(s), reemerged, reemerging
raincheck(s)	reenter(s), reentered, reentering
rainfall(s)	reentry, reentries (pl)
rain-fed (um)	reequip(s), reequipped, reequipping
rain forest(s) (n)	reestablish(es), reestablished, reestablishing
rainforest (um)	reevaluate(s), reevaluated, reevaluating
rainmaking	reexport(s), reexported, reexporting
rainshower(s)	reformat(s), reformatted, reformatting
rainspout(s)	refuel(s), refueled, refueling
rainstorm(s)	reignite(s), reignited, reigniting
raintight	reinforce(s), reinforced, reinforcing
rainwater	remain(s), remained, remaining
raison(s) d'être	reinstato(s), reinstated, reinstating
	reinvent(s), reinvented, reinventing

- reprocess(s), reprocessed, reprocessing
reuse(s), reused, reusing
but
re-cover(s), re-covered, re-covering (cover again)
re-create(s), re-created, re-creating (create again)
re-cross examination
re-form(s), re-formed, re-forming (form again)
re-ice(s), re-iced, re-icing
re-link(s), re-linked, re-linking
re-present(s), re-presented, re-presenting
(present again)
re-redirect(s), re-redirected, re-redirecting
re-treat(s), re-treated, re-treating (treat again)
- readout(s)**
ready-built (um)
readymade
ready reference(s)
real estate (n, um)
realpolitik
real-time (adj)
rear area(s) (n, um)
rear end(s)
rear-guard (adj)
rear service(s)
rear services area
rebel(s), rebelled, rebelling
rebut(s), rebutted, rebutting (to argue to the contrary; see *refute*)
recently designed logo(s)
receptacle(s)
recoinnaisance(s)
reconnoter(s), reconnotted, reconnotering
recordbreaking
recordkeeping
recordmaking
red, redder, reddened, reddening
red-blooded (um)
red-carpet (adj)
red-haired (um)
redhanded
redhead(s)
redheaded
red-hot (um)
redound(s), redounded, redounding
red tape(s) (literar)
redtape (nonliteral)
reduced-observable(s) (n, adj)
redurable(s)
refer(s), referred, referring
referable
reference(s), referenced, referencing (n, v)
referendum(s)
reform-minded
refute(s), refuted, refuting (connotes success in winning the argument; see *rebut*)
regionwide
reign(s), reigned, reigning (n, v, to exercise sovereign power)
rein(s), reined, reigning (n, v; to guide, to control, or— with in—to hold back)
relations with
relevant
reluctant (unwilling to act; see *reticent*)
reminiscent
remit(s), remitted, remitting
remote-control (adj)
remote-controlled
remote-sensing (um)
renaissance(s)
but
the Renaissance
Renaissance man, Renaissance men (pl)
rent-free
repalman, repalmen (pl)
replication(s)
reprehensible
Representative(s) (US Congress)
representative(s) at large
representative(s)-elect
republicwide
requester(s)
research study, research studies (p)
Resident(s) (diplomatic)
residence(s)
resilience
resilient

resistance
 resistant
 rest cure(s)
 rest home(s)
 restroom(s)
 resume(s), resumed, resuming
 reticent (uncommunicative or reserved,
 see reluctant)
 retrofit
 retrofit(s), retrofitted, retrofitting
 retrorocket(s)
 Reuters (news agency)
 reverse-engineer(s), reverse-engineered,
 reverse-engineering
 reversible
 revise(s), revised, revising
 Revolutionary Guard (force or members)
 ricefield(s)
 rice growing (n)
 riceband(s)
 ridge line(s)
 rifleman, riflemen (pl)
 right-angled (um)
 right away
 right-hand (adj)
 right-handed (um)
 right(s)-of-way
 right-to-work (adj)
 right turn(s)
 right wing(s)
 rightwing (adj)
 rightwinger(s)
 ringleader(s)
 ring-shaped (um)
 ringside(s)
 ringworm
 riot-control (adj)
 riptide(s)
 rise(s), rose, rising (n, v)
 risk taker(s)
 risk taking
 rivals(s), rivaled, rivaling
 riverbank(s)
 riverbed(s)
 riverbombs
 river bottom(s)
 river-crossing
 riverfront(s)
 riverside(s)
 roadbed(s)
 roadblock(s)
 roadbuilding
 road-cleaning (um)
 roadmap(s)
 road-mobile (um)
 road scraper(s)
 road show(s)
 roadside(s)
 road-test(s), road-tested, road-testing (n, v)
 roadway(s)
 road-weary (um)
 rob(s), robbed, robbing
 rockbottom (nonliteral)
 rockslide(s)
 rock wool
 rogue state(s)
 rollback(s) (n, um)
 rolleall(s)
 rolling-stock (adj)
 roll-on/roll-off (um, of ships)
 Ro/Ro (military) or ro/ro
 roll(s) out, rolled out, rolling out
 rollout (n, um)
 rollout-to-launch (um, of weapons)
 rollover(s) (n, um)
 roll(s) up, rolled up, rolling up
 roll-up (n, um)
 ROM (read-only memory)
 rooftop(s)
 rough-and-ready (um)
 rough-and-tumble (n, adj)
 roughest (um, v)

rough-faced (um)
 roughhewn
 roughhouse(s), roughhoused, roughhousing (n, v)
 roughneck(s) (n, adj)
 roughrider(s)
 rough-sketch(es), rough-sketched,
 rough-sketching (n, v)
 roundabout(s) (n, um)
 round robin(s) (petition)
 roundtable(s) (panel)
 round-the-clock
 round-topped
 round trip(s) (n, um)
 round(s) up, rounded up, rounding up
 roundup (n, um)
 rubbernecker(s)
 rubber plant(s)
 rubber stamp(s) (literal, n)
 rubberstamp(s), rubberstamped, rubberstamping
 (nonliteral, n, um, v)
 rubber-stamped (literal, um)
 rubles* (pl possessive)
 rulemaking
 rule(s) of thumb
 rules-of-origin
 ruling-family (adj)
 ruling-party (adj)
 rumormonger(s)
 runaround(s) (n, adj)
 runaway(s) (n, adj)
 rundown(s) (n, um)
 run(s) in, ran in, running in
 run-in(s) (n, um)
 runner-up, runners-up (pl)
 running mate(s)
 runoff(s) (n, um)
 runthrough(s) (n, um)
 run(s) up, ran up, running up
 runup(s) (n, um)
 runway
 rush hour(s)

Russian Far East
 rustproofing
 rust-resistant (um)

S

saber rattling(s) (n)
 saber-rattling (um)
 saddle stitch(es) (n)
 saddle-stitch(es), saddle-stitched,
 saddle-stitching
 saddle-stitched (um)
 safe-conduct(s) (n, adj)
 safecracking
 safe-deposit (adj)
 safeguard(s), safeguarded, safeguarding (n, v)
 safe haven(s)
 safehouse(s)
 safehouse keeper(s)
 safehouse keeping
 safekeeping
 sailboat(s)
 sailcloth(s)
 sailmaking
 salable
 salesmanship
 salesperson, salespeople (pl)
 sales tax(es)
 SALT (strategic arms limitation talks)
 salt flat(s)
 saltwater(s)
 salvo(s)
 samizdat(s)
 samurai
 San Andreas Fault
 sanatorium(s)
 sandbag(s), sandbagged, sandbagging (n, v)
 sandbank(s)
 sandbar(s)
 sandblast(s), sandblasted, sandblasting (n, v)

sand dune(s)	scorched-earth (adj)
Sandinista(s)	scoreboard(s)
sandpaper(s), sandpapered, sandpapering (n, v)	scorecard(s)
sandstorm(s)	scorekeeping
sandy-bottomed (um)	scoot-free
sanguinary (bloodthirsty)	Scotsman, Scotsmen (pl)
sanguine (ruddy or optimistic and cheerful)	scoot car(s)
santarium(s)	scrapbook(s)
satellite(s)	scrap heap(s)
satellite-borne (um)	scrap iron
sawmill(s)	scrap paper(s)
saw-toothed (um)	scrapyard(s)
say-so (n)	scratch pad(s)
scale(s) up, scaled up, scaling up	scratch test(s)
scaleup(s) (n)	screw-driven (um)
scale(s) back, scaled back, scaling back	screw propeller(s)
scandalmongering	screw-threaded (um)
scapegoat(s)	screw wheel(s)
scaremonger(s)	scrubland(s)
scareproof	scuba
scatterbrained	Scud B(s)
scene setter(s)	scuttlebutt
school-age (adj)	sea
school board(s)	sea based (um;
schoolbook(s)	snabed(s)
schoolboy(s)	seaboard(s)
schoolbus(es)	seaborne
schoolchildren	seacoast(s)
school day(s)	seacraft
schoolgirl(s)	seafaring
school grounds	seafloor(s)
schoolhouse(s)	seafood(s)
schoolroom(s)	seagoing
schools of thought	seakeeping
schoolteacher(s)	sea lane(s)
but	sea-launched cruise missile(s) (SLCM)
high school teacher	sea level
school-trained (um)	sea life
schoolwork	sealift(s), seafifted, seallifting (n, v)
schoolyard(s)	sea lines of communication (SLOC)
school year(s)	sealion(s)
	seaplane(s)
	seaport(s)
	seapower
	sea route(s)
	seashore(s)
	seasick

seaside(s)
 sea test(s), sea tested, sea testing (n, v)
 seawat (s)
 seaward
 seawater
 seaway(s)
 seaworthy

search-and-destroy (vm)

search engine(s)

searchlight(s)

searchplane(s)

seabird(s)

second

second-best (um)
 second-class (adj)
 second-degree (adj)
 second-generation (adj)
 second-guess(es)
 second-guessed
 second-guessing (v)
 second half (adj)
 second hand(s) (n)
 secondhand (adv, adj)
 second in command
 second-largest (adj)
 second-leading (um)
 second-most
 but
 second-most-powerful (um)
 second-quarter (adj)
 second-ranking (um)
 second-rate
 second-rater(s)
 second-tier (um)

Second World War

secretary general, secretaries general (pl)

secretary-generalship

secretaryship(s)

secretary-treasurer

secret service(s)

secret society, secret societies (pl)

secretwriting

security decisionmaking

seesaw(s), seesawed, seesawing (n, adj, v)

seize(s), seized, seizing

self (reflexive prefix, use hyphen)

self-motivated

self-trained

selfless

selfsame

sell(s) off, sold off, selling off

selloff(s) (n, adj)

sellout(s) (n, um)

semi (pref, usually one word)

semiannually (twice a year; use in preference to biannually, see also biennially)

semaid

semidesert

semiofficial

se-tuweekly (twice a week; see biweekly)

but

semi-armor-piercing

semi-Christian

semi-kilness

semi-independent

semi-indirect

semi-land-mobile

semi-winter-hardy

Senator(s) (US Congress)

sendoff(s) (n, um)

separate(s), separated, separating

Serbo-Croatian

serious-minded (um)

serviceable

service-connected (um)

serviceman, servicemen (pl)

servicewide

servicewoman, servicewomen (pl)

servomechanism(s)

set(s) back, set back, setting back

setback(s) (n, um)

set(s) down, set down, setting down

setdown(s) (n, um)

set(s) in, set in, setting in

set-in(s) (n, um)

set(s) off, set off, setting off

setoff(s) (n, um)

setpiece(s)

set-to(s) (n, um)

set(s) up, set up, setting up

setup(s) (n, um)

sevenfold	partnership(s)
severalfold	premiership(s)
shadowbox(es), shadowboxed, shadowboxing	prime-ministership(s)
shake(s) down, shook down, shaking down	shipboard
shakedown(s) (n, um)	shipborne
shake(s) out, shook out, shaking out	shipbuilder(s)
shakeout(s) (n, um)	shipbuilding
shake(s) up, shook up, shaking up	ship-day(s)
shakeup(s) (n, um)	shipload(s)
shallow-draft (adj)	shipowner(s)
shamefaced	shipowning
shameworthy	shipshape
shantytown(s)	shipwreck(s), shipwrecked, shipwrecking (n, v)
shaped-charge (adj, of warheads)	shipyard(s)
sharcropper(s)	shock wave(s)
shareholder(s)	shogun(s)
sharia	shoo-in(s)
sharp-angled (um)	shoot(s) down, shot down, shooting down
sharp-edged (um)	shootdown(s) (n)
sharpshooting	shootout(s)
sharp-witted (um)	shopkeeping
shaykh(s)	shoplift(s), shoplifted, shoplifting (n, v)
sheep farm(s)	shopowner(s)
sheepherder(s)	shoplark
sheepherding	shopworn
sheepkeeping	shoreland(s)
sheep(s)and(s)	shore leave(s)
sheepshearing	shoreline(s)
sheepskin(s)	shortchange(s), shortchanged, shortchanging
sheet metal(s)	short circuit (n)
shelf life, shelf lives (pl)	short-circuit(s), short-circuited, short-circuiting
shelf plate(s)	short-circuited (um)
shellburst(s)	shortcoming(s)
shellfish	shortcut (n, adj, v)
shell game(s)	shortfall(s)
shellhole(s)	shorthand (writing)
shell-like	short-handed (um)
shellproof	short-lived (um)
shellshocked	short-range (adj)
sherpa(s)	short run(s) (n)
ship (suffix, usually one word)	shortrun (um)

shortsighted
 short-term (adj)
 short-to-long (adj)
 short-to-long-range (adj)
 shortwave(s) (n, adj; radio)
 shoulder-launched (um)
 showcase(s)
 showdown(s)
 showman, showmen (pl)
 showoff(s) (n, um)
 showpiece(s)
 shure
 shut(s) down, shut down, shutting down
 shutdown(s) (n, um)
 shut(s), shut in, shutting in
 shut-in(s) (n, um)
 shut(s) off, shut off, shutting off
 shutoff(s) (n, um)
 shut(s) out, shut out, shutting out
 shutout(s) (n, um)
 sickbay(s)
 sickbed(s)
 sick leave
 sidearm(s)
 sidebar(s)
 side effect(s)
 side line(s) (literal)
 sideline(s), sidelined, sidelining (nonliteral; n, v)
 side lobe(s)
 side road(s)
 side-scan radar
 sideshow(s)
 sidestep(s), sidestepped, sidestepping (n, v)
 sideswipe(s), sideswiped, sideswiping (n, v)
 sidetrack(s), sidetracked, sidetracking (n, v)
 sidelnip(s)
 sidewalk(s)
 sideways
 siege(s)
 sightreading
 sightseeing
 sightsee(s), sightsaw, sightseeing
 sightseer(s)
 SINGINT
 signal(s), signaled, signaling (n, v)
 signaler(s)
 signaller, signallmen (pl)
 signal-processing (um)
 signal tower(s)
 sign(s) off, signed off, signing off
 signoff(s) (n, um)
 sign(s) on, signed on, signing on
 sign-on(s) (n, um)
 signpost(s), signposted, signposting (n, v)
 sign(s) up, signed up, signing up (n, v)
 signup(s) (n, um)
 silk screen(s), silk screened, silk screening (n, v)
 silkworm(s)
 silo-based (um)
 silver-gray (um)
 silver-haired (um)
 silver-tongued (um)
 silverworker(s)
 simon-pure (um)
 simple-minded (um)
 simple-witted (um)
 simulcast(s), simulcast, simulcasting (n, v)
 sine qua non(s)
 single-handed (um)
 single-handedly (adv)
 single-minded (um)
 single-mindedly (adv)
 single-mindedness
 single-most-important (um)
 single-seat (adj)
 single-source (adj)
 single-track (adj)
 single warhead
 Sino- (as prefix)
 siphon(s)
 sister(s)-in-law
 sitdown(s) (n, um)

alt(a) in, sat in, sitting in
 alt-in(a) (n, um)
 Six-Day War
 sizable
 ski(s), skied, skiing (n, v)
 skillful
 skindieep
 skinhead(s)
 skyjack(s), skyjacked, skyjacking
 skyjacker(s)
 skyjacking(s) (n, adj)
 skylight(s)
 skyline(s)
 skyrocket(s), skyrocketed, skyrocketing (n, v)
 skyscraper(s)
 skyward
 skywriting
 slaughterhouse(s)
 slaveholding
 slaveowner(s)
 slave trade
 SLBM(s) (submarine-launched ballistic missile)
 SLCM(s) (sea-launched cruise missile)
 sledge hammer(s)
 sleepwalk(s), sleepwalked, sleepwalking (n, v)
 sleetstorm(s)
 slide rule(s)
 slip(s) up, slipped up, slipping up
 slip-up(s) (n, um)
 SLOC (sea lines of communication)
 slowdown(s) (n, um)
 slowgoing
 slow-motion (adj)
 slow-moving (um)
 slowpoke(s)
 slow time(s)
 slowup(s) (n, um)
 slow-witted (um)
 sluice gate(s)
 skunkwaller(s)
 skunkford(s)
 small arms (n)
 small-arms (adj)
 small business(es)
 small businessman, small businessmen (pl)
 smallpox
 small-scale (adj)
 smalltalk
 small-time (adj)
 small-timer(s)
 small-to-moderate (um)
 smalltown (um)
 small-unit (adj)
 smart stack(s)
 smart-sticky (um)
 smart-looking (um)
 smart set(s)
 smashup(s) (n, um)
 smear culture(s)
 smokebomb(s)
 smoke-filled (um)
 smokeproof
 smokescreen(s)
 smokestack(s)
 smolder(s), smoldered, smoldering
 smoothbore(s) (n, adj)
 smooth-tongued (um)
 smooth-working (um)
 smudge pot(s)
 snail-paced
 snail's pace
 snowball(s)
 snowbank(s)
 snowbound
 snowcapped
 snow cover(s)
 snow-covered (um)
 snowcraft
 snowdrift(s)
 snowfall(s)
 snowline(s)
 snowmobile(s)

- snowshoe(s)
 snowstorm(s)
 snow-topped (um)
 snow-white (um)
 soapbox(es)
 soap opera(s)
 sober-minded (um)
 sobersided
 sob story, sob stories (pl)
 so-called (um)
 social work
 social worker(s)
 socio (cf. usually one word)
 socioeconomic
 but
 socio-official
 soft coal
 soft copy, soft copies (pf) (n)
 soft-copy (adj)
 soft drink(s) (n, um)
 soft goods
 softhearted
 soft-pedal(s), soft-pedaled, soft-pedaling (v)
 soft-soap(s), soft-soaped, soft-soaping
 (v, nonliteral)
 soft-spoken (um)
 software
 Solidarity (Poland)
 solid-propellant (adj)
 solid rocket propellant(s)
 solid-state (adj)
 solo(s)
 somebody (pronoun)
 somebody, somebodies (pl) (n)
 someday
 somehow
 someone (anyone)
 some one (distributive)
 someplace (adv)
 something
 some time (n, an unspecified time)
 sometime (adj, occasionally adv, at an
 unspecified time)
- sometimes (adv, occasionally)
 somewhat
 somewhere
 son(s)-in-law
 sonobuoy(s)
 soon-to-be- (um, often prefixed)
 sore point(s)
 sorry-looking (um)
 soulmate(s)
 soul-searching (um)
 sound-absorbing (um)
 soundingboard(s)
 sound-minded (um)
 soundoff(s) (n, um)
 soundproof(s), soundproofed, soundproofing
 (adj, v)
 sound wave(s)
 surfaced
 sour-natured (um)
 sous-sherpa(s)
 southbound
 south-central
 southeast
 southeast-bound (um)
 south end(s)
 south side(s)
 south-southeast
 southward
 southwest
 soybean(s)
 space age
 space-based (um)
 spaceborne
 spacecraft
 spaceflight(s)
 space key(s)
 space launch site(s) (n, um)
 space mine(s)
 space plane(s)
 spaceship(s)
 space station(s)

space suit(s)	split(s) up, split up, splitting up
space tracking (n, um)	splitup(s) (n, um)
space walk(s)	spoilsport(s)
spam(s), spammed, spamming (n, v)	spokesperson(s) (spokespeople all pl)
Spanish American	sports bar(s)
Spanish-born (um)	sportsmanlike
Spanish-speaking (um)	spot check(s) (n)
spare-parts (adj)	spot-check(s), spot-checked, spot-checking
spark plug(s)	spreadsheet(s)
special envoy(s)	spring(s) (season)
special-forces (adj)	springboard(s)
special-interest (adj)	spring fever
special-purpose (adj)	springtime(s)
Special Weapons and Tactics (SWAT)	spur line(s)
specter(s)	square-bottomed (um)
spectrum, spectra (pl)	square deal(s)
speechwriter(s)	square meter(s)
speechwriting	square root(s)
speedboat(s)	squeeze play(s)
speedwriting	SRF (Strategic Rocket Forces)
spellbind(s), spellbound, spellbinding	SS-7(s)
spellbinder(s)	SSB(s) (ballistic missile submarine)
spell check(s), spell checked, spell checking	SSBN(s) (nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine)
spell checker(s)	SS-N-4(s)
spendthrift(s)	S&T (science and technology)
spent-fuel (adj)	stadium(s)
spent nuclear fuel reprocessing plant(s)	stage-manage(s), stage-managed, state-managing
spill(s) over, spilled over, spilling over	stairstep (adj)
spillover(s) (n, um)	stalemate(s), stalemated, stalemating (n, v)
spillway(s)	stalking-horse(s)
spin doctor(s), spin-doctored, spin-doctoring (n, v)	stanch(es), stanch(ed), stanching (v, stop, especially with regard to a heavy outflow; see stanch)
spin control	stand(s) alone, stood alone, standing alone
spin(s) off, spun off, spinning off	stand-alone(s) (n, adj)
spinoff(s) (n, um)	standard bearer(s)
spin(s) up, spun up, spinning up	standard gauge(s) (n)
spinup(s) (n, um)	standard-gauge (adj)
splash(es) down, splashed down, splashing down	standard time(s)
splashdown(s) (n, um)	stand(s) by, stood by, standing by
split second (n)	standby(s) (n, um)
split-second (adj)	

stand(s) down, stood down, standing down
 standdown(s) (n, um)
 stand(s) fast, stood fast, standing fast
 standfast(s) (n, um)
 stand(s) in, stood in, standing in
 stand-in(s) (n, um)
 standing-room-only (um)
 stand(s) off, stood off, standing off
 standoff(s) (n, um)
 standoffish
 stand(s) out, stood out, standing out
 standout(s) (n, um)
 stand(s) pat, stood pat, standing pat
 standpat(s) (n)
 standpatter(s)
 standpoint(s)
 stand(s) still, stood still, standing still
 standstill(s) (n, um)
 stand(s) up, stood up, standing up
 standup(s) (n, um)
 starboard
 star-spangled (um)
 start(s) up, started up, starting up
 startup(s) (n, um)
 state banking system(s)
 state enterprise industrial sector(s)
 state enterprise sector(s)
 statehood
 state of the art (n)
 state-of-the-art (adj)
 state of the union
 state of war (n)
 state-of-war (adj)
 stateroom(s)
 state-run (um)
 statesman, statesman (pl)
 statesmanlike
 stateswoman, stateswomen (pl)
 statewide
 stationary (fixed)
 stationery, stationeries (pl) (paper)

stationmaster(s)
 station wagon(s)
 Status of Forces Agreement (SOFA)
 status quo
 statute book(s)
 statute mile(s)
 staunch (adj) steadfast; see stanch
 stay-at-home(s) (n, adj)
 staybehind(s) (n)
 stealth
 stealth bomber(s)
 stealth technology, stealth technologies (pl)
 steamboat(s)
 steam-driven (um)
 steam engine(s)
 steamer-borne (um)
 steamer line(s)
 steamfitting
 steam heat
 steampipe(s)
 steam-propelled (um)
 steamroller(s), steamrollered, steamrollering
 (n, um, v)
 steamship(s)
 steelhearted
 steelmaking
 steel mill(s)
 steel-producing (um)
 steel trading
 steel wool
 steelworker(s)
 steelworks
 stepbrother(s)
 stepchild, stepchildren (pl)
 steppingstone(s)
 stepsister(s)
 step(s) up, stepped up, stepping up
 step-up(s) (n, um)
 stick-in-the-mud(s) (nonliteral)
 stick-to-it-iveness
 stubborn

still life(s)
 still-linger (um)
 still-to-be- (um, often prefixed)
 still-unsealed (um)
 stimulus, stimuli (pl)
 stockholder(s)
 stock-in-trade
 stock market(s) (n, um)
 stockpile(s), stockpiled, stockpiling (n, v)
 stockraising
 stock-still (uni)
 stocktaking(s)
 stockyard(s)
 stone-cold (um)
 stonecutting
 stone-deaf (um)
 stonehearted
 stone wall(s) (n)
 stonewall(s), stonewalled, stonewalling
 (v, nonliteral)
 stopgap(s)
 stoplight(s)
 stop(s) off, stopped off, stopping off
 stopoff(s) (n, adj)
 stop(s) over, stopped over, stopping over
 stopover(s) (n, adj)
 stopwatch(es)
 storefront(s)
 storeowner(s)
 storm-swept (um)
 storytelling(s)
 storywriting
 stouthearted
 stow(s) away, stowed away, stowing away
 stowaway(s) (n, um)
 straightaway
 straight face(s)
 straight-faced (um)
 straightforward
 straight line(s)
 straight shooter(s)
 straight-shooting (um)
 straight-spoken (um)
 straight-talker(s)
 straight-talking (um)
 straitjacket(s)
 straitlaced
 stranglehold(s)
 straphanger(s)
 strap(s) on, strapped on, strapping on
 strap-on (n, adj)
 stratagem(s)
 Strategic Rocket Forces (SRF)
 stratum, strata (pl)
 strawman, strawmen (pl) (nonliteral)
 straw vote(s)
 streambed(s)
 streamline(s), streamlined, streamlining
 streetcar(s)
 streetsmart (adj)
 street smarts (n)
 streetwise
 stretchout(s) (n, um)
 strikebreaker(s)
 strike(s) out, struck out, striking out
 strikeout(s) (n, um)
 strike(s) over, struck over, striking over
 strikeover(s) (n, um)
 strong-arm(s), strong-armed,
 strong-arming (um, v)
 strongbox(es)
 stronghearted
 stronghold(s)
 strongman, strongmen (pl) (nonliteral)
 strong-minded (um)
 strong point(s) (personal forte)
 strongpoint(s) (military fortification)
 strong-willed (um)
 stubbornness
 stumblingblock(s)
 stupid-looking (um)
 stylebook(s)

style guide(s)	can also be a separate word—in, or, informally.
style manual(s)	adj or adv)
Su-20(s)	superopolis(s)
sub (cf. usually one word)	superhighway(s)
substance(s)	superpower(s)
subbasement(s)	supermarket(s)
subbasin(s)	but
subchaser(s)	super-Christian
subcommittee(s)	super-high-frequency, super-high-frequencies
subcontinent(s)	(pl) (n, edj)
submachinegun(s)	super-superlative(s) (n, ad.)
submarginal	supersede(s), superseded, superseding
subpolar	superwise(s), supervised, supervising
substandard	supra (pref, usually one word)
subsystem(s)	supranational
subunit(s)	supranational
but	but
sub Himalayan	supra-abdominal
sub rosa	supra-Christian
Sub Saharan	sure-fire (adj)
sub-subcommittee(s)	sure-footed (um)
submarine-launched ballistic missile(s) (SLBM)	sure thing(s)
submit(s), submitted, submitting	surface-burst (adj)
subpoena(s)	surface ship(s) (n, um)
subtlety, subtleties (pl)	surface-to-air (um)
succeed(s), succeeded, succeeding	surge protector(s)
sudden-death (um)	surmise(s), surmised, surmising (n, v)
sugar beet(s)	surprise(s), surprised, surprising (n, v)
sugarcane(s)	surreptitious
sugar-coat(s), sugar-coated, sugar-coating	surveil(s), surveilled, surveilling
sugar-coated (um)	surveillance
sugar mill(s)	susceptible
sulfur (derivatives also spelled with f)	SWAT (Special Weapons and Tactics)
summer(s) (season)	sweepstakes(s)
summer school(s)	sweepback(s) (n, um)
summertime(s)	sweptwing(s) (n, um)
summit(s) (literal and nonliteral, initial letter not capitalized; example: DPEC summit)	swing shift(s)
sundown(s)	swingwing(s)
sun-dried (um)	switchblade(s)
sunlit	switchboard(s)
sunstroke(s)	switch box(es)
suntan(s), suntanned, suntanning (n, v)	switch(es) over, switched over, switching over
sunup(s)	switchover(s) (n)
super (pref, usually one word. Note that super	switch tower(s)
	switchyard(s)

syllabus(es)
 symposium(s)
 synonymous
 synopsis, synopses (pl)
 synthetic-aperture (adj, of radar)
 synup(s)
 system backup(s)
 systemwide (adj)

T

table A-4
 tableau(s)
 taboo(s)
 tailgate(s), tailgated, tailgating (n, v)
 tailor-made
 tailpipe(s)
 tailspin(s)
 Taiwan (n, adj)
 take(s) down, took down, taking down
 takedown(s) (n, um)
 take(s) home, took home, taking home
 take-home(s) (n, adj)
 take(s) off, took off, taking off
 takeoff(s) (n, um)
 take(s) out, took out, taking out
 takeout(s) (n, um)
 take(s) over, took over, taking over
 takeover(s) (n, um)
 take(s) up, took up, taking up
 takeup(s) (n, um)
 talabean(s)
 talemonger(s)
 talisteller(s)
 Taliban (takes singular verb)
 tamperproof
 tangle(s) (n, adj)
 tank(s) (lowercase, even after a proper
 title—Abrams tank)
 tank car(s)
 tape deck(s)
 tape-record(s), tape-recorded, tape-recording
 tape recorder(s)
 target(s), targeted, targeting
 targetable
 targeter(s)
 task force(s)
 taskmaster(s)
 tax collector(s)
 tax dodger(s)
 tax-exempt (um)
 tax form(s)
 tax-free (um)
 taxi(s)
 taxpaying
 tax-supported (um)
 teachers college (no apostrophe)
 teamplay
 teamplayer(s)
 teamwork
 tear(s) down, tore down, tearing down
 teardown(s) (n, um)
 teargas(es), teargassed, teargassing (n, v, um)
 teenage
 teenager(s)
 tele (cf. all one word)
 televise
 telltale(s) (n, adj)
 tendency, tendencies (pl)
 tenfold
 terminus, termini (pl)
 territorywide
 test bed(s)
 test case(s)
 test-fire(s), test-fired, test-firing
 test-fly, test-flies, test-flew, test-flown,
 test-flying
 test-jam(s), test-jammed, test-jamming
 test-launch(es), test-launched, test-launching
 test range(s)
 test site(s)
 test stand(s)

tele-a-tele(s)
 textbook(s)
 thanksgiving(s)
 but
 Thanksgiving Day
 thank-you(s) (n)
 theater(s)
 theatergoing
 theaterwide
 then Premier
 then-ruling (um)
 then second deputy minister
 then-troublesome (um)
 thereafter
 thereby
 therefor (fix it)
 therefore (for that reason)
 thereunder
 thereupon
 thesis, theses (pl)
 thickheaded
 thickskinned
 think factory, think factories (pl)
 think-piece(s)
 think tank(s)
 thinskinned
 third-class (adj)
 third-country (adj)
 third-degree (adj)
 thirdhand (adv, adj)
 third-order (adj)
 third-party (adj)
 third-quarter (adj)
 third-rate (adj)
 Third World countries
 thoroughbred(s) (n, adj)
 thoroughfare(s)
 thoroughgoing
 thought-provoking (um)
 threat-driven (um)
 three-dimensional (um)

threefold
 threesome(s)
 threshold(s)
 throughout
 throughput(s)
 through road(s)
 throughway(s)
 throw(s) away, threw away, thrown away, throwing
 away
 throwaway(s) (n, um)
 throw(s) back, threw back, throwing back
 throwback(s) (n, um)
 throw line(s)
 throw rope(s)
 throw weight(s) (n, um)
 thumbnail(s)
 thunderclap(s)
 thunderhead(s)
 thundershower(s)
 thunderstorm(s)
 Tiananmen Square
 ticketholder(s)
 ticket seller(s)
 tidal wave(s)
 tideland(s)
 tidetable(s)
 tidewater(s)
 tide-worm (um)
 tiebreaker(s)
 tie(s) in, tied in, tying in
 tie-in(s) (n, um)
 tie(s) to, tied to, tying to
 tie(s) up, tied up, tying up
 tieup(s) (n, um)
 tightlisted
 tight-knit (um)
 tightlipped
 tightrope(s)
 lightweight(s)
 timberland(s)
 time (suffix, often so-idi)

daytime	tone-deaf (um)
halftime	tone(s) up, toned up, toning up
peacetime	toneup(s) (n, um)
but	tongue-lash(es), tongue-lashed,
full-time	tongue-lashing (v)
part-time	tongue lashing(s) (n)
time being	tonguetied
time bomb(s)	tongue twister(s)
timeclock(s)	tongue-twisting (um)
time-consuming (um)	ton-kilometer
time-delay (adj)	toolbuilding
time frame(s)	toofilter(s)
time-honored (um)	toolkit(s)
timekeeper(s)	toolshop(s)
timekilling	toolsmith(s)
timelag(s)	tool steel
timeline(s)	toolwork(s)
time-out(s) (n)	tooth and nail
timepiece(s)	top brass
timesaving	top drawer(s) (n)
time-sensitive (um)	top-drawer (adj)
timeserver(s)	top-end (adj)
time-share(s), time-shared, time-sharing (n, v)	topflight (adj)
timeslot(s)	topheavy
timespan(s)	top-level (adj)
timetable(s)	topline(s)
time-urgent (um)	topliner(s)
timewasting	topmost
timeworn	topnotch
tip(s) off, tipped off, tipping off	top-quality (adj)
tipoff(s) (n, um)	top-secret (um)
tip toe(s), tiptoed, tiptoeing (n, v)	topside (nautical)
titleholder(s)	topsy-turvy
title page(s)	torchlight(s)
title-winning (um)	tomado(es)
T-jetty, T-jellies (pl)	Tomados (aircraft name)
to-do(s) (n)	torpedo boat(s)
toehold(s)	torpedo mine(s)
toll bridge(s)	torpedo room(s)
tollgate(s)	torpedo tube(s)
toll road(s)	torsion bar(s) (n, um)
Tomahawk-class missile(s)	

tortuous (adj, twisting, devious, highly complex)	trainshed(s)
torturous (adj, causing torture, cruelly painful)	train station(s)
tossup(s) (n, um)	trainyard(s)
total(s), totaled, totaling	tramcar(s)
touch and go	tramline(s)
touch(es) down, touched down, touching down	tramrail(s)
touchdown(s) (n, um)	tramway(s)
touch(es) up, touched up, touching up	tranquelize(s), tranquilized, tranquilizing
touchup(s) (n, um)	tranquillizer(s)
tough-minded (um)	tranquility
toward (no s)	trans (pref, usually one word)
to wit	transalpine
townhall(s)	transatlantic
town meeting(s)	transasthmian
townspeople	transonic
traceable	transoceanic
track-and-field (um)	transshipment(s), transshipped, transshipping
track-mobile (um)	transshipment(s)
track record(s)	transuranic
tractor-trailer(s)	but
tradeable	trans-Canadian
tradescraft	trans-Siberian
trade(s) in, traded in, trading in	transcendent
trade-in(s) (n, um)	transfer(s), transferred, transferring (n, v)
trademark(s), trademarked, trademarking (n, v)	transferable
trade name(s)	transferal(s)
trade(s) off, traded off, trading off	transit(s), transited, transiting (n, v)
trade-off(s) (n, um)	transmit(s), transmitted, transmitting
trade school(s)	transmittal(s)
tradesperson, tradespersons or tradespeople (pl)	transmittance(s)
trade union(s)	transmitter(s)
trade unionism	transporter-erector-launcher(s) (n)
trade unionist(s)	trapdoor(s)
trade wind(s)	travel(s), traveled, traveling (n, v)
trafficking	traveler(s)
trailblazing	traveler's checks
trainborne	traveltime(s)
training camp(s)	travel-worn (um)
training ship(s)	treatybound
trainload(s)	treatybreaking
trainmaster(s)	treaty-limited
	treatymaking
	tree line(s)
	tree-lined (um)

tree-ripe (um)
 treatop(s)
 tree trunk(s)
 tri (cf. usually one word)
 trico- or
 tri- partle
 tri- state
 tri- but
 tri- iodide
 tri- ply
 tribesman, tribesmen (pl)
 tribespeople
 trigger-happy (um)
 triple-edged (um)
 triple play(s)
 tripwire(s)
 Trojan horse(s)
 trolley(s)
 trolley line(s)
 troopship(s)
 troop train(s)
 troop training (n, um)
 trouble-free (um)
 troublemaking
 troubleshooter(s)
 troublesome
 trouble spot(s)
 truckborne
 truckdriver(s)
 truck farm(s)
 truckline(s)
 truckload(s)
 truckstop(s)
 truck tractor(s)
 truck trailer(s)
 true-blue (um)
 trunkline(s)
 trust-building (um)
 trust-busting (um)
 try out, tries out, tried out, trying out
 tryout(s) (n, um)
 T-shaped
 T-shirt

T-square
 Tu-16
 tube-feed(s), tube-fed, tube-feeding
 tug of war(s)
 tune(s) up, tuned up, tuning up
 tuneup(s) (n, um)
 turbo (cf. usually one word)
 turbo-
 turbo-ramjet
 turn(s) about, turned about, turning about
 turnabout(s) (n, um)
 turn(s) around, turned around, turning around
 turnaround(s) (n, um)
 turn(s) back, turned back, turning back
 turnback(s) (n, um)
 turncoat(s)
 turn(s) down, turned down, turning down
 turndown(s) (n, um)
 turn(s) in, turned in, turning in
 turn-in(s) (n, um)
 turnkey(s)
 turn(s) off, turned off, turning off
 turnoff(s) (n, um)
 turn(s) out, turned out, turning out
 turnout(s) (n, um)
 turn(s) over, turned over, turning over
 turnover(s) (n, um)
 turnpike(s)
 turnscrew(s)
 turntable(s)
 turret deck(s)
 turret gun(s)
 turret ship(s)
 turtleback(s) (n, adj)
 20th-century (adj)
 twenty-first
 twenty-one
 twice-reviewed (um)
 twin-engine (adj)
 twin-engined (um)
 twin-jet (adj)
 twin-screw (adj)

two(s)
 two-faced (um)
 twofold
 two-piece (adj)
 two-seater(s)
 two-sided (um)
 twosome(s)
 two-thirds
 two-way (adj)
 two-wheeler(s)
 typecast
 typeface(s)
 typescript(s)
 typesetting
 typewriting

U

ultra (pref, usually one word)
 ultrahigh
 ultrarothodox
 ultralightwing
 ultrashortwave
 ultrasonic
 ultraviolet
 but
 ultra-sambalious
 ultra-atomic
 ultra-English
 ultra-high-frequency (adj)
 ultra-high-speed (adj)
 ultra-high-voltage (adj)
 ultra large scale (adj)
un (pref, usually one word)
 unaware (adj)
 unawares (adv)
 uncalled-for (adv)
 unheard-of (um)
 unblurred
 unself-conscious
 unsent-for (um)
 unthought-of (um)
 but
 un-American
 unionized

UN

UN Charter
 UN-initiated (um)
 UN Mission(s)
 UN Permanent Representative(s)
 UN Special Commission (UNSCOM)
 UN Special Representative(s)
under (pref, usually one word)
 under age (pred)
 underage (um, too young)
 under contract
 undercover (um)
 under cultivation (being killed)
 undercultivation (insufficient cultivation)
 undercut(s), undercut, undercutting (n, v)
 underdog(s)
 undergoes!, underwent, undergone, undergoing
 underground(s), undergrounded, undergrounding
 (n, adj, v)
 under-ice (adj)
 under oath
 under obligation
 under orders
 underpriced
 underrepresented (adj)
 underresourced (adj)
 underside(s)
 under secretary, under secretaries (pl)
 under-secretaryship(s)
 under strength (pred)
 understrength (um)
 under suspicion
 under-the-counter (um)
 under water (pred)
 underwater (um)
 under way (pred)
 underway (um)
unl (cf, usually one word)
unintelligible
uninterested (indifferent; see *disinterested*)
union-made (um)
union shop(s)
up
 up-and-comer(s) (n)
 up-and-coming (um)
 upbeat
 upcountry
 update(s), updated, updating (n, v)
 upend(s), upended, upending
 up-front (um)
 upgrade(s), upgraded, upgrading (n, v)
 uphill

upkeep
uplift(s), uplifted, uplifting (n, v)
up-link(s), up-linked, up-linking (n, v)
upload(s), uploaded, uploading (n, v)
uprange
upriver
upstairs
upstream
upswing(s)
uptick(s)
up time(s)
up-to date
uptown
upturn(s)
upwind

uppercase (printing)
upper-caste (adj)
upper-class (ac)
upperclassman, upperclassmen (pl)
uppercut (n, um)
upper hand
upper-house (adj)
upper-income (adj)
upper-middle-class (adj)
uppermost
URL(s) (uniform resource locator)
US \$3 million
usable
user friendly
userid(s)
upside down
US-owned (um)
U-turn(s)

V

vacillate(s), vacillated, vacillating
value-added (um)
variable rate mortgage(s)
V-E Day
verbalism
vertebra(s)
vertebrae (pl, scientific)

very-high-frequency (adj)
very-low-frequency (adj)
vice admiral(s)
vice-admiralty
vice chair(s)
vice chairman, vice chairmen (pl)
vice chancellor(s)
vice consul(s)
vice-consulate(s)
vice-consulship(s)
vice-marshal(s)
vice minister(s)
vice-ministry, vice-ministries (pl)
vice-presidency, vice-presidencies (pl)
vice president(s)
vice-presidential
vice-president(s)-elect (general sense)
but
Vice President-elect
vice versa
videocassette(s)
videoconferencing
videotape(s), videotaped, videotaping (n, v)
video tape recording(s)
Vietnam war
viewgraph(s)
viewpoint(s)
vilit, vilified, vilified, vilifying
virtuoso(s)
vis-a-vis
visible
voice-activated (um)
voice mail(s)
Voice of America
volt-ampere(s)
voltmeter(s)
volt-second(s)
vote-casting (um)
votegetter(s)
vote-getting (um)
VRAM (video RAM)

VRML (virtual reality modeling language)

W

wage earner(s)

wage-earning (um)

wage scale(s)

wagonload(s)

wait-and-see (adj)

waiting list(s)

waiting period(s)

wake-homing

walkie-talkie(s)

walk(s) in, walked in, walking in

walk-in (n, um)

walk(s) on, walked on, walking on

walk-on(s) (n, um)

walk(s) out, walked out, walking out

walkout(s) (n, um)

walled-in (um)

walled-up (um)

wall-like

wallpaper(s), wallpapered, wallpapering (n, v)

war chest(s) (n)

war crimes (n)

war-crimes (adj)

warfighter(s)

warfighting (n)

warfighting (um)

war game(s) (n)

war-game(s), war-gamed, war-gaming (adj, v)

wargaming (n)

warhead(s)

warhorse(s) (nonliteral)

warlike

warlord(s)

warmaking

warmonger(s)

warpath(s)

warplane(s)

warplan(s)

warship(s)

wartime(s)

war-torn

war-waging (um)

war-wearied (um)

war weariness

war-weary (um)

war-winning (um)

war zone(s)

ward (suffix, usually one word; no final s)

afterward

homeward

northward

warehouse(s)

warehouse(s), warehoused, warehousing (n, v)

warmed-over (um)

warm(s) up, warmed up, warming up

warmup(s) (n, um)

washed-out

wash(es) out, washed out, washing out

washout(s) (n, um)

wash(es) up, washed up, washing up

washup(s) (n, um)

wastewater(s)

watchband(s)

watchdog(s)

watchlist(s)

watchman, watchmen (pl)

watchword(s)

water-bearing (um)

water body, water bodies (pl)

waterborne

watercolor(s), watercolored, watercoloring (n, v)

water-cool(s), water-cooled, water-cooling

water-cooled (um)

water-cut (from oil well)

watered-down (um)

waterfall(s)

water-filled (um)

waterflood(s) (of oil wells)

waterflow(s)	weapons of mass destruction (WMD)
waterfront(s)	weapons-of-mass-destruction (um)
waterhole(s)	weapons-related (um)
water level(s)	weapon system(s) (preferred), weapons system(s)
waterline(s)	weatherbeaten
waterlogged	weather-hardened (um)
water main(s)	weather map(s)
waterman, waterman (pl)	weatherproof(s), weatherproofed,
watermark(s) (as on stationery)	weatherproofing (adj, v)
but	weatherstrip(s), weatherstripped,
high water mark(s) (as in floods)	weatherstripping (n, v)
waterpower	web browser(s)
waterproof(s), waterproofed,	webcam(s)
waterproofing (n, adj, v)	webcast(s)
water sharing (n)	web index(es)
water-sharking (um)	webmaster(s)
watershed(s)	webpage(s)
waterside(s)	web server(s)
waterski(s), waterskied, waterskiing (n, v)	website(s)
water-soaked (um)	weekday(s)
water-soluble (um)	weekend(s)
water table(s)	weekender(s)
watertight	weeklong (adj)
water tower(s)	week-old (um)
water treatment (adj)	well-being (n)
waterway(s)	well-born (um)
waterworks	well-bred (um)
watthour (Wh)	well-coordinated (um)
wave band(s)	well-done (um)
waveform(s)	well-drilling (um)
wave front(s)	well field(s)
waveguide(s)	wellhead(s)
wave height(s)	wellhouse(s)
wavelength(s)	well-informed (um)
wave-swept (um)	well-known (um)
way point(s)	well-looking (um)
way station(s)	well-off (um)
weak-kneed (um)	well-prepared (um)
weak-willed (um)	well-read (um)
weaponmaking	well-spoken (um)
weapons-grade	wellspring(s)

well-thought-of (um)	whistle-blowing
well-thought-out (um)	whistlestop(s)
well-to-do	white book(s) (diplomatic)
well-trained (um)	whitecap(s) (nonliteral)
well-wisher(s)	white-collar (adj, nonliteral)
well-worn (um)	white count(s)
westbound	white flag(s)
west-central	white goods
west end(s)	white lie(s)
Western-government-backed (um)	white paper(s) (diplomatic)
Western Hemisphere	whitewash(es), whitewashed, whitewashing (n, v)
westernmost	wholehearted
westmost	wholesale
west-northwest	wholesome
westward	wholly owned subsidiary (subsidiaries (pl))
wet(s), wet or wetted, wetting (n, v; of water; see wief)	wide (suffix, usually one word)
wet, wetter, wettest (adj)	armywide
wetland(s)	nationwide
wheatfield(s)	peninsula-wide
wheat grower(s) (n)	but
wheatland(s)	Africa-wide
wheat-rich (um)	Army-wide
wheatstalk(s)	wide-angle (adj)
wheelbarrow(s)	wide-area (adj)
wheelbase(s)	wide-awake (um)
wheelbox(es)	wide-band (adj)
wheelchair(s)	wide-body, wide-bodies (n, adj)
wheeler-dealer(s)	wide gauge(s) (r)
wheelpower	wide-gauge (adj)
whereabouts	wide-open (um)
whereas	wide-ranging (um)
whereby	wide-scale (adj)
whereupon	widespread
wherewithal	widthwise
what(s), whetted, whetting (to stimulate: see wet)	WI-FI
whipcord(s)	wild card(s)
whip hand(s)	wildlife
whiplash(es)	wildful
whirlpool(s)	wildpower
whistle-blower(s)	wind (cf, usually one word)
	windblown
	windborne
	windbreak

- windburn(s)
 windchill(s)
 windfall(s)
 windmill(s)
 windpipe(s)
 windpower
 windproof(s), windproofed, windproofing (adj, v)
 windshield(s)
 windspeed(s)
 windstorm(s)
 windswept
 windward
 but
 wind tunnel (n)
 wind-tunnel (adj)
 window-dress(es), window-dressed,
 window-dressing
 window-dressing (n)
 windowsill(s)
 wind(s) up, wound up, winding up
 windup(s) (n, um)
 wine-making (um)
 wing flap(s)
 wingspan(s)
 wingspread
 wingtip(s)
 winter(s), wintered, wintering (n, v)
 winterkill(s)
 winterproof(s), winterproofed, winterproofing
 (adj, v)
 winter-sown (um)
 wintertime(s)
 winter wheat
 wireline(s)
 wirephoto(s)
 wiretap(s), wiretapped, wiretapping (n, v)
 wise (suffix, usually one word)
 businesswise
 clockwise
 wisetrack(s)
 wise guy(s)
 wise man, wise men (pl)
 wise-spoken (um)
 wish list(s)
 witch hunt(s)
 withdraw(s), withdrew, withdrawn, withdrawing
 withhold(s), withheld, withholding
 withstand(s), withstood, withstanding
 WMD (weapon(s) of mass destruction)
 woodland(s)
 woodpulp(s)
 woodwork(s)
 woodworking (n, adj)
 woolgathering
 wool-lined (um)
 woolshearing
 woolworking
 wordbook(s)
 wordbuilding
 word combination(s)
 wordcraft
 word-for-word (adj, adv)
 wordlist(s)
 word-of-mouth (adj, adv)
 wordplay(s)
 word watcher(s)
 word wrap, word wrapped, word wrapping
 work (cf, usually one word)
 workday(s)
 workflow(s)
 workforce(s)
 workhorse(s)
 workload(s)
 workman, workmen (pl)
 workmanlike
 workmanship
 workout(s)
 workplace(s)
 workplan(s)
 worksaving
 worksheet(s)
 workshop(s)
 worksite(s)
 workspace(s)
 workstation(s)
 workteam(s)
 worktime(s)
 workup(s)
 workweek(s)
 workyard(s)
 workyear(s)

but
 work hour(s)
 work order(s)
 work shift(s)
 working-class (adj)
 working day(s)
 working-level (adj)
 workman, workmen (pl)
 working woman, working women (pl)
 worldbeater(s)
 world-class (adj)
 World Court
 world-record-breaking (um)
 worldview(s)
 World War II period (n)
 worldwide
 World Wide Web (WWW)
 WORM (write-once, read-many)
 wormout (um)
 worrywart(s)
 worship(s), worshiped, worshipping
 worshiper(s)
 worst case(s) (n, um)
 worthwhile
 would-be
 wreck(s), wrecked, wrecking (wreck)
 wrap(s) up, wrapped up, wrapping up
 wrap-up(s) (n, um)
 wreak(s), wreaked, wreaking (to cause)
 write(s) down, wrote down, writing down
 write-down(s) (n, um)
 write(s) in, wrote in, writing in
 write-in(s) (n, um)
 write(s) off, wrote off, writing off
 writeoff(s) (n, um)
 write protected
 writers guide(s)
 write(s) up, wrote up, writing up
 writeups (n, um)
 wrongdoers
 wrong-minded (um)

wrong-thinking (um)
 wrought iron
 WWW (World Wide Web)
 Wye River Memorandum
 but
 Wye accord

X, Y, Z

X-ray(s)
 X-shaped
 Yak-40(s)
 yearbook(s)
 yearend
 yearlong
 year-old
 year on year (adv)
 year-on-year (adj)
 year-round
 years' (possessive case)
 yellowcake (of uranium)
 yellow fever
 yes-man, yes-woman (pl)
 yesterday(s)
 yet-determined (um)
 yet-to-be
 Y-joint(s)
 young-looking (um)
 youthful
 zero-gravity (adj)
 zero(s)
 zero-sum (adj)
 zigzag(s), zigzagged, zigzagging (n, adj, v)



9. WORD WATCHERS LIST

9.1. What's in This Chapter?

The Word Watchers List contains an alphabetized compilation of entries dealing with possibly troublesome words, word types, and word problems. It is intended to help writers and processors of the written word find quickly the answers to questions likely to arise most often in their work. Most of the entries provide answers on the spot. Others direct the user to other entries in this chapter (such references are highlighted in red) or to parts of earlier chapters referred to by section or footnote number.⁴²

9.2. Who Are the Word Watchers?

This compilation is meant to provide guidance for writers of intelligence publications as well as writers of intelligence-related administrative papers. All are assumed already to possess the three essentials of intelligence analysis: knowledge, clarity of thought, and good judgment. No writing, however skilled, can conceal deficiencies in these requisites.

9.3. Some Helpful Precepts

Written English is the analysts' and administrators' main vehicle for conveying their studied evaluations to consumers. Mastery of the language adds force, precision, and grace to these presentations. Writers who want to compose English prose devoid of jargon and easy to comprehend should bear in mind these concepts:

- Keep the language crisp and pungent; prefer the forthright to the pompous and ornate.
- Do not stray from the subject; omit the extraneous, no matter how brilliant it may seem or even be.
- Favor the active voice and shun streams of polysyllables and prepositional phrases.
- Keep sentences and paragraphs short, and vary the structure of both.
- Be frugal in the use of adjectives and adverbs; let nouns and verbs show their own power.
- Make sure that subject and verb agree in number; do not be tricked by intervening words.
- Be just as sure that every pronoun has a clearly identifiable antecedent and that the two agree in number and gender.
- Be aware of your reading audience; reserve technical language for technical readers.
- Be objective; write as a reporter or analyst or administrator unless you are entitled to write as a policymaker.

⁴²Note that a section number always begins with the number of the chapter in which the section appears—section 7.3, for example, is the 3rd section of chapter 7. Footnotes, however, are numbered in one sequence throughout—from footnote 1 in chapter 1 to footnote 42 in chapter 9.

a, an before h	Use <i>an</i> when the next word begins with a silent <i>h</i> (an herb); use <i>a</i> when the <i>h</i> is pronounced (a historic occasion).
aboard, on board	<i>Aboard</i> can be an adjective (the crew is aboard), an adverb (they went aboard), or a preposition (they are aboard the ship). The prepositional phrase <i>on board</i> can be used adjectively (they are on board) or adverbially (they went on board) but preferably not prepositionally—avoid <i>they went on board the ship</i> .
about, approximately, around	<i>Around</i> is acceptable in approximations of time: around three o'clock. In other contexts it is a questionable synonym for <i>about</i> or <i>approximately</i> . Given a choice between those two words, choose <i>about</i> most of the time. It saves space and sounds less stuffy. Do not use <i>about</i> (or <i>approximately</i> , <i>around</i> , or <i>estimated</i>) when a figure is stated precisely. Do not say during the attack, <i>about</i> 3,041 troops were killed if you are sure of the number. If you are not sure, replace the 3,041 figure with <i>about</i> (or an <i>estimated</i>) 3,000.
absolutes	Some adjectives convey an absolute: it is the whole thing or nothing. They do accept modifiers that take away their absoluteness—almost, for example—but they do not accept limiting modifiers such as somewhat, totally, more, and less. The Preamble to the U.S. Constitution is out of bounds grammatically when it speaks of <i>a</i> more perfect Union, and, as the common saying puts it, a woman cannot be somewhat pregnant. Other words in this category are eternal, fatal, incessant, maximum, minimum, ultimate, unique, and universal. Absolute maximum is overkill: maximum says it all.
accelerate	See escalate, accelerate, intensify.
acquiesce, agree	<i>Acquiesce</i> takes the preposition <i>in</i> , not <i>to</i> (acquiesce in the decision); it is used with <i>agree</i> (agree to the plan).
acronyms	Explain them as you would any other abbreviation. But be aware that acronyms do not always seem to follow conventions about capitalization or other matters (Aurimco, NATO, agitprop). Usually, when an acronym is made up solely from the first letter of the major words in the expanded form, render the acronym in all capitals (North Atlantic Treaty Organization, or NATO). We write <i>comsat</i> when speaking generally of a communications satellite but <i>Comsat</i> in reference to the corporation. The term <i>Landsat</i> should refer only to the US Earth resources satellite, but <i>landsat</i> might be used in a less specific reference.
active voice	In formal writing, prefer the active voice. <i>Lifeguards clear beaches when forecasters predict storms.</i> Only if your focus is beach clearing rather than lifeguards would the passive be preferred. <i>The beaches are cleared when storms are forecast.</i>
activity	See condition, situation, activity.
additionally	Prefer <i>in addition</i> if you must use something.
adverbs	When modifying a verb, adverbs usually go between the auxiliary (or auxiliaries) and the main verb. (<i>The Prime Minister has finally announced her decision.</i>)

adverse, averse	sound alike, and both express opposition, but <i>adverse</i> applies to something working against a person or program (<i>adverse weather conditions</i>), and <i>averse</i> applies to a person who is against something. (<i>He is averse to traveling by plane.</i>)
affect, effect	<i>Affect</i> as a verb means to influence, to produce an effect upon. (<i>The blow on the head affected John's vision.</i>) <i>Effect</i> , as a verb, means to bring about. (<i>The assailant effected a change in John's vision by striking him on the head.</i>) <i>Effect</i> , as a noun, means result. (<i>The effect of the blow on John's head was blurred vision.</i>)
agree	with a person, to a proposal, on a plan. (See <i>acquiesce, agree</i> .)
AIDS	See <i>HIV/AIDS</i> .
all ready, already	are not interchangeable. The first means everybody is set to do something; the second means by or before a specified or implied time. (<i>Fortunately, the employees are all ready for the 3:00 meeting because it is already 2:45.</i>)
all right	never alright.
all together	See <i>altogether, all together</i> .
already	See <i>all ready, already</i> .
almost	See <i>most, mostly, almost</i> .
along with	See <i>together with</i> .
also	When used as a direct modifier of a negative verb—he also does not favor/import quotas—also sounds awkward and unidiomatic. Do one of three things: move the word to modify the whole sentence or clause (<i>also, he does not favor import quotas</i>), replace it (<i>he does not favor import quotas either or moreover, he does not favor import quotas</i>), or make the verb positive (<i>he also opposes import quotas</i>). Be sure, moreover, that <i>also</i> is intended to modify the verb directly and not some other word in the sentence; <i>also</i> , like <i>even</i> and <i>only</i> , is a notorious “floating modifier.” (See <i>fill-ins</i> .)
alternate, alternative	<i>Alternate</i> means rotating, following by turns; <i>alternative</i> pertains to a choice between possibilities. <i>Alternate</i> , as an adjective, does overlap <i>alternative</i> by conveying the idea of a second choice.
altogether, all together	<i>Altogether</i> means all told or completely. <i>All together</i> means in unison.
always	means on every occasion or forever. Be sure that you do not use <i>always</i> when you mean <i>habitually</i> or <i>usually</i> . (<i>The President always leaves his office at noon on Saturday. Are there no exceptions?</i>) (See <i>absolutes</i> .)
ambiguous, ambivalent	Use <i>ambiguous</i> if you wish to point out inconclusiveness or lack of clarity in a situation. <i>Ambivalent</i> applies to mixed feelings, the simultaneous operation in the mind of two different and usually conflicting desires.
American	Is certainly acceptable as a noun meaning a US citizen, but for the adjective describing our country the preferred term is <i>US</i> .
among	See <i>between, among</i> .
amused	See <i>bemused</i> .

anathema	means both a curse or denunciation and the thing or person cursed or denounced. In the former case the article and plural are used. <i>The anathemas of the losers, to pronounce an anathema.</i> In the latter they usually are not. <i>He was anathema to his enemies, they were anathema to their enemies.</i>
and, but, however	may be used at the beginning of a sentence when emphasis is desired, but use this construction sparingly; overuse blunts its effect and leans toward the informal.
and/or	Do not use in Bk writing. See section 5.17c.
and so forth	See etc., and so forth.
anticipate, expect	When you anticipate an event, you generally make some preparation for it; when you expect an event, you simply await developments before acting. <i>They anticipated a hostile crowd, so they mobilized the National Guard. Had they expected a hostile crowd, they would not have been surprised, but the National Guard would not have been there.</i>
anxious, eager	Both connote a strong interest or desire; use eager unless you want to add a dimension of worry or fear.
any	As a pronoun, can take either a singular or a plural verb. <i>Any [any one] of her options is suitable. Are any [some] of them practicable?</i>
apparently	See qualifiers.
appraise, apprise	Appraise means to set a value on; apprise, to inform. Apprise, however, is considered a pretentious word and should be avoided.
approximately	See about, approximately, around.
apt	See likely
around	See about, approximately, around
as	in positive comparisons, is followed by another as. <i>She is as clever as her adversary.</i> Watch out for mismatches. <i>As good as or better than</i> , not <i>as good or better than</i> . In negative comparisons, so may be substituted for the first as. <i>She is not so clever as her adversary.</i> (See like, as and compare, contrast.)
as far as	Confusion arises with the construction <i>as far as . . . is concerned</i> . This is an undisciplined unit; <i>as far as by itself</i> is incorrect. <i>As far as football teams are concerned, I like the Redskins</i> is correct. <i>As far as football teams, I like the Redskins</i> is not.
as noted	See fill-ins.
assure, ensure, insure	Assure applies to persons (to assure a leader of one's loyalty). It alone has the sense of setting a person's mind at rest. Use ensure to mean make certain (to ensure a nation's security). Insure means to cover with insurance.
as well as	See together with.
as yet	Most of the time as can be dropped.
asylum	a permissible word, even though not in many dictionaries, meaning a person seeking asylum or one given asylum.
at the same time	See fill-ins
augur, auger	Augur is a verb meaning to predict from signs or omens. An auger is a tool for boring holes.

averse	See adverse, averse.
awhile	is not preceded by for. He stayed awhile; but he stayed for a while.
based on, due to, owing to	These word sets are almost always awkward and often introduce dangling phrases: Due to (or owing to) illness, the meeting was postponed. You can usually produce something smoother by reworking the sentence: We had to postpone the meeting because almost everyone was sick.
basically	See tillins.
because	See reason, because.
bedouin	Capitalize Bedouin when referring to an ethnic population, as in Jordan (see The World Factbook). When referring to a nomadic lifestyle, lowercase is suitable (the bedouin belief in afreet [powerful evil demons]).
beef up	Avoid this overused term. (See metaphors.)
before	See prior to, before.
bemused	means confused or bewildered and is not synonymous with amused.
between, among	Between expresses the relationship of two persons or things (between the devil and the deep blue sea); among, the relationship of three or more (The spoils of victory were divided among the four winning parties). Use between, however, if you are considering more than two things in pairs as well as in a group. (We see major differences between the policies of Country A, Country B, and Country C.)
biannual, biennial, semiannual	Both biannual and semiannual mean twice a year; biennial means every two years. To avoid confusion between biannual and biennial, avoid the former and use semiannual. Even better, say twice a year and every two years.
bits, bytes	are considered units of measure and are quantified in figures, not spelled-out words (a 7-bit byte, 5 bytes of 7 bits each; but five 7-bit bytes—see section 2.23a).
blatant, flagrant	Both words describe glaringly antisocial behavior. Blatant denotes the obvious, the offensive, the obtrusive; a blatant lie. Flagrant carries a stronger overtone of malice; it denotes deliberate, obtrusive wrongdoing. One who willfully violates a pledge commits a flagrant act. Both words convey subjectivism in many contexts. (See subjective words.)
bloc	is usually not capitalized, except for references to the former Soviet Bloc.
blog	A blog is a type of website, usually maintained in an online journal format, containing commentary, descriptions of events, or other material such as graphics or video. As a verb, blog means to maintain or add content to a blog. Blog is short for weblog, but the longer term is rarely used.
boat, ship	Boats, nautically speaking, are usually small craft that can be carried on a ship; a larger vessel suitable for crossing the high seas. The exception is a submarine, which is most often referred to as a boat. All take the pronoun it, not she.
both	is redundant in expressions such as they both agree or they both share. With three, however, both might be used: Both London and Paris agree with Washington that the arrangement is sound.
both . . . and	Be sure that the material that follows is in balance. He was deaf to both argument and entreaty, not he was both deaf to argument and entreaty. (See parallelism.)

boycott, embargo	A boycott is a refusal, usually by an organized group, to buy or use a particular product or service. It is not synonymous with embargo, which is a legal restriction on trade.
breach, breech	As a noun, breach is a violation, a gap, or a rift in a solid structure. Do not confuse it with breech, which is acceptable only in reference to ordnance and to human anatomy.
burgeoning	Originally descriptive of something newly emerging, burgeoning has become accepted for something growing and expanding rapidly.
burnish	means to make shiny or lustrous: It is not correct to say someone burnished his credentials.
but	See and, but, however.
bytes	See bits, bytes.
cadre	Cadre was originally a military term for a group around which a larger unit is formed but now, under the influence of communist terminology, may denote any core group, as well as a member of such a group. Use in a nonmilitary context seems to be dying out as the Cold War era fades further into history. Use an English term if possible. Always add an s when the word is plural. (See cohort.)
calculate	See feel.
capital cities	In intelligence writing are generally legitimate stand-ins for the names of national governments. Moscow's position is clear is fine, but be sure not to use capital cities when you are referring to the country as a whole. Do not write, for instance, Moscow is reinforcing its borders.
casualties	include persons injured, captured, or missing in action as well as those killed in battle. In formulating casualty statistics, be sure to write "killed or wounded," not "killed and wounded." (See injuries, casualties.)
celebrity copycatting	can lead one up the garden path because those emulated are not always pure of speech. A venerable newscaster persists in mispronouncing February (without the first r sound) and has misled a whole generation. Another Piec Piper of TV is given to saying "one of those who is"—joining many others who are deceived by the one and forget that the plural who is the subject of the verb (see one). The classic copycat phrase, at this point in time, grew out of the Watergate hearings and now is so firmly entrenched that we may never again get people to say at this time, at present, or simply now (see presently).
center	as a verb is used with on, upon, in, or at, but not around. The dispute centers on the fairness of the election. The dispute can, however, revolve around the fairness of the election.
charisma	is a Greek word denoting divine grace or endowment. Its use should be limited to those rare and gifted persons who attract exceptional devotion from great numbers of followers.

China, Taiwan	The full name of the People's Republic of China is usually shortened to <i>China</i>. <i>PRC</i> may be used. <i>Hong Kong</i> has been a Special Administrative Region of China since July 1997. <i>Chinese</i> is the preferred adjective and refers only to the mainland. For what was once called Nationalist China or the Republic of China, use only <i>Taiwan</i>, both as noun and as adjective. For variation, <i>Taipei</i> may be used in either noun or adjective form (for example, the officials <i>in Taipei</i>, or the <i>Taipei</i> authorities), but avoid <i>Taiwanese</i> as an adjective referring to the island's administration or its officials (and do not use the term <i>Taiwanese government</i>). The terms <i>Communist China</i> (and <i>Chinese Communist</i>) and <i>Nationalist China</i> (and <i>Chinese Nationalist</i>) or <i>Republic of China</i> should be used only in historical contexts.
citizenry	See pretentious words.
clearly	See qualifiers.
climactic, climatic	<i>Climactic</i> refers to climax or high point, <i>climatic</i> to weather. <i>The climactic moment of the President's trip came at Bonn. The climatic changes in the area are being studied.</i>
clout	is best confined to fights and baseball or golf. It can be used occasionally in the metaphorical sense of influence or power, but it always sounds colloquial. (See colloquialisms.)
cohort	always refers to a group of people. Emphasis is on the trait or traits common to all members. <i>Cohort</i> should not be used as a synonym for <i>comrade</i> or <i>comrades</i> . Mr. X may belong to a cohort, but neither he nor his buddies are cohorts. (Compare <i>cadre</i> .)
colloquialisms	are words or phrases suitable for conversation or other informal situations but not for intelligence writing.
colored	See footnote 6.
combined, joint	When referring to military exercises or operations, a <i>combined exercise</i> involves the forces of more than one country, a <i>joint exercise</i> two or more services of the same country.
communication(s)	In military/security terminology <i>communication</i> usually adds <i>s</i> as an adjective: <i>communications equipment</i> , <i>communications intelligence</i> . As a noun it sometimes drops the <i>s</i> : <i>lines of communication</i> (sometimes abbreviated <i>SLiOCs</i> and pronounced as an acronym).
communism	See section 1.13 and footnote 3.
comparatively	See <i>relatively</i> , <i>comparatively</i> .
compare, contrast	<i>Compare</i> points out likenesses; <i>compare with</i> points out both likenesses and differences; <i>contrast with</i> points out only differences. <i>He compared his cabinet with Kennedy's.</i> (He pointed out similarities and differences.) <i>He compared his cabinet to Kennedy's.</i> (He showed how much alike they were—and by implication, how praiseworthy his cabinet was.) <i>He contrasted his cabinet with Kennedy's.</i> (He emphasized the differences.) When using <i>compared</i> as a participle, preceding it with <i>as</i> will ensure better comprehension and in some cases avoid the appearance of a dangling participle. <i>This year's output, as compared with last year's, is more export oriented.</i>

compel, impel, propel	Compel means to force, drive, or constrain; impel to urge to action through moral pressure; propel to impart motion to.
comprise, compose, include	Comprise views a collection as a whole; it means to contain or to consist of. Use <i>comprise</i> when referring to all components; use <i>include</i> when mentioning only some of them. The statement <i>comprises</i> all he has to say on the topic. The statement <i>includes</i> a cogent summary of his thoughts. Compose emphasizes the elements of a collection; it means to constitute or to make up. Unless accompanied by a modifier, it, too, refers to all components. The parts <i>compose</i> the whole. The committee is <i>composed</i> of Sue, Jim, and Andy, among others. The real problem with <i>compose/comprise</i> comes with the passive form. Compose in the sense of contain generally requires a passive construction: is composed of. Comprise lacks a meaningful passive form, but (partly because <i>comprise</i> sounds fancier than <i>compose</i>) we try to fill the gap with a parallelism: is composed of. Never use this phrase. Something can be composed of a, b, and c. It can include a, b, and c. It can <i>compose</i> (be made up of, be composed of) a, b, and c. It can never be <i>comprised</i> of a, b, and c.
concern	takes different prepositions for different senses. He is concerned <i>with</i> computers (he is so occupied or employed). He is concerned <i>about</i> computers (he is worried about them). When used in the sense of worry, concern sounds limp: The government of Country A is concerned about US policy. Focus whenever possible on what the government calculates on what it might do.
concerted	meaning combined, requires a plural subject or object to make sense. Only <i>we</i> or <i>they</i> (never <i>I</i> , <i>he</i> , <i>she</i> , or <i>it</i>) can make a "concerted effort."
conclave	is a secret meeting, not just any gathering.
concrete steps	In nonliteral use this phrase raises awkward connotations of literalness. Say <i>concrete measures</i> or <i>specific steps</i> .
condition, situation, activity	often intrude into sentences for no reason. Good writers will say <i>the famine is worsening</i> , not <i>the famine conditions are worsening</i> . <i>The deteriorating economy</i> reads better than <i>the deteriorating economic situation</i> . Likewise, <i>the Russian Navy continued its exercises</i> , not <i>its exercise activities</i> .
consensus	is an opinion held collectively, not simply by a majority. Note the spelling: one c, three s's.
consider, regard	<i>Regard</i> , in the sense of coming to a belief after careful deliberation, is usually followed by <i>as</i> ; <i>consider</i> , in the same sense, is not. He <i>considered the vote a defeat</i> . He <i>regarded the vote as a defeat</i> .
council	See <i>council</i> , <i>counsel</i> , <i>consult</i> .
continual, continuous, continuing, continued	<i>Continual</i> applies to something that occurs intermittently or is repeated at intervals; <i>continuous</i> to something that is uninterrupted in time or space. <i>Continuing</i> can be used in either sense. <i>Continuing</i> and <i>continued</i> are most often seen in government prose as pallid filler words. When tempted to use either, ask yourself whether there is a more effective word or whether you can do without the adjective. <i>His continuing efforts</i> . . . (persistent efforts? fruitless efforts? Do you need any adjective at all?)
contractions	are not acceptable in formal writing.
contradistinction	See pretentious words.
contrast	See <i>compare</i> , <i>contrast</i> .

convince, persuade	are not interchangeable. A person is <i>convinced</i> of a need after he has been <i>persuaded</i> to recognize the need. <i>They convinced him of the importance of his participation and persuaded him to join.</i> If <i>convince</i> is followed by <i>to</i> , it usually is incorrect.
could, may, might	In the DI these words are used more or less interchangeably in a predictive mode: <i>Country A could (may, might) invade Country B.</i> Strictly speaking, however, they are not predictive at all. They are conditionals, and conditionals carry little analytic weight without the anchor of a limiting condition: <i>Country A may invade country B if Country B's leader leaves the scene.</i> Moreover, the three words are not synonymous. <i>Could</i> means <i>would be able to</i> and should be confined to statements dealing with capacity: <i>Country A could invade Country B if it achieved air superiority.</i> Without a limiting condition, <i>could</i> carries the connotation that the capability exists but will not be used: <i>Country A could invade Country B (but we do not think it will).</i> Both <i>may</i> and <i>might</i> deal with possibility. For <i>may</i>, <i>might</i> carries an implication of greater uncertainty on the part of the writer. Again, the construction provides little enlightenment unless it offers further analysis: <i>Country A may invade Country B if President X gets the support of Country C.</i> <i>Country A might invade Country B if President X can persuade the legislature to back him.</i> Note the logical constraints imposed by <i>may</i> and <i>might</i> when they are properly yoked to a limiting condition. The last two examples not only warn about a possible invasion if certain conditions are satisfied; they also tell the reader by implication that the invasion <i>will not</i> occur unless the conditions are satisfied. If that is not what we want to say, the sentence needs reworking.
council, counsel, consul	<i>Council</i> is a noun that refers to a deliberative assembly, its work, or its membership. <i>Counsel</i> may be either a noun or a verb; it applies to advice and the person proffering that advice. <i>Consul</i> is the title of an officer in the foreign service.
countries, nations	Even <i>La Belle France</i> and <i>Mother Russia</i> are neuter and, like boats, take neuter pronouns (<i>it, they</i>). For information on country names and nationality designators, consult <i>The World Factbook</i> . (See footnote 1.)
credence, credibility, credulity	<i>Credence</i> means belief or mental acceptance. <i>Credibility</i> is the quality of being believable; something is credible when it is worthy of belief and judged plausible. One receives information that lends <i>credibility</i> to a rumor; one gives <i>credence</i> to the rumor upon being convinced that the information is valid. One who gives credence too easily is likely to stray over into <i>credulity</i> , which is next to gullibility.
crisis	In international affairs, a <i>crisis</i> is a situation involving significant actual or potential conflict. Similarly, in a country's domestic politics, reserve the word for major turning points. <i>Crisis</i> should not be used to describe lesser disruptions.
criteria	See <i>data, media, criteria, phenomena</i> .
culminate	takes the preposition <i>in</i> and is used intransitively. <i>The concert culminated in a sing-along, not a sing-along culminated the concert.</i>
cyberspace	the electronic medium of computer networks in which online communication occurs.

dangling participles	See participles.
data, media, criteria, phenomena	are plural and therefore require plural verbs. The singulars are <i>datum</i> , <i>medium</i> , and (because they come from Greek rather than Latin) <i>criterion</i> and <i>phenomenon</i> . <i>Datum</i> and <i>medium</i> rarely have a place in DI writing, but we do use <i>criterion</i> and <i>phenomenon</i> . One never satisfies a criteria or observes a phenomena. (Note: Gregg points to a few instances when <i>data</i> and <i>media</i> might appropriately take a singular verb in formal writing; see section 1018. In the DI, you still are safer sticking with a plural verb.) The majority of -um nouns, of course, appear most often in the singular form. When pluralizing them, the DI generally uses English rather than Latin endings—for example, <i>forum(s)</i> , <i>curriculum(s)</i> . See also Gregg, section 614, for lists of the preferred pluralizations of foreign words.
dates as modifiers	A date should be used adjectivally only if you are distinguishing one event from another. Thus, the 1973 Middle East war differentiates that conflict from others in other years. In contrast, the 1901 assassination of President McKinley and the 1991 Iraqi invasion of Kuwait need to be recast because they refer to unique events. Ending the phrases with <i>in 1901</i> and <i>in 1991</i> , respectively, would be a quick solution, but more creative choices may be available.
decimate	originally meant to select by lot, and then to kill, one out of every 10 in a group of enemies. Now it is used (and overused) to encompass heavy losses of many kinds. Use it only when referring to people, most often military people, and only when actual deaths are involved. Troops and units can be decimated. By extension, a disease can decimate a population. But buildings, tanks, and crops are damaged or destroyed, not decimated; and government economizing does not, one hopes, decimate the relief rolls.
definitely	See <i>very</i> , <i>definitely</i> .
defuse, diffuse	<i>Defuse</i> means to remove a fuse (or fuze—see the spelling and compounding list in chapter 8) from a weapon or, nonliterally, to deintensify, as in to <i>defuse</i> a crisis. <i>Diffuse</i> means to spread around, to scatter.
depart, leave	<i>Depart</i> requires a preposition; <i>leave</i> does not. She will <i>depart from</i> Dulles today and will <i>leave</i> London on Tuesday.
deploy	applies to military movement—in its narrowest definition, to military movement in preparation for battle. Avoid using it in the service of nonmilitary activity.
deprecate, depreciate	<i>Deprecate</i> means to express disapproval of something. Besides its application to prices and values, <i>depreciate</i> means to belittle something. If you <i>depreciate</i> someone's public-speaking skills, you are saying they do not amount to much; if you <i>deprecate</i> a speech, you are criticizing it.
developing countries	See <i>less developed countries</i> .
die	is something we all do, even writers who relegate world leaders to a sort of Immortality Club with phrasing like <i>the President has taken steps to ensure a peaceful transition if he should die</i> . Reality can be recognized by inserting <i>in office</i> or <i>before the end of his term</i> , or even by saying simply <i>when he dies</i> .
Dietmen	Avoid this term for members of the Japanese legislature; rather, use <i>Diet members</i> or <i>members of the Diet</i> .

different from	is correct; <i>different than</i> is not. <i>Her opinion is different from his. Better yet, differs from.</i>
diffuse	See <i>defuse</i> , <i>diffuse</i> .
dilemma	Involves a choice between two equally unsatisfactory courses of action. It is not the proper word to use when you mean simply a predicament or a troublesome decision. <i>The general had a dilemma: he had to decide whether to surrender or to face almost certain defeat on the battlefield.</i>
diplomatic corps	comprises all foreign diplomats assigned to a particular city; it is not synonymous with a country's diplomatic (or foreign) service. <i>Jones, a member of the British Foreign Service since 1983, is currently dean of the diplomatic corps in Ouagadougou.</i>
disburse, disperse	<i>Disburse</i> refers to the release of funds. <i>The payroll office disbursed the funds on Friday. Disperse</i> means to scatter. <i>The air force dispersed all its aircraft on Friday.</i>
disclose	See <i>reveal</i> , <i>expose</i> , <i>disclose</i> , <i>divulge</i> .
discreet, discrete	<i>Discreet</i> means cautious, prudent. <i>Discrete</i> means separate, distinct.
disinformation, misinformation	<i>Disinformation</i> refers to the deliberate planting of false reports. <i>Misinformation</i> equates in meaning but does not carry the same devious connotation.
disinterested, uninterested	<i>Disinterested</i> means impartial, not swayed by self-interest. <i>He attended the conference as a disinterested observer. Uninterested</i> connotes indifference. <i>She was uninterested in the film on management techniques.</i>
disperse	See <i>disburse</i> , <i>disperse</i> .
divulge	See <i>reveal</i> , <i>expose</i> , <i>disclose</i> , <i>divulge</i> .
domestic, indigenous	These words are synonymous in some senses but not all. Modifying <i>production</i> , for example, both define it as homegrown, or related to the country concerned. Modifying <i>animal</i> , on the other hand, the words diverge in meaning, <i>domestic</i> meaning domesticated or tamed, <i>indigenous</i> connoting native to or naturally occurring in the country or region concerned. In a phrase like <i>domestic political opponents</i> <i>domestic</i> is unnecessary because political opponents are always domestic unless otherwise stipulated; you may not need political either.
downbeat	See <i>upbeat</i> , <i>downbeat</i> .
due to	See <i>based on</i> , <i>due to</i> , <i>owing to</i> .
during	See <i>more than</i> , <i>fewer than</i> , <i>over</i> , <i>under</i> , <i>during</i> , <i>while</i> .
each	As a subject, <i>each</i> takes a singular verb and singular related pronouns. <i>Each has his own duties.</i> If, however, <i>each</i> follows a plural subject, the verb is plural. <i>The President and the Vice President each have an interest in the outcome.</i>
eager	See <i>anxious</i> , <i>eager</i> .
East Asia	Prefer to <i>Far East</i> .
East-West	<i>East-West relations</i> refers to those between the United States and its allies on one side (the West) and the Soviet Union and its allies on the other (the East) between World War II and the breakup of the Soviet Union in 1991.
economic growth	DI publications do not use the term <i>negative rate of economic growth</i> . Say instead that gross domestic product (or gross national product) is declining.

effect	See affect, effect.
effluvia	See pretentious words.
either	as a subject, takes a singular verb and pronoun. For <i>either . . . or</i> constructions, see <i>neither . . . not</i> .
election	Singular in most cases; usually there is only one election at a time (national election, general election, presidential election). But presidential and legislative elections, municipal elections in several parts of the country.
e-mail	a way to transmit messages electronically, or a message or messages so transmitted.
e-ticket	a paperless electronic document used for ticketing passengers, usually on an airline.
e-trade	electronic stock trading.
embargo	See boycott, embargo.
emigrate, immigrate, migrate	<i>Emigrate</i> is to leave a place permanently and is usually followed by <i>from</i> . <i>Immigrate</i> is to come to a place permanently and is usually followed by <i>to</i> . <i>Migrate</i> embraces both. The doctor <i>migrated</i> in the 1950s. He <i>emigrated from</i> Sweden. He <i>immigrated to</i> Italy. When a sentence includes both the place of departure and the place of arrival, <i>immigrate</i> is usually omitted. He <i>emigrated from</i> Sweden <i>to</i> Italy.
enormity, enormousness	<i>Enormity</i> means great wickedness. The <i>enormity</i> of his attempts to conceal the facts led to his ouster. <i>Enormousness</i> , the noun form of <i>enormous</i> , means great size.
ensure	See assure, ensure, insure.
enthuse	should not be used. (See colloquialisms.)
enunciate	See pretentious words.
equal, equivalent	<i>Equal</i> emphasizes precise quantitative likeness. The three countries have <i>equal</i> numbers of submarines. <i>Equivalent</i> applies to two or more things that have a qualitative similarity. The military capabilities of the three countries are roughly <i>equivalent</i> .
equally, as	Do not use these two words together in the same sentence (<i>equally as</i>) when you are making comparisons. Drop <i>equally</i> when you are comparing two persons or groups or two things. He is <i>as ineffective</i> as his predecessor (not <i>equally as ineffective</i>). Drop <i>as</i> when you name only one person or group or one thing in the sentence. They are <i>equally ineffective</i> .
equivalent	See equal, equivalent.
escalate, accelerate, intensify	<i>Escalate</i> means to increase by successive stages. A confrontation can <i>escalate</i> from border skirmishes to raids to invasion to all-out war; pensions can <i>escalate</i> with annual cost-of-living increases. Do not use <i>escalate</i> when you mean simply <i>accelerate</i> or <i>intensify</i> . His political problems are <i>escalating</i> is poor usage.
essentially	See fill-ins.
estimated	See about, approximately, around.
etc., and so forth	Rarely appropriate in DI writing. Enumerating the additional instances is usually more helpful.
eternal	See absolutes.

even	A notorious floating modifier when used as an adverb. If it ends up in the wrong place it can distort meaning, and proper placement in a sentence requires care. <i>Even the Secretary was not disturbed by the threats</i> (and, if anybody would be, it would be he). <i>The Secretary was not even disturbed by the threats</i> (in fact, he was more or less unaffected). <i>The Secretary was not disturbed even by the threats</i> (much less by other things).
evaluate	See pretentious words.
evidence	Is not a synonym for information or reporting. For the most part, avoid the word and get on with the analysis. Such phrases as <i>available evidence indicates</i> are essentially meaningless.
evidently	See qualifiers.
evince	See pretentious words.
exacerbate	Avoid this word; try <i>weaken</i> , <i>worsen</i> , <i>heighten</i> , <i>intensify</i> , <i>widen</i> , or <i>deepen</i> instead. (See pretentious words.)
exile	Except for diplomatic exile, a person is exiled from a country, not to a country. (See <i>asylee</i> .)
expect	See anticipate, expect.
expose	See reveal, expose, disclose, divulge.
extra words	See verbat overkill.
fake analysis	Phrases like the following betray sloppy thinking and detract from any serious presentation: anything can happen it is not possible to predict further developments are to be expected It is too early to tell It remains to be seen only the future will tell
Far East	See East Asia.
farther, further	<i>Farther</i> refers to physical or literal distance; <i>further</i> conveys the notion of additional degrees, time, or quantity. A person hits a ball <i>farther</i> , he pursues a subject <i>further</i> .
fatal	See absolutes.
fear	Use only to describe a strong emotion, not a vague concern, an uneasy feeling, or an ill-defined skepticism.
feel	carries tricky emotional overtones. If a piece of analysis says the leaders of another country <i>feel</i> a certain way, the policymaking reader may conclude that the writer is identifying with those leaders—and perhaps criticizing the policymaker. You are on safer ground with <i>calculate</i> or <i>estimate</i> , whose relationship to the policymaker's operational word is unambiguous.
fewer, less	<i>Fewer</i> applies to numbers or units considered individually, <i>less</i> to quantities taken collectively. <i>Fewer dollars, less money; fewer months, less time; fewer miles, less distance</i> .
fewer than	See <i>more than</i> , <i>fewer than</i> , <i>over</i> , <i>under</i> , <i>during</i> , <i>while</i> .

ill-its	Reserve words and phrases like the following for those few occasions when they are really needed: <i>also</i> , <i>as noted</i> , <i>at the same time</i> , <i>basically</i> , <i>in connection with</i> , <i>indeed</i> , <i>in this context</i> , <i>of course</i> , <i>on the other hand</i> , <i>essentially</i> , <i>significantly</i> , <i>with reference to</i> . (See <i>verbal overkill</i> and <i>fake analysis</i> .)
finalize	See <i>-ize</i> words.
fiscal, monetary	<i>Fiscal</i> applies to a budget, <i>monetary</i> to currency.
fiscal year	See section 2.20d and footnote 18.
flagrant	See <i>blatant</i> , <i>flagrant</i> .
flammable, inflammable	<i>Flammable</i> is the preferred word when you are describing a combustible substance. However, a situation or a temperament is <i>inflammable</i> , not <i>flammable</i> .
flaunt, flout	<i>Flaunt</i> means to display ostentatiously; <i>flout</i> means to disobey openly, to treat the rules with contempt. The starlet <i>flaunted</i> her physical assets in hopes of getting a good role. George <i>flouted</i> community association rules when he built a glass house.
founder, founder	As a verb, <i>founder</i> means to stumble about clumsily; <i>founder</i> means to go lame (as with horses), to sink (as with boats), to collapse, or to fail utterly.
flout	See <i>flaunt</i> , <i>flout</i> .
forceful, forcible	<i>Forceful</i> means vigorous, strong, effective. If you want to connote the exertion of force, use <i>forcible</i> .
forego, forgo	<i>Forego</i> is to go before in time or place. Instead of using it we would usually write <i>go before</i> or <i>precede</i> . If you are doing without something, <i>forgo</i> the e
foreword, forward	<i>Foreword</i> is the name for something written, usually by someone other than the author, to appear at the beginning of an article or book—whose author ordinarily writes the preface. Do not confuse with <i>forward</i> , which means near, at, or moving toward the front.
forgo	See <i>forego</i> , <i>forgo</i> .
former	See <i>latter</i> , <i>former</i> .
forthcoming	See <i>upcoming</i> , <i>forthcoming</i> , <i>coming</i> .
fortuitous, fortunate	<i>Fortuitous</i> describes something that happens by chance or accident. Do not confuse with <i>fortunate</i> . A <i>fortuitous</i> event can be either <i>fortunate</i> or <i>unfortunate</i> .
fortunately	See <i>subjective</i> words.
forward	See <i>foreword</i> , <i>forward</i> .
founder	See <i>founder</i> , <i>founder</i> .
fractions	<i>One-half</i> , <i>one-third</i> , and the like are used when the fractions are precise. When precision is lacking, use <i>a half</i> , <i>a third</i> , and so forth.
Free World	is at best an imprecise designation. Use only in quoted matter.
fulsome	means offensive or loathsome, not complete or full.
further	See <i>farther</i> , <i>further</i> .

gender	The English language is steadily acquiring new terms to counter the predominance of masculine forms: anchor, newscaster, flight attendant, business person, hyperson, chairperson, chair, mail carrier, Diet member, member of Congress, firefighter, police officer. No completely satisfactory substitute yet exists for the pronouns he, she, his, her, and him. The best solution is to use the plural. All representatives (instead of each representative) must cast their ballots (rather than his or her ballot). If this is impractical, stick with one or he or she until someone comes up with a better idea.
gibe, jibe	A gibe is a taunt or sneer. Jibe is the act of shifting sails. Informally, to jibe with means to agree.
hackneyed phrases	Phrases like the following have been overused to the point of becoming meaningless clichés. Note the number of tired metaphors, and of equally tired adjectives and adverbs, in this list. a likely scenario assume the mantle of office bottom line broad outlines of the case considered judgment dire straits far-reaching implications geared up for action generates further disagreement hammer out a compromise heightened tensions hit the campaign trail keep their options open net effect of the decision nonstarters potential chokepoint refresh his tarnished image triggered new developments viable alternatives widely held perception
hanged, hung	<i>Hanged</i> is the past tense of <i>hang</i> when referring to an execution. <i>hung</i> is the proper past tense in all other meanings.
hardly	has the force of a negative (<i>They had hardly any</i> [not no] response.); be careful to avoid an inadvertent double negative (<i>does not hardly</i>).
he/him/his	See gender.
historic, historical	<i>Historic</i> means famous in history (<i>Gettysburg was the scene of a historic battle.</i>) <i>Historical</i> refers to general events of the past. (<i>She presented a historical review of the Middle East.</i>)
HIV/AIDS	Use <i>HIV/AIDS</i> when discussing the disease in terms of its social, economic, and political impacts. Use <i>HIV</i> by itself when discussing the human immunodeficiency virus or HIV prevalence rates. Use <i>AIDS</i> by itself when discussing mortality rates or the prevalence of AIDS-related illnesses, which follow HIV infection.
Hong Kong	See China, Taiwan.
hopefully	means with hope. Avoid using the word in the sense of <i>it is to be hoped</i> or <i>in the hope of</i> , or <i>let us hope</i> . (See subjective words.)
however	See and, but, however.
HTML	abbreviation for hypertext markup language.
hung	See hanged, hung.
hyperlink	a word, phrase, or image in a document that, when clicked on with a computer mouse, will take the user to a point in another document or another place in the same one. Hyperlinks are most common in webpages but can also be found in other hypertext documents.

hypertext	a computer-based text retrieval system that enables a user to access particular locations in webpages or other electronic documents by clicking on hyperlinks.
hypertext markup language	a special language used to write pages and sites for the Internet.
immigrate	See emigrate, immigrate, migrate.
impact	Verbs such as <i>affect</i> or <i>hit</i> are preferable to <i>impact</i> . If you do use it as a verb, you should always use it intransitively. A missile does not impact a target; it <i>impacts on</i> a target or <i>in</i> a target area.
impel	See compel, impel, propel.
impending	See pending, impending.
imply, infer	<i>Implying</i> occurs when the writer or the speaker states something indirectly. <i>Inferring</i> occurs when the reader or the hearer draws a conclusion on the basis of indirect evidence.
important	When you want to introduce a second and more worthy consideration, use <i>more important</i> rather than <i>more importantly</i> . <i>Retail sales were up last month; more important, interest rates fell for the first time this year.</i> Similarly, use <i>most important</i> , rather than <i>most importantly</i> , in a context requiring the superlative. (See relevant, important.)
In addition to	See together with.
incessant	See absolute.
incident, incidence	<i>Incident</i> applies to a minor occurrence or an event of only momentary importance. A border incident took place yesterday when a small patrol entered the neutral zone. <i>Incident</i> is not the proper word to use in cases of major conflict or catastrophe. An invasion is not an incident; neither is an earthquake. Be careful also to distinguish between incidents (occurrences) of civil unrest and the incidence (frequency) of civil unrest.
include	See comprise, comprise, include.
In connection with	See with.
incredible, incredulous	<i>Incredible</i> means not believable; <i>incredulous</i> means skeptical. <i>His explanation was incredible; she gave him an incredulous stare.</i> (See credence, credibility, credulity.)
indeed	See with.
indicate	denotes a conclusion based on specific information. (<i>The massing of troops indicates that a battle is imminent.</i>) Do not use when you mean announce, reveal, say, or the like.
indigenous	See domestic, indigenous.
individual	is not a desirable synonym for person. Use it when you need to make a distinction between one person and a group: <i>The police are searching for the group or individual responsible.</i>
infer	See imply, infer.
infinities	No one insists any more that all split infinitives must be shunned. Do, however, make sure that clarity or the flow of the sentence demands the split. If you are not sure, do not split.
inflammable	See flammable, inflammable.
infrastructure	is a legitimate word, but use it selectively.

injuries, casualties	are suffered or sustained, not received or taken. (See casualties.)
in order to	often begins an adverbial phrase in the middle of a sentence, but at the beginning of the sentence you can usually do without the first two words. He brought his lunch in a bag in order to save money. But: To save money, he brought his lunch in a bag. Be careful of negative verbs followed by phrases beginning with in order to or because of. He did not go out to lunch in order to save money and He did not go out to lunch because he wanted to save money are both ambiguous, leading the reader to ask then why did he go out to lunch? The problem is usually solved by putting the in order to or because of phrase at the beginning of the sentence. A better plan is to rephrase and change the negative verb to a positive one with negative connotations. He avoided restaurant lunches in order to (because he wanted to) save money.
insure	See assure, ensure, insure.
intensity	See escalate, accelerate, intensify.
inter, intra	Inter indicates something that is between or among or together; intra, a prefix, means within. International competition (competition among nations), intramural competition (competition within an institution).
Internet	a communications network that connects computer networks and organizational computer facilities around the world.
interestingly	See hopefully and subjective words.
in terms of	a pretentious and often unnecessary phrase that can usually be deleted along with what it introduces—or at least replaced by at, in, for, or by.
in this context	See fill-ins.
intra	See inter, intra.
ironically	involves a sharp contrast between the apparent and the expected. Do not use ironically when referring to a trivial oddity. Ironically, the senator, a professed atheist, goes to church every Sunday is fine. Ironically, the senator wears tennis shoes to church is not.
Islam	the religious faith of Muslims. (See Muslims.)
issues	are resolved, not solved
its, it's	Its is the possessive of the personal pronoun it. It's is the contraction of it is.
-ize words	appeal to many misguided writers. Seek synonyms for conceptualize, finalize, optimize, prioritize, and their ilk—a recent, particularly egregious example is rumorize.
jibe	See gibe, jibe.
joint	See combined, joint.
kind	See type.
kudos	Is a Greek word meaning glory. In English it means praise or credit for an outstanding achievement. In both Greek and English it is singular and has no plural. Kudos goes to someone, kudos never go to anyone.
lack	as a transitive verb, is not followed by for. The French do not lack (omit for) a sense of their grandeur.
lay, lain	See lay, lie.

late	When referring to someone who is deceased use <i>the</i> before the word <i>late</i> . He succeeded <i>the late</i> President Smith, not <i>He succeeded late</i> President Smith.
Latin abbreviations	See section 3.11.
latter, former	Both words refer to one of only two persons or things or collections. In a series of three or more, repeat the subject referred to or, if repetition is a problem, use last-named (or first-named).
lay, lie	<i>Lay</i> means to put, place, or prepare. It always takes a direct object. Both the past tense and the past participle are <i>laid</i> . (<i>The President ordered his aide to lay a wreath at the unknown soldier's tomb. The aide laid the wreath two hours later. Yesterday a wreath was laid by the defense minister.</i>) <i>Lie</i> means to recline or be situated. It never takes a direct object. Confusion arises because the past tense of <i>lie</i> is <i>lay</i> (the past participle is <i>lain</i>). <i>He lies</i> (or <i>lays</i> , or <i>has lain</i>) down.
lead, led	<i>Lead</i> (rhymes with <i>need</i>) means to go ahead of, <i>led</i> is its past tense and participle. <i>Lead</i> (rhymes with <i>red</i>) is the metal.
leave	See depart, leave.
led	See lead, led.
LDCs	See less developed countries
lend, loan	Use <i>lend</i> when you need a verb; <i>loan</i> as a verb is colloquial.
less	See fewer, less.
less developed countries (LDCs)	Developing countries is preferred. (Do not say "lesser developed countries." (See Third World.)
Liable	See likely.
lie	See lay, lie.
like, as	Both <i>like</i> and <i>as</i> can properly be used in making comparisons, but <i>like</i> , a preposition, governs nouns, pronouns, and incomplete clauses, while <i>as</i> , a conjunction, governs full clauses. <i>He behaves like a child. He behaves as a child would behave.</i> Sometimes you can omit the verb in the clause after <i>as</i> . In this case the verb is understood: <i>When I was a child, I thought as a child [would think].</i> Leaving out the verb will often produce smoother prose, but you need to ensure that the omission does not sound stilted or foster ambiguity.
likely	As an adverb, <i>likely</i> must be preceded by a qualifier: <i>He quite, more, most, or very.</i> (<i>She will very likely win the election.</i>) As an adjective, it needs no qualifier. <i>He is likely to blow the operation</i> (not <i>He will likely blow the operation</i>). <i>She is a likely candidate.</i> <i>Apt</i> and <i>liable</i> sometimes crop up as synonyms for <i>likely</i> . Neither, however, has the same predictive connotation. <i>Apt</i> suggests a tendency, usually unfortunate: <i>He is apt to lie at the drop of a hat.</i> <i>Liable</i> connotes vulnerability rather than probability: <i>He is liable to arrest.</i>
likewise	is an adverb, not a conjunction, and cannot properly be used as a substitute for <i>and</i> .
links	See relations, ties, links.
loan	See lend, loan.

loath, loathe, loathsome	<i>Loath</i> , an adjective, means reluctant. <i>He is loath to break the agreement.</i> <i>Loathe</i> , a verb, means to dislike intensely. <i>He loathed the long train ride.</i> <i>Loathsome</i> means abhorrent or repulsive. <i>The bloody murder was loathsome.</i>
logistic	in the sense of moving, quartering, and supplying troops, is the adjective; <i>logistics</i> is the noun. <i>Logistical</i> is discouraged.
lower	is both the comparative degree of the positive adjective <i>low</i> (superlative <i>lowest</i>) and the antonym of the positive adjective <i>upper</i> , which, like the antonymous <i>lower</i> , has no comparative or superlative. This consideration is significant only when deciding whether to put a hyphen after <i>lower</i> (as always after <i>upper</i>) in a unit modifier. (See footnote 34.)
majority	means more than 50 percent. <i>Majority</i> takes a singular verb when the sense is oneness. <i>The majority of the Senate supports the measure.</i> When the individuality of the members is stressed, the verb is plural. <i>The majority of the Senators are from rural districts.</i> When no one has achieved a majority, someone still will have a plurality (the group that, while falling short of a majority, is larger than any other). Neither majority nor plurality can be modified by terms like "one-vote" or "one-seat." (See plurality, consensus, and margin.)
margin	<i>Margin</i> , not <i>majority</i> , is what you call the number of legislative seats by which the majority exceeds the minority. <i>The Prime Minister's party, with 220 seats, has a 20 seat margin over the opposition's 200 seats.</i> (See majority and plurality.)
masterful, masterly	Careful writers distinguish between these adjectives. A <i>masterful</i> person is overpowering, overbearing, or imperious; he or she is capable of mastering others. A virtuosic performance is <i>masterly</i> , the work of a master artist.
material, materiel	<i>Material</i> is any substance from which something is made. <i>Materiel</i> refers to equipment, especially military supplies.
may	See <i>could</i> , <i>may</i> , <i>might</i> .
maximum	See absolutes.
meaningful	is a vacuous word that is too often used by analysts to mean significant. <i>The results of the meeting were meaningful</i> is meaningless.
meantime, meanwhile	The former serves mainly as a noun. <i>In the meantime, he waited.</i> You can express the same idea in fewer words by using <i>meanwhile</i> . <i>Meanwhile, he waited.</i>
measures, units of	See sections 2.21, 2.22, and 3.15 as well as the conversion chart on page 25.
media	See <i>data</i> , <i>media</i> , <i>criteria</i> , <i>phenomena</i> .
merofully	See <i>hopefully</i> and subjective words.
metaphors	are figures of speech used to describe something in terms of something else. Approach them with caution. Even experienced writers, seeking to add a flourish to their prose, sometimes make the mistake of mixing unrelated metaphors in a single sentence. One example will serve as a warning: <i>This slap on the wrist came on the heels of the President's trip.</i>
Middle East	is preferred over <i>Near East</i> and <i>Mideast</i> and, as an adjective form, is as acceptable as <i>Middle Eastern</i> .
might	See <i>could</i> , <i>may</i> , <i>might</i> .
migrate	See <i>emigrate</i> , <i>immigrate</i> , <i>migrate</i> .

military	As a noun can be singular or plural—be consistent within a paper. If in doubt, consider it plural.
militate	See <i>mitigate, militate</i> .
minimum	See <i>absolutes</i> .
misinformation	See <i>disinformation, misinformation</i> .
mitigate, militate	<i>Mitigate</i> means to moderate or alleviate. He did what he could to <i>mitigate</i> his minister's wrath. <i>Militate</i> means to have weight or effect, either for or against but more frequently the latter. The facts <i>militate</i> against his interpretation.
Mod	is an abbreviation-derived jargon word (capitalized) that is acceptable in formal writing about weapons to designate different versions (models) of a weapon system: the SS-II Mod 2, all Mods of the SS 11.
modifiers, floating	See also, even, and only.
momentarily	applies to a fleeting instant, it does not mean at any moment.
monetary	See <i>fiscal, monetary</i> .
more than, fewer than, over, under, during, while	<i>Over</i> and <i>under</i> describe location; use <i>more than</i> and <i>fewer than</i> with numbers. For time, use <i>during</i> , <i>from</i> , or <i>while</i> except when the time reference is indefinite or vague. The system has <i>improved during</i> the past year. Inflation is up 10 percent <i>from</i> a year ago. But: Relations <i>between</i> the two nations have <i>improved over</i> time. Living conditions have <i>changed over</i> the centuries.
most, mostly, almost	<i>Most</i> is not a proper substitute for <i>almost</i> in formal writing. <i>Almost every one</i> , not <i>most everyone</i> . <i>Most</i> , not <i>mostly</i> , is the correct word when you mean to the greatest degree. Those <i>most</i> affected, not those <i>mostly</i> affected.
Muhammed, Mohammed	See <i>Muslims</i> .
Muslims	Are adherents of Islam. They are followers of the prophet Muhammad, not Mohammed.
nations	See <i>countries, nations</i> .
naturally	See <i>subjective words</i> .
neither . . . nor	When the elements in a <i>neither . . . nor</i> construction are singular, the verb is singular; when they are plural, the verb is plural. When the elements differ in number, the verb is determined by the number of the nearer (or nearest) element. <i>Neither Bob nor Joe is going to the conference.</i> <i>Neither the French nor the Italians are attending this year.</i> <i>Neither Bob nor his neighbors are planting gardens.</i>
never	Think before writing that something has <i>never</i> happened: are you sure that there has not been even one occurrence in all of history? (See <i>absolutes</i> .)
newly industrializing countries or economies	See <i>Third World</i> .
noisome	means either offensive and disgusting, like a <i>noisome</i> odor, or harmful; it has nothing to do with noise.
nonaligned countries	do not belong to alliances of West or East, but they often are not practitioners of neutrality, like Switzerland. Instead, they are advocates or opponents of selective policies of both sides. Most of them are grouped in the Nonaligned Movement.

nonconventional, unconventional	Nonconventional refers to high-tech weaponry short of nuclear explosives. <i>Fuel air bombs are effective nonconventional weapons.</i> Unconventional means not bound by convention. <i>Shirley Chisholm was an unconventional woman.</i>
none	is singular when used in the sense of no one or not one. <i>None of those delegates was elected party chair.</i> If none applies to more than one person or thing, use a plural verb. <i>None of those delegates were expected to be nominated.</i> The object of the <i>of</i> phrase following none is usually the best indicator of whether none is singular or plural. <i>None of the cake was eaten. None of the cookies were eaten.</i>
North-South	refers in international politics to relations between industrialized and developing nations. North and South also can mean the two Koreas.
not only . . . but also	In not only . . . but also constructions, be sure that the parts of the sentence are parallel. <i>He is aware not only of the political consequences but also of the military dangers.</i> <i>He not only is aware of the political consequences but also recognizes the military dangers.</i> (See parallelism.)
number of	a phrase that is too imprecise in some contexts. <i>A number of troops were killed.</i> (If you do not know how many, say <i>an unknown number</i> .) <i>Number of</i> , when preceded by <i>the</i> , usually takes a singular verb. <i>The number of mistakes is small.</i> When preceded by <i>a</i> , <i>number of</i> generally takes a plural verb and means several. <i>A number of the mistakes were due to carelessness.</i>
numerical order designators	First, second, third, and other designators of numerical order are preferred to firstly, secondly, thirdly, and the rest.
obviously	See qualifiers.
of	turns up as an unnecessary hanger-on in conjunction with words like outside and off. The latter are prepositions in their own right and need no reinforcement. <i>One gets off one's high horse or off the fence, not off of them. Out of, on the other hand, cannot do without of.</i>
of course	See fill-ins.
offload	Use the less pretentious word <i>unload</i> .
offput	is not a word. If you are offended, you are put off.
older, younger	refer to only two persons or things or collections of either; oldest and youngest are the proper adjectives when more than two are involved.
on	See upon, on.
on board	See aboard, on board
one	has a way of intruding into a sentence. <i>The congress was an obstrusive one reads better as The congress was obstrusive.</i> In constructions where one is the subject, use a singular verb. <i>One in every 10 senators is uncommitted.</i> But beware: <i>He is one of those who were (not was) uncommitted;</i> In this construction, <i>those who</i> , not <i>one</i> , controls the verb.
only	is a floating modifier that can be attached to almost any word in a sentence. Anchor it carefully to ensure that you are conveying the meaning you want to convey. <i>Even, primarily, and mainly</i> pose similar challenges. <i>Only he attended the meeting.</i> (The others did not show up.) <i>He only attended the meeting.</i> (He did not make a speech.) <i>He attended only the meeting.</i> (He skipped the dinner.)
on the other hand	See fill-ins.

opine	See pretentious words.
opposition, opposed, opponent	Opposition takes the preposition <i>to</i> , as does <i>opposed</i> ; <i>opponent</i> is followed by <i>of</i> .
optimize	See <i>-ize</i> words.
oral	See verbal, oral.
organ, organism, organization	An <i>organ</i> is a musical instrument, a part of the body, or a medium of communication. An <i>organism</i> is a living plant or animal. An <i>organization</i> is a society or association or business consisting of people united in some way for a specific purpose. Do not use these three words interchangeably.
over	See more than, fewer than, over, under, during, while.
owing to	See based on, due to, owing to.
parallelism	To make a parallel clear, repeat a preposition, an article, the <i>to</i> of the infinitive, or the introductory word of a phrase or clause. Technology <i>to boost</i> production and <i>to exploit</i> natural resources.
parameter, perimeter	<i>Parameter</i> is a legitimate word for mathematicians and scientists, but it is easily misused, for example when <i>dimension</i> or <i>characteristic</i> would be better. Save <i>parameter</i> for the times you really mean a limiting factor, especially when the thing limited is abstract rather than concrete. Do not confuse with <i>perimeter</i> , which is the outer edge of a physical area; the emphasis is on shape and extent rather than on the limits being set.
parliament	Use only if it is the actual name of the body. Otherwise, use <i>legislature</i> or the precise name: <i>National Assembly</i> , <i>Diet</i> , <i>Congress</i> .
parliamentarian	A <i>parliamentarian</i> is an expert on parliamentary rules and procedures, not a member of parliament. People who pass laws are <i>legislators</i> . Or use the specific title of the legislators in question (<i>senator</i> , <i>delegate</i>). Refer to a Japanese legislator as a <i>Diet member</i> , not a <i>Dietman</i> .
participles	must not be left dangling, where they often lead to ambiguity and illogicality. Turning the corner, the view was much changed is clearly wrong. The sentence should read: Turning the corner, he found the view much changed. General guide: participles are adjectives, so watch what they modify and keep them close by. (A memorable dangler from a travel brochure: You can see the Statue of Liberty sailing into New York harbor.)
party	should be applied to a person only in telephone and legal contexts. For guidance on when to capitalize <i>party</i> , see section 1.12.
passive voice	See active voice.
PC	means personal computer.
pending, impending	<i>Pending</i> means yet to come or not yet settled; <i>impending</i> adds a hint of threat or menace.
people, persons, personnel	The word <i>people</i> usually applies to sizable groups imprecisely enumerated (several thousand people showed up for the demonstration), <i>persons</i> to smaller, usually explicit numbers (217 persons were interviewed, nine persons were hired). <i>Personnel</i> is a collective noun (usually plural) referring to employees of an organization or to members of the armed services as a group. Do not use it as a substitute for <i>people</i> or <i>persons</i> . Many people applied. Three persons remain in the running. All company personnel have to be trained.
perimeter	See parameter, perimeter.

personnel	See <i>people, persons, personnel</i> .
persons	See <i>people, persons, personnel</i> .
persuade	See <i>convince, persuade</i> .
phenomena	See <i>data, media, criteria, phenomena</i> .
plurality	The largest single group (of votes, opinions, and the like) when no one has a majority. (See <i>majority and consensus</i> .)
plurals of -um nouns	To pluralize nouns that began life as neuter Latin words (ending in <i>-um</i>), the DI generally adds <i>s</i> rather than following the Latin rules: <i>forums</i> rather than <i>fora</i> , for instance. See Gregg, section 614 for lists of the preferred pluralizations of foreign words. For Latin (and Greek) words that appear most commonly in the plural, see <i>data, media, criteria, phenomena</i> .
possible	See <i>probable, possible</i> .
possibly	See <i>could, may, might</i> .
practicable, practical	<i>Practicable</i> means capable of being carried out in action; <i>practical</i> connotes useful. It was <i>practicable</i> to build a highway (it could be done), but it was not <i>practical</i> (because it would receive little use).
precipitate, precipitant, precipitous	<i>Precipitate</i> applies to rash or hasty human actions. <i>Precipitant</i> is used in the same general sense, but with stress on rushing or falling headlong. <i>Precipitous</i> refers to physical steepness.
preclude, prevent	Generally, <i>preclude</i> applies to events as its object, <i>prevent</i> to persons. The bad weather <i>precludes</i> a departure today. The bad weather <i>prevents</i> me from leaving today.
predominant, predominate	<i>Predominant</i> is the adjective; <i>predominate</i> is the verb. His <i>predominant</i> influence is evident in party pronouncements. His views <i>predominated</i> in party pronouncements.
preface	See <i>foreword, forward</i> .
presently	means in a short time, not at present, currently, or now.
pressure	As a verb, <i>press</i> is preferred.
pretentious words	Avoid words like <i>apprise, citizenry, contradistinction, effectuate, enunciate, evenuate, evince, and opine</i> and use simpler synonyms.
prevent	See <i>preclude, prevent</i> .
primarily	See <i>only</i> .
principal, principle	<i>Principal</i> is an adjective meaning most important, or a noun referring to a leader or to money. <i>Principle</i> is a noun only. It means basic truth, rule of conduct, fundamental law; <i>principled</i> is its related adjective.
prioritize	See <i>-ize</i> words.
prior to, before	<i>Prior to</i> is appropriate when a notion of requirement is involved. The law must be passed <i>prior to</i> 1 July. Otherwise, <i>before</i> is the better word.
pristine	describes something that is in its original condition, or primitive. It should not be used as a synonym for <i>new</i> or <i>clean</i> .
probable, possible	Analysts, particularly military analysts, are tempted to use <i>probable</i> or <i>possible</i> when what <i>probability</i> is or what <i>possibility</i> is is the proper formulation. The attache saw what <i>probability</i> is a missile, not the attache saw a <i>probable</i> missile. Could the officer have seen an <i>improbable</i> (or <i>impossible</i>) missile?

propel	See <i>compel</i> , <i>impel</i> , <i>propel</i> .
protagonist	the leading or principal character, not necessarily a champion of an idea or course of action. <i>Chief protagonist</i> is redundant. (See <i>redundancies</i> .)
proved, proven	<i>Proved</i> is preferred as the participle, <i>proven</i> as the adjective except for energy contexts such as <i>proved reserves</i> or <i>proved fields</i> .
purportedly	See <i>qualifiers</i> .
qualifiers	Do not weaken judgments supported by direct evidence by inserting words like <i>apparently</i> , <i>evidently</i> , <i>seemingly</i> , <i>purportedly</i> . Conversely, you cannot strengthen judgments based on weak evidence by using words like <i>obviously</i> , <i>undoubtedly</i> , <i>clearly</i> . These adverbs are an instance of modifiers that do little or no work. Often you will find adjectives that are open to the same criticism. (See <i>subjective words</i> and the discussion of adjectives and adverbs in section 9.3.)
reason, because	After an opening like <i>the reason for</i> , the clause containing the reason should begin with <i>that</i> , not <i>because</i> or <i>why</i> . <i>The reason for his failure was that he was ill.</i> Better still would be: <i>He failed because he was ill.</i>
rebound	See <i>redound</i> , <i>rebound</i> .
rebut, refute	If you <i>rebut</i> a point of view, you argue to the contrary; if you <i>refute</i> a point of view, you win the argument. New evidence can sometimes <i>refute</i> an earlier report or a piece of intelligence analysis; otherwise, <i>rebut</i> is generally the appropriate word in DE writing.
redound, rebound	<i>Redound</i> means to have an effect. <i>The plot redounds to his credit.</i> <i>Rebound</i> means to bounce back. <i>The economy rebounded last month.</i>

redundancies	are phrases that succumb to repetition. They expose bad habits or, worse, carelessness. The author who writes <i>It is a true fact that they are offering free gifts</i> is not watching his words. Below are selected examples observed over the years by the "redundancy police":
	accidentally mistired adequate enough advance reservation as has been mentioned previously both agree build a new house bureaucratic redtape chief mainstay church seminarians close confidant close personal friend combine together completely surrounded consensus of opinion could possibly current status established tradition exact same exile abroad exports beyond their borders eyewitness at the scene first began final vestiges foreign imports free gift future potential future prospects future successor historical monuments historical past holy shrine in close proximity interact together joint coalition little booklet live studio audience long litany major crisis major milestone meet personally military troops mutual cooperation naval marines old adage own personal past career past history personal autograph personal charisma past custom personal popularity pecameal on a piece basis professional career rally together relocate elsewhere separate isolation cells separate out share together single greatest single most small cottage small village sound logic still continues still remains still retains sufficient enough sum total tandem couple temporary respite temporary suspension thin veneer top business magnate true facts trusted confidant underlying promise unexpected surprise unite together well-known reputation young baby
refute	See rebut, refute.
regard	See consider, regard.
regime	has a disparaging connotation and should not be used when referring to democratically elected governments or, generally, to governments friendly to the United States.
regretfully	See subjective words.
regrettably	See subjective words.

relations, ties, links	Relations should be followed by the preposition <i>with</i> . <i>This country is about to establish relations with that one.</i> Ties (or links) should be followed by <i>to</i> . <i>That country has ties (links) to this one.</i>
relatively, comparatively	<i>Relatively</i> should be used only when the intended comparison can be easily grasped. <i>He has a relatively heavy workload</i> has, by itself, little meaning. Relative to what? Last year? Last week? His colleagues? The same stricture applies to <i>comparatively</i> . (See <i>compare, contrast</i> .)
relevant, important	<i>Relevant</i> refers to something that has a bearing on the matter at hand and should be followed by <i>to</i> . <i>His speech was relevant to the problem.</i> Do not use <i>relevant</i> when you mean <i>important</i> .
reluctant, reticent	<i>Reluctant</i> means hesitant, unwilling to act and should not be confused with <i>reticent</i> , which means uncommunicative or reserved.
represent	means to depict or symbolize, not constitute. <i>The red line on the map represents the boundary between France and Germany</i> is proper usage. <i>South African gold represents most of the world's output</i> is not.
reticent	See <i>reluctant, reticent</i> .
reveal, expose, disclose, divulge	<i>Reveal</i> implies an unveiling of something not previously known; <i>expose</i> , to the making public of something reprehensible; <i>disclose</i> , to the making public of something that has been private; <i>divulge</i> , to the making public of something that has been secret.
Russian submarines	See section 7.6a for information on Russian submarine designators and footnote 39 for a list of submarine names.
sanction	As a noun, has meanings that are almost in opposition, from approval and encouragement to penalty and coercion. It should therefore be used only when the context makes its meaning clear. As a verb, <i>sanction</i> picks up only the approval aspect of the noun.
sanguinary, sanguine	<i>Sanguinary</i> means accompanied by carnage or bloodthirsty. <i>Sanguine</i> means ruddy or optimistic and cheerful.
seemingly	See <i>qualifiers</i> .
semiannual	See <i>biannual, biennial, semiannual</i> .
shall, will	Grammar purists tell us there are fine distinctions to be made between <i>shall</i> and <i>will</i> . Today, these distinctions are not closely observed even in serious writing. For devotees of grammatical history, the distinctions are: In the first person, <i>shall</i> denotes simple futurity; in the second and third persons, <i>shall</i> denotes promise, inevitability, command, or compulsion. <i>Will</i> is the other way around. In our publications, use <i>will</i> . The same distinctions are true for <i>should</i> and <i>would</i> .
she/her/hers	See <i>gender</i> .
ship	See <i>boat, ship</i> .
should	Except when used to connote moral obligation, <i>should</i> is a fuzzy word. Use more precise language in presenting intelligence judgments. (See <i>shall, will</i> .)
significantly	See <i>filings</i> .
single	See <i>redundancies</i> .
situation	See <i>condition, situation, activity</i> .

smartphone	a mobile phone that offers advanced capabilities, often with PC-like functionality
sort	See type.
spam	unsolicited e-mail, sent indiscriminately to multiple mailing lists, individuals, or newsgroups; as a verb it means to send such junk e-mail.
strategy, tactics	Strategy is an overall plan of action, usually military action; tactics are specific plans or maneuvers designed to advance strategic goals. Nuclear weapons can be included in both strategic and tactical planning.
subjective words	The DI is not in the business of deciding whether something is good or bad; therefore, words like <i>fortunately</i> and <i>unfortunately</i> should not appear in DI writing. Discerning the subjective overtones sometimes requires a keen ear: naturally, for example, may give the reader a sense of being talked down to. <i>Regretfully</i> , <i>regrettably</i> , <i>mercifully</i> , <i>interestingly</i> , and other subjective words are vulnerable to the same kind of abuse. Stick with terms that focus on the world of our operational readers: motives and the actions that flow from them, choices, strengths and weaknesses, capabilities and intentions. Most of the time you can find a better way to express the thought. (See <i>hopefully</i> , <i>feel</i> , <i>regime</i> , and <i>upbeat</i> , <i>downtbeat</i> .)
surveil	If you must use it, confine it to the military or intelligence sense.
table	As a verb, <i>table</i> can mean to put a bill aside. In British usage it can also mean to introduce a bill for consideration. Use the word only when the meaning is unmistakable.
tactics	See strategy, tactics.
Taiwan	See China, Taiwan.
technical terms	For the most part, DI analysts are writing for generalists. Generalists may have deep expertise in specific areas, such as missile technology or a country's tribal politics; nonetheless, the analyst's goal is to do away with the specialist's jargon and to put everything into layman's language. If your audience consists of just a few people who thoroughly understand the subject (or who cannot be trusted to follow the reasoning without jargon to guide them), by all means sprinkle your piece with technical terms. Most of the time, however, write for the nonexpert.
that, which	<i>That</i> , as a relative pronoun, introduces clauses containing information necessary for the full comprehension of a sentence. Such defining or restrictive clauses are not set off by commas. The report <i>that</i> was on the general's desk needed revision suggests that there were several reports, but only the one on the general's desk needed to be revised. <i>Which</i> introduces clauses that are not essential to the meaning of a sentence. These nonrestrictive clauses are set off by commas. The report, <i>which</i> was on the general's desk, needed revision suggests that there was a report in need of revision, and it happened to be on the general's desk. The distinction between the two types of clauses is not always easy to make. In crisp prose, <i>that</i> can, and probably should, often be deleted. The information <i>that</i> he needs goes faster <i>as</i> the information he needs. When persons are involved the pronoun is <i>who</i> , whether the clause is restrictive or nonrestrictive.

there is, there are	Try to avoid using <i>there is</i> or <i>there are</i> to start a sentence; look for a more illuminating verb than <i>is</i> . If you do lead off with such a construction, be sure the number of the verb agrees with the subject that follows. Acceptable but minimally informative: <i>There is an artillery regiment on the border.</i> Better: <i>The government has moved an artillery regiment to the border.</i> Grammatically correct but hard to comprehend: <i>There are a headquarters building for each unit and numerous other structures.</i> Better: <i>The army has built a headquarters building for each unit as well as numerous other structures.</i>
Third World	refers to the economically underdeveloped or developing nations in Africa, Asia, and Latin America. These nations are also known as <i>less developed countries</i> , or <i>LDCs</i> , or, preferably, <i>developing countries</i> . Some countries within the Third World are more advanced than the others; they are called <i>newly industrializing countries</i> , or <i>NICs</i> . Among the NICs are Singapore and South Korea. When a reference to such a grouping embraces "nongovernments" such as Hong Kong and Taiwan, the more appropriate term is <i>newly industrializing economies</i> (avoid the abbreviation <i>NIEs</i>). Note that we capitalize (for clarity) the abbreviations <i>LDC</i> and <i>NIC</i> but not the literal terms they stand for; however, we do capitalize (for distinction or contrast) certain nonliteral terms like <i>Third World</i> , <i>Cold War</i> , <i>North-South</i> , <i>East-West</i> , and, if unavoidable, <i>Free World</i> .
this	Often used as a demonstrative pronoun, representing in a single word a situation or a thought expressed earlier. Be sure, however, that <i>this</i> has a clear antecedent; if it does not, either rework the sentence to make the antecedent unmistakable (proximity is the best solution), add the appropriate word or words after <i>this</i> , or devise a formulation that makes the connection without using <i>this</i> .
ties	See <i>relations</i> , <i>ties</i> , <i>links</i> .
together with	Is often found immediately after the subject of a sentence. <i>Together with</i> phrases do not affect the verb. <i>Lower productivity, together with higher interest rates, is hurting the economy.</i> The same is true of <i>along with</i> , <i>as well as</i> , <i>in addition to</i> , and <i>like</i> .
too	In the sense of <i>very</i> , is not acceptable in formal writing; in the sense of <i>excessively</i> , however, it is likely to be the best word.
torturous, tortuous	<i>Torturous</i> means extremely painful. <i>Tortuous</i> means twisting, devious, or highly complex. <i>Many accidents have occurred on the tortuous mountain road.</i>
traditions	long-established practices or elements of culture passed down from generation to generation. Do not use to describe practices developed over the past few years.
try	is followed by <i>to</i> , not <i>and</i> .
type	As a noun, <i>type</i> should be followed by <i>of</i> in constructions like <i>that type of plane</i> or, in the plural, <i>those types of planes</i> . Never omit the preposition. The same holds true for <i>kind</i> and <i>sort</i> .
ultimate	See <i>absolute</i> .
unconventional	See <i>nonconventional</i> , <i>unconventional</i> .
under	See <i>more than</i> , <i>fewer than</i> , <i>over</i> , <i>under</i> , <i>during</i> , <i>while</i> .
undoubtedly	See <i>qualifiers</i> .

unfortunately	See subjective words.																
uninterested	See disinterested, uninterested.																
unique	See absolutes.																
universal	See absolutes.																
unprecedented	See absolutes.																
upbeat, downbeat	should be confined to use as musical terms. In formal prose they sound overly colloquial and may be value-laden as well. (See subjective words.)																
upcoming, forthcoming, coming	When you are looking for an adjective meaning to take place later, try forthcoming or just coming instead of upcoming. Better yet, give a clue as to when: tomorrow, next week, next month.																
upon, on	In almost all cases you can substitute on for upon as a preposition (bearing on the case), but not as an adverb (he felt overwhelmed and put upon).																
URL	is the abbreviation for uniform resource locator, a protocol for specifying addresses on the Internet.																
US	The preferred adjective for our country is US, not American. United States (written out) is the preferred noun, but the US may be used when repetition or space is a problem. You can also use Washington as the noun when it is clear that you are referring to the US Government, not the capital city. Never use we, us, our, or ours when referring to the United States. US (not our) allies disagree. The first person plural is reserved in intelligence writing for the analysts/estimators/writers themselves.																
usage, use	Usage means either a manner of use, as in rough usage, or a habitual practice creating a standard, as in good English usage.																
variety of	takes a plural verb when conveying the sense of several or various. <i>A variety of sources report high casualties.</i> When the emphasis is on the singular variety, rather than on the plural object of of, the verb is singular. <i>A variety of meals is better than eating the same food all the time.</i>																
verbal, oral	A verbal message can be either spoken or written. An oral message is always spoken.																
verbal overkill	Extra words are burdensome to the reader and should be avoided. Here are some samples of verbal overkill and a simple substitute for each: <table> <tr> <td>are in a position to (can)</td><td>it is highly likely that (probably)</td></tr> <tr> <td>at that point in time (then)</td><td>it is possible that (may)</td></tr> <tr> <td>at the present time (now)</td><td>never before in the past (never)</td></tr> <tr> <td>currently in progress (going on)</td><td>subsequent to (after)</td></tr> <tr> <td>due to the fact that (because)</td><td>the majority of (most)</td></tr> <tr> <td>in regard to (about)</td><td>the manner in which (how)</td></tr> <tr> <td>in the event that (if)</td><td>whether or not (whether)</td></tr> <tr> <td>in the near future (soon)</td><td></td></tr> </table> (See tautology and redundancies.)	are in a position to (can)	it is highly likely that (probably)	at that point in time (then)	it is possible that (may)	at the present time (now)	never before in the past (never)	currently in progress (going on)	subsequent to (after)	due to the fact that (because)	the majority of (most)	in regard to (about)	the manner in which (how)	in the event that (if)	whether or not (whether)	in the near future (soon)	
are in a position to (can)	it is highly likely that (probably)																
at that point in time (then)	it is possible that (may)																
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in regard to (about)	the manner in which (how)																
in the event that (if)	whether or not (whether)																
in the near future (soon)																	
very, definitely	Use these and other ambiguous intensifiers sparingly.																
viable	denotes the capacity of a newly created organism to maintain a separate existence. It is often mistakenly used when durable, lasting, workable, effective, or practical is the appropriate adjective.																
vicious circle	is correct. Although vicious cycle is now seen almost as often, it is not accepted in DI writing.																

war	See footnote 7 for guidance on capitalization.
whether	Whether does not always need <i>or not</i> . He still has not decided <i>whether</i> to go. She is going <i>whether or not</i> he does.
which	See <i>that, when</i> .
while	as a conjunction, usually has reference to time. <i>While</i> the President was out of the country, the Army staged a coup. It can, with discretion, also be used in the sense of <i>although</i> or <i>but</i> . <i>While</i> he hated force, he recognized the need for order. Avoid using <i>while</i> in the sense of <i>and</i> . (See more than, fewer than, over, under, during, <i>while</i> .)
who, whom	Most of the time the issue of whether to use <i>who</i> (nominative case) or <i>whom</i> (objective case) is straightforward. Subject: <i>Who</i> is his boss? Object of a verb: <i>Whom</i> did the committee choose? Object of a preposition: <i>Whom</i> does she work for? The nominative case in the objective slot, as in <i>Who</i> did the committee choose? or <i>Who</i> does she work for?, has become acceptable in casual English, spoken or written, but it is not acceptable in formal writing. The main difficulty comes in subordinate clauses, when the syntax sometimes gives <i>who</i> and <i>whoever</i> an objective cast even though structurally they are nominative. The voters will pick the candidate <i>who</i> they think <i>will</i> do the best job. (<i>Who</i> is the subject of <i>will</i> do in the subordinate clause. Do not be thrown off by the interjection <i>they think</i>.) The voters will turn against <i>whoever</i> they think is responsible for their economic hardships. The voters will turn against <i>whomever</i> they blame for their economic hardships. (In the first of the last two sentences, it might seem that <i>whoever</i> is the object of the preposition <i>against</i> and should be replaced with <i>whomever</i>. The object of <i>against</i>, however, is not a single word but the entire clause <i>whoever . . . economic hardships</i>. Thus, <i>whoever</i>, the subject of the verb in the subordinate clause, is correct. In the second sentence, <i>whomever</i>, the direct object of <i>blame</i> in the subordinate clause, is properly in the objective case.)
whose	functions as the possessive of both <i>who</i> and <i>which</i> . <i>Of which</i> , though grammatically correct, sometimes sounds stilted.
will	See <i>shall, will</i> .
with	Do not use <i>with</i> in the conjunctive role of <i>and</i>. Sometimes this sort of use has unintended consequences. They are married <i>and have</i> three children. (Not: They are married, <i>with</i> three children.) He is married <i>and has</i> a child. (Not: He is married <i>with</i> one child.) Too often, <i>with</i> is used to attach an additional thought that would be better treated as an independent clause following an <i>and</i> or a semicolon. Economics and history are his mainstays; knowledge of linguistics is an additional qualification. (Not: Economics and history are his mainstays, <i>with</i> knowledge of linguistics an additional qualification.)
with reference to	See <i>fill-ins</i> .
would	See <i>shall, will</i> .
younger	See <i>older, younger</i> .

youth	as the opposite of old age is always singular; when it means young persons (male or female) collectively it is always plural; when the word refers to an individual young male it is, of course, singular, and its plural is youths. The nation's youth were encouraged to enroll. A gang of youths started the riot. Nowadays, robbing young persons probably include females as well as males, and reports of their activities are more likely to say youths rather than young persons—a trend that we probably should join until someone comes up with a better unsex term.
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